PROGRESS REPORT

Connectivity: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-10-11 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

54 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** *on it in its own report.*

MOBILE PENETRATION · INTERNET USAGE · MOBILE AFFORDABILITY · NATIONAL FIBRE BACKBONE · INTERNATIONAL INTERNET BANDWIDTH · INTERNET EXCHANGE POINTS · SATELLITE BROADBAND LICENSING AND AVAILABILITY

Progress values. *Movement* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Mobile penetration

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	Three 5G licences were awarded in December 2025 for DZD 63.9bn, and one operator is live in all wilayas. A tender was launched in mid-2025 with no award, reported across the trade press, and one operator secured its licence in July. 2025-12-08 - three licences were awarded for DZD 63.9bn, about US$492m, on a six-year plan to nationwide coverage by 2031, the rollout beginning that month. By March 2026 one operator was live in all wilayas and another in eighteen. 2026-02-18 - 345 new 4G base stations were announced across 44 wilayas, toward 4,500 localities by 2027. Draft decrees renewing two GSM licences were examined by the Council of Government in July 2026 with no term, fee or coverage obligation published. Market entry below licence level is inert: the regulator had registered two authorisations for private cabled networks by the end of 2024 and received no applications at all under the simple-declaration regime, operators on general authorisations generating 1.28% of sector revenue.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	A third operator installed 20 towers in an exclave province and enterprise 5G launched commercially; no national subscriber figure is published. 2026-08-19 — the third network installed 20 telecommunications towers in the exclave province of Cabinda with satellite backhaul agreed, stating commercial voice, data and satellite-linked service would start within days. No coverage percentage, investment figure, population reached or launch date is published, and "in the coming days" is the whole of the commitment held. 2026-07-23 — an enterprise 5G service launched commercially in the same province, with the capital at over 70% city coverage, about US$20m budgeted and every provincial capital targeted by 2027. This is enterprise connectivity rather than consumer mobile, and the throughput figures are the operator's own. 2026-06-11 — national roaming and infrastructure sharing extended voice and data to remote areas through shared towers, solar power and satellite backhaul, with no national site count, budget or target published. The standalone fifth-generation network remains at a trial call in a live environment with no commercial launch date, on a vendor release. No regulator return and no operator subscriber total appears anywhere on this ledger, so penetration itself is unmeasured.	MOVEMENT on network build, with no subscriber series on the base
Benin	A second operator launched fifth-generation service in April 2026, two years after the first. 2026-04-28 — a second operator launched fifth-generation service, after the first launched in 2024. That is the whole of the window's movement in network capability. No subscriber total, penetration rate, coverage footprint or regulator return appears on this ledger for either generation of network, so what is recorded is the arrival of a second competitor and nothing about who is on either network. The regulator's own 2025 report is held for its mobile-money and usage findings, reported elsewhere, and carries no connection figure in the account held.	MOVEMENT
Botswana	Mobile telephony subscriptions reached 4,370,350 by September 2025, a rise of 6%%, and the state-held operator targets commercial 5G in Gaborone by October 2026, four years behind the other two. 2026-03-01 — the regulator reported 4,370,350 mobile telephony subscriptions at September 2025 against 4,104,304 a year earlier, and 3,112,962 mobile broadband subscriptions against 2,915,158. Prepaid accounts were 96% of the mobile base and mobile money subscriptions rose 24% to 1,455,986. 2025-09-22 — all three mobile operators cut retail tariffs after the regulator’s costing and pricing study, with inter-network termination rates reduced. The report publishes subscription counts and no penetration rate, so the share of people connected cannot be stated from the base. 2026-08-31 — the state-held operator commits more than P240 million for 2026/27 and targets commercial 5G in Gaborone by October, having spent P225.5 million in 2025/26 upgrading 151 sites to 4G, and putting population coverage at 97 per cent for 2G and 4G and 62 per cent for 3G. The other two operators have been live on 5G since 2022, so a launch closes a gap rather than opening a market. The same census puts 4G coverage at approximately 98% of the population and names infrastructure as the country's strongest competitive advantage. It is a figure carried in a sector report rather than a regulator's return, and coverage is not use.	MOVEMENT
Burkina Faso	Operators delivered their 2025 site commitments in full at 200, 200 and 150 sites, against 800 planned for the year across the fund and the acceleration project. 2026-06-21 — the three operators' 2025 commitments were delivered in full at 200, 200 and 150 sites, and for 2026 one operator is at about half of 100 planned while another has five live, twenty installing and 125 in build, against 800 new sites planned for 2025 across the universal-access fund and the acceleration project with the tender then in progress. The 800 planned and the 550 committed-and-delivered are never reconciled in any held source, so a programme that reports full delivery is reporting against a smaller number than the one announced. No subscriber total, penetration rate or regulator connection series appears anywhere on this ledger, so towers are counted and users are not. Power is the standing constraint on the towers themselves, reported under energy.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burundi	Two operators were contracted to build 4G on 178 hills, a third was licensed with no launch, and no national penetration figure exists. 2026-03-04 — one operator was contracted at more than US$10m for 86 hills across 14 provinces, and 2026-05-04 — the incumbent for 92 hills at US$5.9m, stated to cover 372,035 people, confirmed the following day. A mast-deployment programme under the same financing is named by the regulator as in train, addressing coverage rather than outages. 2026-03-02 — a third operator holds a licence granted in October 2025 with telecommunications and e-health plans and no service launch on file. An infrastructure-sharing law is named by the regulator as in draft, with no text, tabling date or sponsoring ministry published. No subscriber total, penetration rate or regulator return appears anywhere on this ledger, so coverage contracts are visible and take-up is not.	MOVEMENT on contracted coverage rather than on any measured subscriber base
Cameroon	The regulator counts more than 31.5 million active mobile subscriptions in 2024; one operator claims 13.09 million customers and 54.3 per cent share for 2025, unconfirmed by the regulator. The regulator's annual observatory records more than 31.5 million active mobile subscriptions, mobile revenue up nearly 12 per cent at FCFA 631 billion, falling voice traffic and a marked drop in text messaging as users migrate to messaging applications, and more than 4,700 passive infrastructure sites. It also names its own limit: incomplete data from some operators weakens sector monitoring. 2026-03-17 - one operator's group accounts claim 13.09 million customers against 11.87 million a year earlier, a 54.3 per cent market share the regulator has not confirmed, mobile penetration of 80.7 per cent of the population, revenue of FCFA 437.26 billion up 19.4 per cent and capital spending of FCFA 206.72 billion up about 39 per cent. Subscriptions are not users: the same observatory counts over 15 million internet subscriptions, 99 per cent of them mobile, and no unique-user or population-penetration series is published by the regulator itself.	MOVEMENT
Cape Verde	The regulator counted 588,603 active SIMs at 113.9% penetration at the end of March 2026, down 0.8% on the quarter. ARME's Q1 2026 market indicators, published on 5 August 2026, count 588,603 active SIM cards at a penetration rate of 113.9%, a fall of 0.8% against the fourth quarter of 2025 and a rise of 0.2% against the same quarter a year earlier, with CVTelecom holding 68% of active SIMs and Unitel T+ 32%. The quarterly series had stopped at Q2 2025 in the base and now resumes. Nothing in it is broken down by island or municipality, which the ledger carries as an open row.	NO CHANGE
Central African Republic	A third operator launched fourth-generation service in the capital, while subscribers at a northern town had no calls, no internet and no mobile money for close to a month. 2026-05-14 — the third operator launched fourth-generation service in the capital, completing commercial service at all three, having been licensed in December 2025 against one operator live since May 2025. A licence is not coverage: fourth-generation population coverage was measured at 0.3% in 2023. 2026-07-28 — subscribers at a northern town reported no calls, no internet and no mobile money for close to a month, with no restoration date, and some officials unpaid for the previous month because salary transfers run over mobile services. Single-operator dependency with no redundancy, attributed to off-grid relay sites, equipment theft and repair crews travelling hundreds of kilometres. The instrument that would fix that is dormant: the country's first passive-infrastructure licence for pylons, antennas and technical sites to be built and leased to the operators was signed in July 2025 fourteen days before the window opened, and no tower count, site build or lease has been recorded since.	MIXED all three operators now hold fourth-generation licences while one town lost every service for a month
Chad	The larger operator's network investment programme has contested delivery, and fifty telecom sites and fifty kilometres of fibre were announced by an outgoing minister. The investment figure is reported at group level rather than for the national entity, and no source reconciles it with the figures the minister cited (programme, sites, operator). The fifty sites and fifty kilometres were announced at a ministry ceremony by the outgoing minister seven weeks before the portfolio changed hands, and nothing is recorded against them since (announcement). A third private mobile operator is named in the national strategy with no licensing process on record (third operator).	STALLED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Comoros	Both fifth-generation services stand where they launched: one pilot site and two districts of the capital. The incumbent's service is live at one pilot site at a claimed rate of up to 1 Gbit/s, the rate being the operator's own claim rather than a measurement, and no second site, coverage or subscriber figure has been published since. The second operator's service is live in two districts of Moroni, with extension to the other two islands announced, and its group's own 2026 restatement names no new site. No penetration, subscriber or coverage series exists for this country at all - the measurement body the 2018 strategy designed was never created.	NO CHANGE
Congo	The regulator's first market report holds 3.757m mobile-internet subscribers at December 2024, up 9.4%. The regulator's 2024 mobile-internet market report, the first Congolese telecom market data the base holds, records 3.757m mobile-internet subscribers at December 2024, up 9.4%, against an over-15 population of 3.738m. Subscriptions now exceed the addressable over-15 population, so the count no longer measures people. It is an older source arriving late, which makes it a baseline rather than news, and no later regulator market report is held - so the most recent penetration position the base can state is twenty months old.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	The ministry put mobile coverage at 95% and telecom penetration above 130% of population, while 5G's July 2026 launch passed. At the window's opening the base held 4G covering 73.34% of localities and 93.71% of the population. 2026-07-13 - the ministry stated 95% mobile coverage, telecom penetration above 130% of population and smartphone adoption of 41%, a figure repeated at an investment forum against a stated ambition of 80% by 2030. Coverage figures switch between territory, localities and population without a stated base, so the two ends are not the same measurement. 5G went the other way. It was announced for July 2026 in towns above 25,000 inhabitants with all operators said to be equipped, after spectrum was re-planned and financial terms settled following a missed 2023 target. No launch, spectrum award terms or coverage obligation is on file: the second stated date to pass undelivered.	MIXED the ministry's coverage and penetration figures rose while a second stated 5G launch date passed undelivered
Djibouti	The incumbent's statutory monopoly stands under two laws, with no competing licensed operator. The monopoly is restated in the operator's own profile and no competing licensed operator exists, unchanged at both ends of the window. The profile's cable and capacity figures are stale and are not carried here. No subscriber count, penetration rate, coverage figure or tariff is published by the operator or by any regulator, for any date in the window. A country carrying a substantial share of the world's submarine cable traffic publishes no measure of how many of its own people are connected.	NO CHANGE
DR Congo	Mobile subscriptions reached 73.93m at 67.8% penetration in 2025, from 63.96m and 60.5% in 2024. The first regulator-submitted regional dataset the base holds puts the country at 73.93m mobile subscriptions and 67.8% penetration in 2025, against 63.96m and 60.5% in 2024. It is a regional compilation of the national regulator's own returns rather than a published national series, and the regulator itself publishes nothing comparable that the base holds. The same return reports no mobile-money transaction value at all, so a country with tens of millions of wallets contributes no payment volume to the regional statistics it now files into. The next generation is not moving: a public consultation on introducing 5G opened in March 2025 and seventeen months later no consultation report, spectrum award, licence or revised timetable has been published. An independent tower company reached 3,000 sites on 3 September 2026, 673 of them rural, and claims coverage for more than 40 million Congolese. The count and the claim are the company's own; no regulator figure stands against them.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Egypt	Fifth-generation service has run since June 2025 on refarmed 2.6 GHz, while combined median download speed fell to 34.77 Mbps. Service has been in place since June 2025, initially focused on Cairo and Alexandria, on shared refarmed blocks of 20 to 30 MHz; no coverage obligation, subscriber count or population-coverage figure is held, and the country is the only one of four North African launch markets with no published coverage or quality obligation. Crowdsourced measurement puts fifth-generation median download at about 89 Mbps at month six against 110.5 Mbps on launch day, and the combined median at 34.77 Mbps against a pre-launch baseline of 37.68 Mbps, with fourth-generation down 17% - cited as a measurement, not absorbed. About 3,000 new towers are planned in 2026 and more than 9,000 over three years, against a target of 40,000 by 2028. 2026-08-19 - a first upper 6 GHz mobile trial ran at a reported 1.7 Gbps per user, with no allocation, award or commercial date.	MIXED fifth-generation service is in place across four operators and towers are expanding while measured combined download speeds fell below the pre-launch baseline
Equatorial Guinea	A semestral plan targets 85 per cent second- and fourth-generation coverage through 34 new towers in the islands and the interior. The plan was presented to the Prime Minister in July 2026 and also names a zero-roaming arrangement with four neighbours and a national digital postcode system; the plan document itself is not held (connectivity plan). No current coverage figure, subscription series or penetration rate is published at any date, so the 85 per cent target (plan) has no starting point on the record.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	Active connections reached 859,000, or 23.7% of the population, up 8.2% year on year, among the lowest rates in Africa. 2025-11-08 — DataReportal's Digital 2026 report for Eritrea puts active mobile connections at 859,000, 23.7% of the population, 49.3% of them broadband, and up 8.2% on the year. The previous edition is the comparison. The direction is upward and the level is among the lowest in Africa. Both statements are true, and the second governs what sits downstream of it: a foundational digital ID, mobile money and any service assumed to reach a citizen through a handset all rest on this figure. No operator or regulator return on the ledger tests it. Coverage is separately reported and much higher than connections: 85% of the population is covered by a mobile-cellular network but only 35% by at least third-generation service and 0% by at least fourth-generation, on 2023 international figures. Nearly a quarter of the population holds a connection inside a network that reaches five-sixths of them.	MOVEMENT
Eswatini	Mobile coverage against mobile-internet use has not moved, while a smart-city deployment fits a fifth-generation network, 59 camera systems and public wireless access in the capital. The coverage and usage figures come from the ICT ministry, given at a change-management workshop for the digital project (coverage, reform). The capital's deployment fits a fifth-generation network, 59 artificial-intelligence-enabled cameras and public wireless access (deployment). No lawful basis, retention rule or oversight arrangement for the camera network is stated anywhere, and the four laws named as forthcoming alongside it — including critical infrastructure and artificial intelligence — have not appeared.	NO CHANGE
Ethiopia	The incumbent reports 99.8% population coverage on about 90m subscribers, and the second operator 14.7m active customers. Mobile connections reached 93.2m in late 2025, 68.4% of the population, from 85.4m and 63.8% in early 2025 (connections). The incumbent reported 99.8% population coverage in April 2026 (coverage), and the second operator 14.7m ninety-day active customers in August after upgrading more than 67 sites across nine southern towns against congestion and power problems (site upgrades). Contracts signed at the 2026 industry congress cover 1,500 new sites and 502 upgrades from one vendor and 647 from another, under a three-year corporate strategy to 2028 (expansion contracts, strategy); a review in August put 879 sites complete under the second programme (progress review). The incumbent's Year II business plan of 3 September 2026 targets a customer base of 96.2 million and 4G sites rising from 6,924 to 11,014 in 2026/27 (plan); these are targets, not outturns. The second network put itself at 15 million 90-day active customers and more than 3,600 sites at five years (second network).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gabon	3.27 million mobile connections at the end of 2025, equivalent to 126 per cent of the population, of which 88.9 per cent are broadband. Industry data counts 3.27 million cellular connections at the end of 2025, equivalent to 126 per cent of the population and up 65,000 or 2.0 per cent on the end of 2024, of which 88.9 per cent connect over third-, fourth- or fifth-generation networks. Connections are not people: the same data notes that some carry voice and messaging only, and multiple subscriptions per person are what lift the ratio past the population itself. The regulator counts subscriptions rather than connections and puts them at more than two million on 97 per cent national coverage in 2024. A governance index scores mobile communications at 74.2 for 2023, 17th of 54 and up 5.8 points over the decade - a quarter of the gain the same index records on internet and computers, which is what a market already near saturation on voice looks like.	MOVEMENT
Gambia	The mobile incumbent's network modernisation is contracted at GMD 6.1bn, covering fourth- and fifth-generation radio access and core systems. The agreement was signed on 9 July 2026 alongside the equity transfer (modernisation). No subscription series, penetration rate, coverage figure or market-share statistic is published by the regulator at any date, so a contracted upgrade is the only forward-looking connectivity evidence the base holds and there is nothing to measure it against. Three operators migrated to nine-digit mobile numbers at midnight, with the fourth to follow in a second phase on the 89 prefix. No date is published for the second phase, and no subscriber or fault figure for the first.	MOVEMENT
Ghana	The latest regulator bulletin records 38.47m mobile voice subscriptions at 116.84 per cent penetration, against a stated shortfall of about 6,000 cell sites. The July-September 2024 bulletin is still the latest held, recording 38.47m mobile voice subscriptions at 116.84 per cent penetration, 25.56m mobile data subscriptions and one operator on 75.09 per cent of the market - a rate above parity because it counts subscriptions rather than people. 2026-09-06 - the minister puts the requirement at about 6,000 additional cell sites against roughly 1,100 in the current build, completion of that round set for 2027. Behind it are 800 sites committed by the dominant operator with 180 already active, and a 2026 plan of 2,698 sites at the second operator of which 1,890 are live within a network of roughly 9,000. 2026-09-07 - voice over LTE has risen from about 7 per cent of traffic to 22.43 per cent on 8.4 million subscribers, the minister's figures with no regulator series behind either end. 2026-09-03 - the state operator behind the AT Ghana brand got a board, releasing spectrum in three bands and core-network access that had waited almost two months for one, both conditional on audited accounts. The first shared 5G wholesale network was activated in March 2026 and its operator's exclusivity deleted from 15 July 2026.	MOVEMENT
Guinea	The state holds 87.5 per cent of the second mobile operator, transferred at the end of 2024, on about 3m subscribers. The transfer was made official on 30 December 2024 (transfer). No regulator subscription series, penetration rate or market-share figure is published at any date, so a single operator's subscriber count carried in a transfer report is the whole of the connectivity measurement the base holds.	NO CHANGE
Guinea-Bissau	No new penetration series was published; the ledger's own measures remain the base's figures. Nothing in this batch updates the mobile or internet penetration measures the ledger already carries. What moved instead is supply and enforcement: the national fibre backbone tender was relaunched in March 2026 after two cancelled rounds, and the regulator warned that only the licensed satellite operator may sell its service, with illegal resale to face sanctions.	NO CHANGE
Kenya	The dominant operator took a 25-year unified licence in May 2026, consolidating spectrum and authorisations against a historic ten-year term. Licence-related costs were about US$126.7m in the year to March 2026, and the prior position was a temporary two-year unified permit (licence). A twenty-five-year term is the longest regulatory commitment in the base, and it was granted to the operator the base separately records as dominant in mobile money and designated systemically critical.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Lesotho	The larger operator reports 1.21m customers and 85 per cent market share, and the other has 149 5G sites on 700MHz. The thirtieth-anniversary account of June 2026 gives 1.21m customers, 85 per cent market share, 422 base stations of which 101 are solar, and coverage of 97 per cent on 2G, 98 per cent on 3G and 96 per cent on 4G (account). A US$40m phased network upgrade was announced in March 2026 (upgrade), following an upgrade pledged at the group chief executive's visit in August 2025 (visit). The second operator grew its 5G sites from 54 to 149 on 700MHz by June 2025, and no later figure is held (5G, network).	MOVEMENT
Liberia	A universal licence was revoked in July 2026 after six years without operation, leaving two mobile operators of any scale. Spectrum, numbering and regulatory privileges reverted to the regulator, the licensee having been suspended for 90 days from February 2026; the market at mid-2026 is estimated at 3.2m subscribers for the leading operator, 2.3m for the second and 14,000 for the state operator (revocation). Fifth-generation services are stated as planned with investors still being engaged, and no spectrum award, licence condition or launch date is published (plans).	MIXED a dormant licence was revoked while a fifth-generation plan has no spectrum award behind it
Libya	Commercial 5G began in central Tripoli in January 2026 and the state operator is in talks with Nokia; no penetration figure is published. Almadar Aljadid began the country's first commercial 5G service in central Tripoli on 29 January 2026, with extension to the rest of the country stated to follow (launch). A regional review a year later placed Libya among the North African markets where 5G is live (review). LTT met Nokia on 15 July 2026 on 5G cooperation, with no agreement announced (meeting). No subscriber count, coverage share or penetration measure is published in this base, so what is recorded here is network availability rather than take-up.	MOVEMENT
Madagascar	A 5G-Advanced trial ran in July 2026 with no commercial 5G on record, above a 4G and 5G expansion programme funded at US$100m. The trial ran at an operator campus on 23 July 2026; the operator claims to be the fourth in the world to test the technology, and the claim is its own (trial, account). A development bank lent US$100m to the operator group under a European connectivity programme, US$40m of it for Madagascar, alongside US$82m of the group's own investment (loan); no coverage or site figure has been published since (loan, investment). No subscriber count, penetration rate or coverage share for the country is held at all.	MOVEMENT
Malawi	An industry report puts 4G coverage at 87 per cent against mobile-internet penetration of 12.5, while 5G launched in 2025 and reached 111 sites on the other network. The industry association's report gives fourth-generation coverage at 87 per cent of the population against mobile-internet penetration of 12.5 per cent, scores the country 36 of 100 on its digital nations index and 55 of 100 on policy and regulation, and describes mobile-money adoption as near universal (report); it is the association's own index and the base holds no official national subscriber and coverage series (report). The first 5G network launched at Lilongwe in July 2025 with four further cities named as extension targets, and no later site count is held for it (launch). The other operator reported 111 sites across ten districts, after 58 new sites on MWK 50.8bn of network capital expenditure in the 2025 financial year (sites), and a fixed-wireless operator extended 4G coverage to nineteen neighbourhoods of the capital (fixed wireless). A 36th tower under the Last Mile Rural Connectivity Project was switched on at Kalira Village, Traditional Authority Kalumbu, in September 2026. The wider World Bank-financed programme carries US$150m across digital connectivity, a 100-tower universal service fund rollout and an e-services platform. Neither account gives a population figure for the coverage the 36 towers have added.	MIXED 5G launched and expanding against fourth-generation coverage of 87 per cent that only 12.5 per cent of people use
Mali	A development-bank loan of November 2025 puts 300 4G towers, half of them rural, and fibre to about 300,000 households into build. The build is the base's only forward commitment on mobile coverage: 300 towers with half in rural areas, alongside fibre to about 300,000 households (loan). No subscriber count, penetration rate or coverage share is published for the country at all, so the addition is on record and the base it adds to is not.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritania	Four fifteen-year 5G licences were awarded in 2026 and the first commercial network launched at Nouakchott in August, with no coverage or subscriber figure published. Licences went to the three incumbents and a new entrant at bids of MRU 252.6m to 305m plus 5 per cent of revenue, breaking the three-operator structure (licences). One operator launched the country's first commercial 5G network at Nouakchott on 10 August 2026 under the digital transformation minister; no coverage footprint, tariff or subscriber figure is published (launch, account). The same operator had completed a full network modernisation at Nouakchott with a foreign vendor in November 2025, again with no coverage, capacity or subscriber figure published (modernisation).	MOVEMENT
Mauritius	Mobile penetration is reported in the 2025 ICT statistics, a first observation on this ledger. The statistics office's 2025 ICT release is the source of record (release). Two regulator decisions bear on what those subscriptions run over: the 700 MHz band opened in December 2025 (decision), and 3G is being phased out (communique). This is a first figure with no earlier observation held, so the level is stated and the direction is withheld. The 3G sunset has no switch-off date or migration figure behind it.	NO CHANGE
Morocco	The regulator's own observatory puts the mobile park at 57.06m and penetration at 154.93 per cent, with the park down slightly year on year and 5G in service since November 2025. Independent measurement put median 5G speed down 38% in six months, from an opening figure near 267 Mb/s (measurement) — a fall in service quality as subscriber numbers rise. The first regulator-published periodic observatory, for the first quarter of 2026, gives a mobile park of 57.06m, down 0.58 per cent year on year, penetration of 154.93 per cent, outgoing traffic down 18.79 per cent and messaging down 9.12 per cent, with sector revenue up 2.89 per cent (observatory). Three operators launched 5G on the same day in November 2025 on 3.5 GHz and 700 MHz (launch, account). A dual-band deployment on rail and motorway corridors entered commercial service in 2026 with no additional sites built; the regulator put that operator at 19.4m mobile subscriptions and a 34.04 per cent share at the end of March 2026 (deployment).	MIXED subscriber numbers rose while measured 5G speed fell
Mozambique	5G spectrum was assigned to three operators in June 2026 with a provincial-capital deadline of June 2027, against 209 of 1,222 localities uncovered. Licences were awarded to the three operators in June 2026 by administrative consignment rather than auction, covering 5G and 4G expansion; one group reports 210 MHz assigned to its Mozambican operator for US$56m with payment and licence terms still being finalised (award, revenue). The licences carry a deadline of June 2027 for 5G in every provincial capital, with 4G obligations reaching border and rural areas in a later phase; two operators put on record that many target localities have no grid electricity, roads or backhaul (terms). The regulator's 2024 report has 6 of 453 administrative posts and 209 of 1,222 localities uncovered, at 82.9 per cent locality coverage, with no later figure published (coverage).	MIXED 5G licensed with 2027 coverage deadlines while six administrative posts and 209 localities still have no service at all
Namibia	4G population coverage was 88.4 per cent on 2023 data, commercial 5G is live in three centres, and operators have been instructed to retire 2G and 3G. The regulator's series gives 4G population coverage of 85 per cent in 2022, with six of fourteen regions below 80 per cent and one at 41 per cent, 456 of 1,380 schools and 84 of 452 health facilities without 4G coverage, and about 2,000,000 of 2,900,000 mobile cards actively used for internet (2022); the 2023 edition gives coverage of 88.4 per cent, fibre to the home at 27 per cent of fixed broadband subscribers and a 6 per cent fall in active cards (2023, release). The published series is irregular and no edition reporting 2024 data is held (series). Commercial 5G launched at the end of August 2025 in three centres, with nationwide deployment stated as phased and city-first (5G). The regulator has instructed operators to retire 2G and 3G and refarm the spectrum; the incumbent asked government to subsidise smartphones before switch-off, and no switch-off date or government response is on file (retirement).	MIXED 5G live in three centres and 2G and 3G ordered retired while the regulator's own published series stops at 2023

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Niger	The regulator puts 16,380,016 subscriptions and 62% penetration at the end of 2024, the first national figure the base holds. The regulator's annual report states the mobile subscriber base at 31 December 2024 as 16,380,016 subscriptions, a penetration rate of 62% against a population of 26,312,034. It published its third-quarter 2025 observatory on 15 January 2026; the quarterly subscriber and penetration figures sit in an attachment the base does not hold, so the 2024 year-end reading is the most recent one on file. Against that, the regulator launched a campaign on 27 July 2026 to verify coverage and the voice and data service map after months of user complaints; its findings are not published, so the base holds the complaint and the promise of a measurement but no measurement.	MOVEMENT
Nigeria	188m mobile subscriptions and 157m internet subscribers sit above 4G population coverage of about 85 per cent, while a roaming remedy has produced no subscriber recovery. Two regulator series run side by side: mobile subscriptions at 188m with broadband penetration 55.67 per cent in April 2026, up from 50 per cent in November 2025, and internet subscribers at about 157m in May 2026, up 2.67m in the month (subscriptions); the internet series counts active data-using lines, so reactivation and acquisition are indistinguishable in it (subscriptions, internet). Population coverage runs 4G at about 85 per cent and 5G at about 13 per cent against 2030 targets of at least 96 and at least 50 (coverage); 2G reaches 95.31 per cent and 3G 89.42 (coverage, roadmap). Close to a year after national roaming was approved as a remedy, the beneficiary operator was flat at 802,534 internet subscribers for a second month (roaming), while a competitor grew from about 13,000 to about 17,200 sites in three years (retail). The dominant operator ended July 2026 with 100.86 million subscribers on regulator data, up from 98.64 million in June and 51.76 per cent of the market, the first Nigerian operator to pass 100 million (operator).	MOVEMENT
Rwanda	Regulator quarterly statistics carry mobile and internet subscriptions to the first quarter of 2026, and voice over fourth-generation networks launched in August 2026. The regulator's quarterly report is the subscription series, and it carries no printed publication date (statistics). Voice over fourth-generation networks launched in August 2026. It is the technical precondition for retiring circuit-switched voice, though the source makes no reference to the sunset (voice). The fifth-generation network launched in June 2025 and nothing on the build has entered the base in the fourteen months since (fifth generation).	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	The incumbent operator inaugurated its 35th antenna in March 2026, on a network expansion running alongside a school connectivity plan. The 35th antenna was inaugurated in a coastal district in March 2026 (antenna, expansion). No coverage percentage, subscriber count or population-served figure accompanies it, so the antenna count is the only measure of the network the base holds. For a two-island state, a count of masts is a more meaningful measure than it would be elsewhere, and it is still not coverage.	MOVEMENT
Senegal	Rural household internet access was stated at end-2025 against fourth-generation coverage reaching 97 per cent of the population, so the shortfall is usage rather than coverage. The rural figure sits against fourth-generation coverage reaching 97 per cent of the population in 2025, which makes it a usage gap rather than a coverage gap (access). That distinction decides what would close it. Coverage obligations and tower financing do not reach a household that is covered and not connected, and the instruments recorded elsewhere in this report — the connectivity project, the device programme, the affordability measures — are the ones that would.	MOVEMENT
Seychelles	One operator launched commercial fifth-generation service in July 2026, and the incumbent launched fifth-generation with a Chinese vendor in 2020. The commercial launch came in July 2026 with a broadcaster content partnership alongside; plan and pricing detail is paywalled and not held (launch, turnkey). The incumbent launched fifth-generation service in 2020 with a Chinese vendor supplying it (incumbent). An emergency-communications memorandum signed with a Chinese supplier at a 2025 trade congress, for a resilient mission-critical core integrating with the incumbent's network, has had no update in more than seventeen months (memorandum).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sierra Leone	The state operator is being relaunched as a mobile virtual network operator, with a commercial partner appointed in April 2026. The investment partner was appointed in April 2026 (relaunch). No launch date, subscriber target, spectrum arrangement or wholesale price is published. A state operator re-entering the market as a virtual operator on a competitor's network is a structural choice the record states without explaining.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	11.5 million connections at the end of 2025, 58.1 per cent of the population and up 757,000 year on year, with three-quarters on broadband networks. The most recent figure the base holds puts active cellular connections at 11.5 million against a 19.8 million population, of which 75.7 per cent are classed as broadband, growing 757,000 or 7.0 per cent over the year (estimate). Connections are not people: no unique-subscriber figure is published, and multi-SIM use in a market with five operators makes the penetration rate an upper bound. What the market is now addressing is the handset, through a device-finance scheme targeting 100,000 units by the end of 2026 (programme).	MOVEMENT
South Africa	93.8% of households held a cellphone only in 2025, with 3.7% having no telephone at all (figures). Official household figures charted and published in August 2026 record 93.8% of households holding a cellphone only in 2025, 2.5% holding both a cellphone and a landline, and 3.7% — about 740,000 households — holding no telephone at all, against nearly 55% with none in 2002 (figures). The only subscription movement the base holds for the window is at the resale layer. An analyst house put active virtual-operator SIMs at about 4.4 million at end-2025, up roughly 43% year on year and forecast to reach 14.4 million by 2030, placing the country first on the continent. One operator separately reported 5.7 million virtual-operator subscribers on its own wholesale platform for the twelve months to 31 May 2026, which it put at an estimated 80 to 85% share. The two are not a series and cannot be netted: one counts SIMs across the market on an undisclosed method, the other counts subscribers on a single platform. No regulator return and no operator-reported national subscriber figure appears on this ledger, so growth in resale is visible and total penetration is not.	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	3G or 4G covers 15 per cent of the population, and a coverage extension expected from February 2026 has not been delivered. The mobile industry association put 3G or 4G coverage at 15 per cent of the population, with 2G voice networks predominating and 7 active mobile broadband subscriptions per 100 people against an African average of 44.8 (profile). A fifteen-year operator licence was awarded in April 2025 (licence), and an operator launched embedded subscriber identity service in January 2025 (service). The coverage extension to one administrative area was expected from February 2026 and has not arrived. Operators are reported as citing doubts about revenue from the area, and no operator statement is held (coverage). A Universal Service and Access Fund exists in statute and was budgeted for in September 2025 without an amount or source being stated (fund), so the instrument that would override the market answer is constituted and unquantified.	MOVEMENT
Sudan	The ministry reports 60 fourth-generation towers built with 200 more planned during 2026, and no later source confirms progress against the target. The tower count and the 2026 target come from the digital ministry's own account, and no later source confirms progress against it (towers). The digital-transformation minister separately praised the two operators for keeping services running through the war; that is ministerial praise rather than an independent operational assessment, and no coverage, outage or availability figure accompanies it (operators). Every connectivity figure in this unit is the government's or an operator's own, and none is measured by a regulator.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tanzania	Fifth-generation facilities rose 139 per cent from 754 in June 2024 with data consumption up from 426 to 932 petabytes, while the smartphone user count fell quarter on quarter as the percentage rose. The regulator's quarterly report to March 2026 carries the facilities and consumption figures (deployment, expansion). The smartphone user count fell quarter on quarter while the percentage rose and the base does not reconcile the two; the regulator names low smartphone penetration and a 23.7 per cent geographic broadband gap as sector challenges (smartphones). Active subscriptions and penetration come from the regulator's own quarterly report for the quarter to June 2026, now held first-hand (subscriptions, report, regional). The regulator scored quality for the quarter to June 2026: the state operator highest at 98.1 per cent, ahead of the largest operator at 97.7 and the third at 97.1 (rankings) — the state operator leading on quality while holding a small share of the market.	MOVEMENT
Togo	Fifth-generation service on 100 MHz has been commercial since 2020, restated in a regional regulators' survey, and a licence for internet-of-things networks was authorised by decree. The fifth-generation launch date is held at year precision, and both sources are regional reports faceted to West Africa, so a national query misses them (service, report). The internet-of-things licence decree was adopted in August 2026; it authorises the grant rather than recording it, and no licence number, fee, coverage obligation or ownership of the licensee is published (licence). No subscriber, coverage or population-served figure for mobile service appears anywhere in this ledger.	NO CHANGE
Tunisia	All three operators launched fifth-generation service within days of each other in February 2025, on a market where mobile broadband is the dominant access point. The three launches came within days in February 2025, and independent measurement of speed a year on is a reference study cited rather than absorbed as country state (launch, measurement). Regulator data shows mobile broadband as the dominant access point (market, growth). Three simultaneous launches indicate a coordinated award rather than competitive timing, and no spectrum award document is held.	MOVEMENT
Uganda	Active mobile subscriptions and smartphones in use both rose on regulator statements, and the regulator states its figures come from licensees' own submissions. The subscription figure was stated in July 2026, and the regulator states the figures come from licensees' own submissions (subscriptions, report, submission). The smartphone figure's start carries no date (smartphones). The leading operator's coverage and fibre footprint come from its own unaudited half-year results, with the base holding no position at the window's opening (operator, sustainability). Every connectivity figure in this unit originates with an operator.	MOVEMENT
Zambia	The technology ministry puts the country at about 26.2 million mobile subscriptions in 2025 against 23.2 million in 2024. The technology ministry put the country at about 26.2 million mobile subscriptions in 2025, up from 23.2 million in 2024, with about 14.7 million of them mobile internet (ministry). These are the ministry's own figures, given in a seminar address rather than a regulator publication. 2026-09-03 - a second account of the same period puts internet subscriptions at 14.7m in 2025 against 10.4m in 2021 and mobile population coverage at 95% over 2022 to 2025, alongside the services the national portal carries. The coverage figure is government-reported and does not reconcile with the ministry's own separate claim for the same period.	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	Fifth-generation base stations rose on first-quarter 2026 sector data, and the state mobile operator's turnaround plan restated a US$1bn-by-2029 target weeks before its chief executive was terminated. The base-station and rural-coverage figures are the regulator's own (stations, report, comparison). The turnaround target was restated at an annual general meeting; revenue figures are operator-reported and the same source states two growth rates that cannot both be right, and the chief executive's contract was terminated in August 2026 (plan, termination). Base stations deployed by the infrastructure company are company-reported for the quarter to May 2026 (deployment), and a broadband mapping programme is working with operators to identify poor-coverage areas (mapping).	MOVEMENT

Internet usage

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	The regulator's 2024 report records fixed internet at 6,216,146 subscribers, up 12.48% on 619,779 new fibre connections. The 2024 annual report records 60.98m combined fixed and mobile subscribers at 31 December 2024, of which 54.05m mobile and 6.93m fixed, with 47.30m of the mobile base on 4G against 2.73m on second-generation service, that older base down by a fifth in the year; fixed internet stands at 6,216,146, up 12.48% on 619,779 new fibre connections. It is the only official statistical release held: no quarterly observatory, statistics-office series or payment-instrument report exists. 2026-07-14 - generalisation of the newer internet addressing standard was ordered, with no completion date. Oran joined Algiers in a measurement firm's global top 50 cities for mobile internet speed on its latest monthly update. It measures cities on crowdsourced tests, not the country, and neither speed nor rank is stated in the account held.	MOVEMENT
Angola	55.5 per cent of individuals used the internet in 2024, on 12,785,472 broadband subscriptions at 36.4 per cent penetration. The regulator publishes the measured position: 55.50 per cent of individuals using the internet in 2024, 12,785,472 broadband subscriptions at 36.40 per cent penetration against 26,407,932 mobile subscriptions at 75.19 per cent, and national population coverage of 89.60 per cent at second generation, 85.66 at third, 77.41 at fourth and 16.40 at fifth. Fifth-generation coverage reaches three provinces of the then eighteen, and only the capital is at full coverage on the older generations. Nothing in the twelve months to September 2026 updates that measurement. What moved was supply rather than use: the national broadband programme and rural roaming and infrastructure sharing.	NO CHANGE
Benin	The regulator's weekly readings placed the state-linked operator ahead of the two international groups on 3G and 4G data speed (readings). The regulator's weekly readings placed the state-linked operator ahead of the two international groups on 3G and 4G data speed (readings). The measurement is the regulator's own and no absolute speed is carried here.	MOVEMENT
Botswana	Penetration is put at 81.4% on 2.09m users at end-2025, against a regulator figure of about 73% three weeks earlier, and the two are unreconciled. 2025-11-26 — an end-2025 estimate puts internet users at 2.09m and penetration at 81.4%. It is a reference-study figure, and the regulator is separately reported at about 73% three weeks earlier, with the base reconciling neither against the other. No official penetration figure is held for the country at any date — only a venture fund's promotional claim and a reference study — so the eight-point spread between the two numbers in circulation cannot be settled. That matters more here than in most countries in this report, because the roadmap reported under strategy is built on an ICT share of output and a jobs target, and the denominator for both is a population whose connection rate the state does not publish. The household series is firmer than either national figure. Household internet access reached 68.9 per cent in 2024, up 28.3 percentage points on 2014, with 31.1 per cent of households having none against 59.4 per cent a decade earlier. Among those without, the commonest reason given was the cost of equipment at 34.3 per cent, then lack of skills or knowledge at 32.4 per cent - so what is missing is devices and skills rather than coverage.	MIXED household access far ahead of the reasons households give for going without
Burkina Faso	800 towers are planned to connect 1,000 white-zone localities by 2027. The government plans 800 telecom towers, 250 through the Digital Transformation Acceleration Project and 550 through the Universal Access and Service Fund, to connect 1,000 white-zone localities by 2027. The regulator's own figures put attacks on telecom infrastructure at 106 in 2022 against 11 in 2019, cutting network coverage by 10 to 20 per cent. The plan is the largest structural expansion on the record and it has no contract, budget or site list behind it. The coverage the towers would restore was lost to attack, not to underinvestment.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burundi	12.5 per cent of Burundians were using the internet in early 2025, while a fifth-generation network launched commercially in December. The regulator's coverage figures put 3G at 50 to 54 per cent of the population, 4G at 32 to 34 per cent and 2G at 97 per cent, with only 12.5 per cent of Burundians actually using the internet in early 2025, against 80 installed fifth-generation sites after a commercial launch in December 2025. A separate account cites international union data that nearly 90 per cent of Burundians had no internet access in 2023. The regulator publishes a quarterly market observatory covering voice, SMS, internet and mobile financial services, its fourth-quarter 2025 edition appearing in April 2026 — the standing subscription-based series the indicator would be read from. Coverage and use are the gap this row records: a network reaching most of the population that most of the population does not use. An earlier and independent figure sits under that: 1.51 million internet users at the start of 2024, 11.3 per cent of the population and up 40,000 or 2.7 per cent on the year, against 7.78 million cellular mobile connections equal to 58.0 per cent of the population. The two counts use different methods and nothing reconciles them, but both put usage far below connection.	MOVEMENT on a low base
Cameroon	The regulator's 2024 observatory records over 15m internet subscriptions, 99% of them mobile, with data traffic up 26%. The regulator's 2024 annual market observatory records over 15m internet subscriptions, 99% of them mobile, data traffic up 26%, fixed teledensity described as extremely low, and over 11m active mobile financial services subscribers. The account held is secondary; the regulator's own report is not. The base holds no comparable dated prior-year subscription figure and no penetration or gender-gap rate at all, so the only movement statable is the traffic growth, and the level is carried as the observatory states it rather than promoted into a current position.	MOVEMENT
Cape Verde	The regulator counted 511,702 internet subscriptions at the end of March 2026, up 1% on the quarter and down 4% on the year. ARME's Q1 2026 indicators count 511,702 internet access subscriptions, 86% of them delivered over mobile broadband on a small screen, a rise of 1% against the fourth quarter of 2025 and a fall of 4% against the same quarter of 2025 — mobile broadband subscriptions fell 16.4% year on year while fixed broadband rose 12.9%. Market shares by subscription are CVTelecom 72%, Unitel T+ 27.3% and Starlink 0.64%, with Starlink up 0.20 percentage points on the quarter. The shift from mobile to fixed broadband is the movement in the quarter; the base holds no household or individual-use survey against which to read it.	MIXED subscriptions up on the quarter and down on the year
Central African Republic	Internet use is put at about 670,000 users, 12.0%, at October 2025, while the state's higher figures describe coverage rather than use. 2025-11-08 — an end-2025 measurement puts users at about 670,000, 12.0%, at October 2025, with 2.49m mobile subscriptions and 38.1% penetration at end-2025, against an earlier international estimate of 13.8% for 2024 and a publisher estimate of 15.5% in January 2025. The publisher reports fewer users against a larger population, so the earlier figure is withdrawn rather than showing a decline. Government statements of about 30% describe network coverage rather than use, and the two are routinely conflated. Every penetration figure held traces to a single international estimate redistributed by intermediaries, and the regulator publishes none — so there is no independent measurer of the most basic number in this report.	NO CHANGE
Chad	Internet users reached 5.6 million in 2024 against 4.8 million in 2023, the first published movement since the 2020 observatory. The regulator's 2024 market observatory, presented on 1 October 2025, gives 5.6 million internet users against 4.8 million in 2023, 14.8 million mobile subscribers up 9.2 per cent, and sector turnover above 237 billion FCFA (observatory). The prior published national figures are four years older: 14.2 per cent of the population using internet services and 10.0 per cent using SMS in 2020, mobile penetration 53.5 per cent, 8.7 million subscribers (observatory). A trade report of September 2025 carries a 2024 industry figure of 38.6 per cent mobile penetration and internet access below 15 per cent, which does not reconcile with the regulator's own series (audit).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Comoros	316,000 people were online at the end of 2025, 35.7 per cent of the population, up 1.9 per cent on the year. The regulator publishes no series. Its own homepage, current at the end of August 2026, still shows a single internet-penetration figure of 28 per cent which it dates to 2021, with no methodology and no affordability measure beside it. 2025-11 - an aggregator working from operator and industry datasets put 316,000 individuals online at the end of 2025, 35.7 per cent of the population, a rise of 5,781 users or 1.9 per cent year on year, against 760,000 cellular connections at 85.7 per cent of population. The gap between connections and users is the country's digital divide stated as a number. 2025-10 - a nationally representative survey of Comorian adults, fielded May to December 2024, was catalogued with an inaugural digital connectivity tracker; its Comoros figures are not in what the base holds.	NO CHANGE a first measured level with a rise of under two per cent behind it
Congo	Traffic ran at 90.904bn megabytes on FCFA 63.569bn of revenue in 2024, on the regulator's first market report. The 2024 market report records 90.904bn megabytes of mobile-internet traffic on FCFA 63.569bn of revenue. Against that, an industry country report puts unique mobile-internet use at about 19% against about 86% national coverage - a usage gap of some sixty-seven points between where service reaches and who takes it. No household survey, no fixed-broadband count and no gender or income disaggregation exists anywhere on this ledger to explain it.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	The ministry put active internet users at nearly 15 million and e-commerce users at about 2 million. 2026-07-13 - the ministry stated nearly 15m active internet users and about 2m e-commerce users, alongside connectivity reaching nearly one million homes. No earlier user count on the same definition is held, so what is stated is a level rather than a movement, and nothing on file says how the count is derived or as at what date. The base holds no regulator market statistics later than 2019, which is the gap under every subscriber and usage figure in this report.	MOVEMENT
Djibouti	65.30% of the population used the internet in 2024, the latest observation on file and one predating this period. The standing series puts internet use at 65.30% of the population in 2024, against 63.78% in 2022 and 59.93% in 2020. No observation dated inside this period has been published, so the figure at both ends of it is the same one. 2026-03-01 - in his general-policy speech the Prime Minister put mobile-internet penetration at 56.7%, up from 42.5% five years earlier. That is the government's own figure, on a different measure, with no published series behind it. Neither the regulator nor the operator publishes a subscription or usage series on file.	NO CHANGE the latest observation predates the period
DR Congo	Mobile-internet subscriptions stand at 36.98m, 33.9% penetration, with mobile-internet revenue of US$970.2m in 2025. The regional dataset records 36.98m mobile-internet subscriptions at 33.9% penetration and mobile-internet revenue of US$970.2m in 2025, nearly matching voice revenue. The earlier position the base holds is a Council of Ministers record of 30.79% mobile-internet access and under 0.02% fixed access, which is close enough to the 2025 figure to say the level is stated rather than a movement measured. Fixed access remains statistically absent, and no household or individual usage survey exists on this ledger.	MOVEMENT
Egypt	98.2 million people were online in October 2025, 82.7% of the population, with fixed broadband at 12.60 million subscriptions. The base held no internet-penetration figure at all before this. A commercial digital-adoption compilation puts 98.2 million internet users in October 2025, 82.7% of a population of 119 million, alongside 121 million mobile connections at 102% of population and 51.6 million social media users at 43.4%. It is a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it, and no regulator or ministry penetration figure is on record. The base held 11.51 million fixed broadband subscriptions for 2024. By November 2025 there were 12.60 million, up from 12.50 million in October, growing 8.98% annually, with mobile carrying 75.44% of internet access against 72.97% a year earlier. The same monthly bulletin records rising consumer complaints over data caps, upgrade fees and post-cap speed reduction. So subscriptions grow while the terms attached to them draw complaint, and no later monthly figure than November 2025 is held.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Equatorial Guinea	No national internet-use series exists; the statistical yearbook publishes administrative counts and no penetration figure. The eighth national yearbook carries 19,586 civil servants, 10,468 online visas approved and public debt at 33.3 per cent of output — administrative counts, not connectivity. The population it would be measured against is itself estimated: the 2025 compendium still projects population off the 2015 census. The fifth population census now has its legal basis and has not been taken.	NO CHANGE
Eritrea	About 27% of the population uses the internet, with fixed broadband subscriptions effectively negligible. A country profile carries the 2023 international telecommunication union figures: 85% of the population covered by a mobile-cellular network, 35% by at least third-generation service and 0% by at least fourth-generation, with fixed broadband subscriptions effectively negligible, and puts internet use at about 27% of the population on a separate estimate. Coverage and use are two different numbers here and the gap between them is the finding. Five-sixths of the population live inside a mobile-cellular signal, about a third inside one carrying third-generation data and none inside fourth-generation, while about a quarter use the internet at all. With no public submarine cable landing station, the operator's internet connectivity relies on geostationary satellite links, which is the ceiling under all three. These are first figures for this base with nothing earlier behind them, so no direction can be stated.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it
Eswatini	The regulator proposed raising the minimum service standard from 2 Mbps to 10 Mbps, and free statutory complaint adjudication runs on windows of one to six months by sector. The proposal was issued as a public notice in July 2026 (proposal). Adjudication is free under the 2013 communications Act, with windows of one month for post and courier, three for broadcasting and six for telecommunications; these are structural provisions of the Act rather than dated state (adjudication). A six-month window for a telecommunications complaint is long enough that the remedy is unlikely to reach the problem it was raised about, and no complaint volume or outcome series is published.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	Data and internet became the incumbent's largest revenue line in the year to June 2026, at 31.1% against mobile voice at 23.5%. It was the first financial year in which data and internet, not mobile voice, were the largest share of the incumbent's revenue (data overtakes voice). Total revenue was 215.8bn birr with operating profit of 92.9bn birr, on the operator's own unaudited figures (results). A streaming service and a zero-touch broadband product launched in February 2026 (new services). No independent measure of internet use is held: the base carries revenue mix and connection counts, not a survey of users.	MOVEMENT
Gabon	71.9 per cent of the population used the internet at the end of 2025, against 97 per cent national coverage and 1,253 villages left uncovered in 2024. An analyst compilation counts 1.87 million people using the internet at the end of 2025, a penetration rate of 71.9 per cent, up 39,000 or 2.1 per cent on October 2024, and 850,000 social media user identities, 32.6 per cent of the population. It is not an official statistic and its compiler warns against comparing across its own editions. The regulator's own reading is coverage rather than use: 97 per cent national telephony and internet coverage in 2024, stated as the best in central Africa, on more than two million subscriptions. Earlier the same year its president put 6.5 per cent of the population - 1,253 villages and about 117,622 people - outside mobile and internet coverage altogether. Coverage running 25 points ahead of use is the shape of the problem the universal service programme does not address: the villages are the smaller number. The one external series agrees on direction. A governance index scores internet and computers at 48.5 for 2023, 14th of 54 and up 23.3 points over the decade - the country's largest decade gain on any infrastructure measure.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gambia	1.30m internet users, 45.9 per cent on a commercial estimate; the statistics office publishes no penetration figure at all. The October 2025 estimate puts internet users at 1.30m, 45.9 per cent of the population, against 3.19m mobile connections. It is a commercial estimate, not an official series. The official series does not answer the question: the statistics office's 2024 communication statistics publish 3.48m mobile subscribers and no internet penetration figure. A microdata release on connectivity and financial inclusion in October 2025 supplies survey-based mobile ownership and internet use, which is a different instrument again.	NO CHANGE a first estimate with no comparable earlier figure
Ghana	37 per cent of the population used mobile internet in 2024 against near-total coverage, leaving a usage gap of 62 per cent and a coverage gap of 1 per cent. The gap is now measured rather than asserted. An industry measurement puts mobile internet use at 37 per cent of the population in 2024 against near-total network coverage, a usage gap of 62 per cent and a coverage gap of 1 per cent, against a 2015 position of 15 per cent connected, a 70 per cent usage gap and a 15 per cent coverage gap. Nine years of build-out closed the coverage gap almost entirely and the usage gap by eight points. The same body projects the usage gap at 46 per cent by 2029 if a named set of spectrum, infrastructure, device-affordability and skills reforms is adopted, against 55 per cent without them - a forecast by the party proposing the reforms. The last household survey was fielded in June 2019 and not repeated: 16.8 per cent of households had internet access and smartphone ownership ran at 58.4 per cent urban against 28.1 per cent rural. An unlimited 100 Mbit/s fibre package fell from GH¢987 to GH¢299 a month, extracted by ministerial pressure rather than by licensing change. Of 78 authorised internet and public-data providers, 42 are operational, the single rural one not among them.	MIXED coverage and price both moved the right way while the usage gap has closed slowly against near-total coverage
Guinea	The regulator counted 8.3 million internet subscriptions at end-June 2025, about 58 per cent of the population, against an international estimate of 33.3 per cent actual usage. The gap between the two numbers is the finding. The regulator reported 12.8 million mobile subscribers at 89.1 per cent penetration and 8.3 million internet subscriptions, while the international telecommunications union estimates 33.3 per cent internet usage and 82.2 per cent mobile penetration for 2024, with 3G coverage 81.3 per cent and 4G 77 per cent. Subscription counts overstate unique users because each active card is counted separately. Price is the named constraint: a 5 GB mobile data basket ran at 5.16 per cent of monthly income a head in 2025 against a 2 per cent affordability benchmark, about 6 per cent of neighbourhoods and districts lacked adequate mobile coverage in the second quarter of 2025, and one operator holds 76.2 per cent of the market. 2026-07-08 - the minister pressed that operator's chief executive to improve service quality, cut internet prices and extend coverage. The ministry separately reports mobile internet cost falling over 2025, on its own account and with no series behind it.	MOVEMENT
Guinea-Bissau	Internet use was last measured at 32.5% penetration, 723,000 users, with two-thirds of the population offline, before the window opened. 2025-03-03 — the last measurement the base holds puts internet users at 723,000 and penetration at 32.5%, leaving 67.5% of the population offline. The figure predates the twelve-month window and nothing fresher was published into it: no regulator return, no operator disclosure and no household survey covering internet use appears for Guinea-Bissau. The census reported under Censuses and surveys is the one national data collection inside the window, and its preliminary release carries no connectivity variable. So the direction of internet use over the window is unmeasured, at the point where the national backbone is still in design and satellite is the only service to have entered the market.	NO CHANGE
Kenya	Broadband subscriptions reached 52.85 million by March 2026 against 22.08 million in June 2020, and smartphone connections passed 50m for the first time. The regulator puts fixed internet subscriptions at 2.66 million, 4G population coverage at 73.4% and 5G at 3.04% (subscriptions). Smartphone connections stood at 48.7m in December 2025 and passed 50m in March 2026, with feature phones falling to 28.5m (devices). The statistics office's own chapter, a year behind, puts fixed and wireless internet subscriptions at 57.8m in 2024 (survey). The two series are not on the same basis and the base holds no reconciliation of them.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Lesotho	The ministry puts broadband coverage at 100 per cent against about 50 per cent regular internet use, a gap no programme on file addresses directly. The communications ministry stated the two figures at the United Nations Global Dialogue on AI Governance in July 2026 (statement). No earlier measurement is held, so the level is recorded and the direction is not. The one product launched into that gap is a fixed-mobile convergence service, live since July 2025 with nothing later on record (service).	NO CHANGE a first statement of the gap with no earlier figure behind it
Liberia	1.84m internet users at 32.4 per cent of the population in early 2025, with about 3.8m offline and no later national figure published. The reading is a commercial compilation rather than a regulator or statistics-office release (penetration). Eighteen months on, no regulator subscription series, household survey or statistics-office chapter has replaced it, so the country's connectivity is measured once a year by an outside compiler.	NO CHANGE
Libya	74 per cent of women use the internet and household internet stands at 92 per cent on the 2024-25 survey. The regulator's own dashboard puts 9.06m internet users and 15.4m mobile lines for 2024, a line count well above the population. The household survey is the better instrument and gives a different picture: 92 per cent of women using mobile phones, 74 per cent using the internet, household internet at 92 per cent. The international agency series carries 88 per cent internet use for 2022 and leaves every household and gender indicator unreported.	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	18.7 per cent of the population used the internet in the 2024 reference year, the most recent populated observation. The World Bank series records 18.7 per cent for the 2024 reference year, with 2025 unpopulated at a refresh of July 2026 (series). An operator launched a second mobile prefix in June 2026, citing a subscriber base approaching five million active monthly users (launch). The regulator published four-region 4G population coverage figures for the south in September 2025, showing uneven expansion (coverage). This is a first usage figure in the base, with no earlier observation to compare it against.	NO CHANGE
Malawi	80 per cent of Malawians are offline despite 87 per cent fourth-generation coverage, and no state measurement is held against the target of 80 per cent usage by 2026. The appraisal document put internet use at around 24 per 100 inhabitants on a 2022 baseline against a regional average of 28 (appraisal), and a separate account put access at about 20 per cent of citizens (access). The first usable current figure comes from the operators' trade association, which puts 80 per cent of the population offline against 87 per cent coverage, so the gap is usage rather than coverage, and estimates MWK 1.1 trillion of economic value and 490,000 jobs by 2030 from closing it (report). That is a modelled figure from an interested party whose policy asks include cutting the taxes its members pay. The presidential target of 80 per cent usage by 2026 is a target and not a measurement, with no baseline given (target). A national survey published in December 2025 puts seven in ten adults as never using the internet and gives a penetration rate of 27.7 per cent, the first non-industry current measurement the base holds (survey).	NO CHANGE four fifths of the population offline with no state measurement to set against the presidential target
Mauritania	Use is measured through the financial inclusion and connectivity survey and the regulator's market observatory, not by a national survey of individuals. Two published series bear on how many people use the internet. The 2025 financial inclusion survey carries connectivity alongside account ownership, and the telecommunications union's development dashboard carries the infrastructure and access series. The regulator publishes subscriptions through its market observatory and annual report. None of them is a national survey of individuals using the internet, and nothing in the window updates the position. What did move is supply: coverage extended to southern and south-eastern border zones in December 2025 and three satellite service providers selected in July 2026.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritius	Internet usage is reported annually alongside household penetration indicators, with no earlier figure held here. The 2025 ICT statistics carry usage and household penetration together (release), on the household indicator series the promotion agency publishes (indicators). Spectrum for mobile broadband was released in June 2026 (decision). A first observation with no earlier one on this ledger. What the base does not hold is a rural-urban split, a gender split, or usage by income.	NO CHANGE
Morocco	5G reached 3.2m subscribers by March 2026, 8.4 per cent of mobile-internet users, from 2.63m at the end of 2025. The regulator's figures, as reported by a measurement firm, give 3.2m 5G subscribers at March 2026 and 8.4 per cent of mobile-internet users, up from 2.63m and 38 per cent outdoor population coverage at the fourth quarter of 2025 (figures). Morocco is the only market in that comparison publishing a 5G subscriber count, which is itself the finding: the number exists here and nowhere else in the set.	MOVEMENT
Mozambique	A public broadband coverage portal went live in July 2026 letting anyone query operator coverage and speeds by location, with a public gap-reporting channel. The geospatial platform was built with commercial mapping software and publishes operator coverage and speeds queryable by location, with a channel for the public to report gaps (portal). No usage or gap-report figures have been published. The portal maps what is available rather than what is used, and no national internet penetration figure is published alongside it.	MOVEMENT
Namibia	Internet penetration was 62.2 per cent at January 2024, and the share of subscriber modules used for internet rose from 61 to 63 per cent in the third quarter of 2025. The ICT ministry's budget motivation puts penetration at 62.2 per cent and about 1.63 million users at January 2024, with 4G population coverage at 88.4 per cent against 85 per cent in 2022 — 98 and 99 per cent in the strongest urban regions against 49 per cent in Kunene (motivation). In the third quarter of 2025 active modules rose 3 per cent, mobile broadband usage 6 per cent and dongle and router subscriptions 30 per cent, while fixed-line internet subscriptions fell 2 per cent (quarterly). The universal service fund awarded the state fixed operator N$9,796,650 in April 2026 to deploy infrastructure at sites in underserved rural areas (fund). Rural households remain the gap: 16.2 per cent had mobile internet at November 2025 (rural).	MOVEMENT
Niger	The regulator publishes subscriptions and penetration quarterly but no measure of individuals using the internet. What is published is the supply side. The regulator's quarterly observatory carries mobile subscriptions and penetration, and its annual report the longer series. No survey of individuals using the internet is published for Niger at any date, so use has to be inferred from subscriptions, which count instruments rather than people. Two things bear on whether a subscription is used. Price: the telecommunications union's affordability figures for the mobile broadband basket. And quality: the regulator ran a control campaign on operator quality in July 2026 and issued a formal notice.	NO CHANGE
Nigeria	Fibre overtook fixed wireless for the first time with median fixed download at 34.47 Mbps, and rural medians rose on the regulator's crowdsourced measurement. Fibre-to-the-premises connections reached 265,000 by June 2026 from 84,141 at the end of 2025, the median fixed download speed rose 155 per cent to 34.47 Mbps, uploads nearly doubled and latency fell (mix); the gain sits at the bottom of the distribution, the slowest decile improving from 2.24 to 6.04 Mbps while the fastest moved only from 74.37 to 90.04 (mix). Rural median download rose from 15.0 to 16.4 Mbps and rural latency fell, on a test base growing from 266,970 to 543,123 (measurement); only 31.4 per cent of 5G-capable devices in the capital territory and 27.5 in Lagos actually use 5G, unchanged over six months, with a negative promoter score for every carrier (measurement, geospatial). One operator is live in five cities with six further states named for launch before the end of 2026 (footprint), and the largest operator is building toward a target of 8m fibre homes by 2028 (homes).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rwanda	An international body put mid-2025 internet penetration at 38 per cent with end-2025 projected at 42.6, and the most recent figure the base holds is a projection rather than a measurement. Penetration was measured at 38 per cent in mid-2025 and 42.6 per cent for end-2025 is a projection (penetration, masterclass). A household survey reported in June 2025 records the urban and rural internet use gap, and no successor survey is held (gap). Cost is the constraint both sources name, and neither carries a tariff series against which affordability could be tracked.	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	Broadband use is now carried in a financing operation's results framework at 146,000 people at December 2025, against regulator figures of 2.6 fixed and 43.3 mobile broadband per 100 inhabitants in 2023. The regulator's sector statistics for 2023 report 5,775 fixed broadband subscribers at a penetration rate of 2.6 per 100 inhabitants and 96,901 active mobile broadband accesses at 43.3 per 100, with installed international capacity of 35,840 Gb against 6,122 Gb used (statistics). The lender's policy operation sets people using broadband, inferred use, at 146,000 in December 2025 rising to a target of 172,000 by December 2028, with the female figure at 74,000 rising to 87,000 (operation). The two are not the same measure - subscriptions against inferred users - and no source reconciles them. What the window adds is a target the state has signed up to, which the regulator's series does not carry.	MOVEMENT
Senegal	The incumbent operator committed to one million new fibre sockets between 2026 and 2028, and a mobile latency measurement covering January to July 2026 is the first the base holds. The fibre commitment was set out with full-year 2025 results in April 2026 (results). The latency measurement covers January to July 2026 and no prior figure for the country is held, so it establishes a baseline rather than a direction (latency). Both figures are the operator's and a measurement firm's; no regulator series on quality of service is held for this unit.	MOVEMENT
Seychelles	87.8 per cent of the population used the internet in 2024, against 79.3 per cent in 2020; a tracker puts 16,800 people still offline. The World Bank and ITU series puts internet use at 87.818 per cent of the population in 2024, against 79.3 per cent in 2020 (series). A commercial tracker dated October 2025 puts 117,000 users, 87.4 per cent penetration and an estimated 16,800 people, or 12.6 per cent, still offline (tracker). The two are close but differently constructed. No national survey of who is offline and why is held, so the residual has a size and no description.	NO CHANGE
Sierra Leone	20.8 per cent online - 1.85 million users against 7.02 million offline - with the ministry's own account of the gap resting on coverage rather than use. The measured position is 1.85 million users against 7.02 million offline (usage). The regulator's 2019 annual report is the base's earliest published sector position (report). Since then the ministry has reported progress in coverage terms - a connectivity address in September 2025 (address) and a new network site at Mathonkra in Tonkolili district in October (site). Coverage is not usage, and the gap the ministry reports against is a usage gap. No series is published that would let a reader see the two move apart.	NO CHANGE
Somalia	Internet use and price were reported in October 2025, and the same account ranks the country 191st on online government services. The figures establish a baseline the base did not previously hold (use). The ranking on online government services sits alongside them in the same account, which is the useful pairing: connectivity and price are one problem, and what a connected person can actually do with government is another.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	The regulator puts household internet access at 82.1% and fixed internet at home at 17.4%, with fourth-generation coverage at 99.5%. 2026-03-31 — the sector report puts fourth-generation population coverage at 99.5% and fifth-generation at 58.0%, household internet access at 82.1% and fixed internet at home at 17.4%, with 4,377 of 21,878 government facilities connected as at October 2025, against the prior year's edition. Two of those figures are the finding. The gap between household access and fixed access at home says almost all use is mobile, which sets what a household can do with it. And a fifth of government facilities connected, in a country with near-universal mobile coverage, locates the problem in the state's own estate rather than in the network. It is the only regulator-published usage series on this ledger.	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	Internet users and penetration were reported by the regulator in July 2025, and no later national measurement is held. The figures are the regulator's own (figures). Thirteen months without a further measurement, in a period covering two tariff adjustments and a licence award, means the direction of use since then is unknown.	MOVEMENT
Sudan	14.9 million users at 28.7 per cent penetration in October 2025, up 407,000 year on year; the official series has no observation since 2017. The commercial estimate for October 2025 puts users at 14.9 million, up 407,000 or 2.8 per cent year on year, with penetration unchanged at 28.7 per cent (estimate). The official indicator series for Sudan was last updated on 13 July 2026 but its most recent non-null observation is 18.6 per cent for 2017, with every year since null (series). Usage is also being displaced rather than simply grown: during the April 2026 exam shutdowns one satellite provider reached 27 per cent of the internet-service market (report).	MOVEMENT
Tanzania	The state operator reset its fibre-to-the-home target to 2028 with about 200,000 of 280,000 financial-year connections delivered, and a second operator launched fibre service in the capital. The target slipped to 2028 with roughly seven-tenths of the year's connections delivered; the event date is not stated so the publication date stands, and subscriber ranks are regulator data to end-March 2026 (target). A second operator launched fibre-to-the-home and business service in the capital in August 2026 (launch).	MOVEMENT
Togo	The regulator now publishes annual quality-of-experience studies and a quarterly market observatory; daily data use a subscriber doubled in a year. At the first quarter of 2026 the observatory records 6,652,523 mobile data subscriptions, 75.90 per cent of population, 148,560 fixed data subscriptions at 1.69 per cent, and daily mobile data a subscriber up from 58 MB in the first quarter of 2025 to 115 MB. The mobile quality study for 2025 puts fourth-generation networks at close to 85 per cent of national mobile data traffic and the two operators first and second in the monetary union at 56.37 and 53.09 Mb/s downlink, while recording that web browsing and video streaming remain well short of expectations. The fixed study records fixed experience as below mobile. Penetration is subscriptions over population, not the share of individuals online.	MOVEMENT
Tunisia	76.5 per cent of literate people aged 10 and over used the internet at the 2024 census, against 40.4 per cent of households connected. The 2024 census puts internet use at 76.5 per cent of literate people aged 10 and over in the preceding three months — 77.4 per cent of women against 75.8 per cent of men, and 81.4 per cent urban against 61 per cent rural — while 40.4 per cent of households had a home connection. The regulator's third-quarter 2025 dashboard puts mobile-data penetration at 93.9 per cent and fixed household internet penetration at 51 per cent on denominators recalculated after the census, with fixed data traffic up from 1,555 to 1,989 petabytes year on year, and its full-year report has mobile-data subscriptions up 2.8 per cent to 10.9 million and fixed wireless consumption up 115 per cent. The two household figures — 40.4 per cent at the census and 51 per cent on the regulator's recalculated denominators — are eleven points apart on the same question, and nothing reconciles them.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Uganda	The census puts internet usage at 8.9 per cent, 2,809,327 people; the regulator says internet users exceed 15 million. 2025-09 - the 2024 census final report gives the sustainable development goal measure directly: 2,809,327 people used the internet, 8.9 per cent of the population, 10.6 per cent of men and 7.6 per cent of women, against mobile phone ownership of 43.3 per cent among people aged 10 and above. 2025-12 - the regulator's annual sector report states that mobile subscriptions have climbed past 40 million and internet users now exceed 15 million, while noting that rural communities lag. The two are not comparable and nothing in the base reconciles them: one counts people who said they used the internet, the other counts subscriptions or accounts. Taking either alone would state a position the evidence does not support, so both stand. This is the first census measurement on this definition, so no direction can be read from it.	NO CHANGE two counts four years and twelve million people apart with nothing reconciling them
Zambia	Internet adoption has been flat across two annual readings, and mobile connections count connections rather than people. The adoption reading is cited rather than absorbed, and has been flat across two annual compilations (users, prior). Mobile connections are connections, not people, and the regulator's separate administrative series counts subscriptions per hundred inhabitants (connections). A median fixed broadband download reading is likewise cited and not absorbed (speed). Every usage figure in this unit comes from a foreign compiler rather than the national regulator.	NO CHANGE
Zimbabwe	Internet penetration is active subscriptions divided by population rather than users, against a private tracker measuring 38.4 per cent of individuals, and wireless became the majority fixed technology. The regulator's rate divides active subscriptions by population and is not a measure of individual use (penetration, roadmap). Wireless became the majority fixed-broadband technology during the third quarter of 2025 (mix), and internet and data traffic rose on first-quarter 2026 figures given at a post-Cabinet briefing (traffic). A preferential buyer's credit for fixed broadband expansion ended in 2019; its title states US$98.6m and its deal record carries US$110,675,991, with no conversion basis on either (credit).	MOVEMENT

Mobile affordability

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	The regulator published a decision on the interconnection catalogue; no retail tariff or basket figure is held. The wholesale side is regulated and on the record: the regulator's bulletin of October 2025 carries a decision on the interconnection catalogue among at least a dozen decisions taken between June and October 2025, and the incumbent's fixed-network licence was renewed by executive decree with its annexed specification. The retail side is not. No mobile tariff, data-basket price, price index or affordability measure against income appears anywhere on this ledger, so what a subscriber pays cannot be stated.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it
Angola	The second operator's prepaid data prices, quotas and validity periods changed on 23 October 2025. It is the only retail price list the base holds. Affordability here is evidenced by a tariff sheet rather than by an index. The second mobile operator's published prepaid data schedule states that updated prices, quotas and validity periods took effect on 23 October 2025. No basket, income-share measure or price index for Angola appears anywhere on the base, so what a gigabyte costs relative to income cannot be stated. The context the price sits in is the regulator's own: 26,407,932 mobile subscriptions at 75.19 per cent penetration against 36.40 per cent broadband penetration. The gap between those two numbers is where affordability would show up if it were measured.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Benin	Data prices fell from 4,000 to 995 FCFA a gigabyte between 2016 and 2023, and no measurement since is held. Mobile data fell from 4,000 FCFA a gigabyte in 2016 to 995 in 2023. The series ends three years before the window opens, so the direction of prices across the window is unmeasured. No tariff schedule, basket measure or regulator price return appears anywhere on this ledger, and the second fifth-generation launch reported above came with no published pricing. The regional declaration Benin signed commits to 90% affordable broadband by 2030 without defining affordable, and no baseline against that commitment exists here.	NO CHANGE
Botswana	The incumbent's prepaid data tariffs were cut with regulator approval on a pricing study, and a device-financing facility has published no uptake in fifteen months. 2026-02-18 — the regulator approved revised prepaid tariffs with immediate effect on a May 2025 pricing study: 1.5GB a day for P10, 4GB a month for P65, 30GB over 30 days for P199 and 100GB over 30 days for P349. The other two operators revised earlier under the same study and their schedules are not held, so the market-wide effect cannot be stated. The device side has not moved. The country's first mobile device financing facility launched in May 2025 and has published no uptake, portfolio or default figure in the fifteen months since. A regulator-driven price cut with a published schedule is unusual in this report; what is missing is any measure of what it changed.	MOVEMENT
Burkina Faso	Consumer rules became enforceable after a court ruling, extending balance validity to 180 days, with the regulator reporting standard mobile-internet prices down 28 to 45%. 2025-12-02 — rules adopted in 2023 but suspended and unenforceable became enforceable after a court ruling: main-balance validity extended from 90 to 180 days, promotional credit usable across networks and a minimum one-month validity on data bundles, with the regulator reporting standard mobile-internet prices down 28 to 45%. What consumers had asked for was lower prices, which is not what the rules address; the price movement is reported alongside them rather than attributed to them. 2026 — an interconnection catalogue for 2026 to 2028 is in force with call-termination tariffs revised, known only through an operator's half-year filing. The catalogue itself is not held, so the wholesale terms underneath retail prices reach this base through the accounts of a party to them.	MOVEMENT
Burundi	Internet package tariffs have more than doubled since January 2025, in some cases tripling, on the consumer association's account. 2026-07-31 — the consumer association reported that internet package tariffs have more than doubled since January 2025, in some cases doubling or tripling, alongside degradation of service. The account is the association's own. No regulator tariff series, operator price schedule or basket measure appears anywhere on this ledger, so the direction is reported by the party least likely to understate it and there is nothing to test it against. Read beside it, the satellite alternative is also out of reach on cost, reported under satellite broadband, and the network people are paying more for is the one the regulator itself describes as degraded.	REGRESSED
Cameroon	The regulator publishes compared tariffs and regulates wholesale rather than retail prices; handset cost moved instead, through duty by device identifier and network blocking from 1 September 2026. The regulator's stated position is that in a structurally oligopolistic sector, regulation targets the wholesale market between operators to make cost components objective, fair, non-discriminatory and transparent — not retail prices. Its own observatory records that retail tariffs remain rigid despite falling interconnection costs, and the most recent published comparison is for the first half of 2023. What has changed is the cost of the handset. From 1 April 2026 importers must declare each device by its identifier through the customs platform and pay duties before network use, with an amnesty for devices already connected, the finance ministry stating the reform adds no new tax and automates an existing one. 2026-09-01 - deactivation of handsets on which duty has not been paid begins, under a communique signed by the finance minister on 20 August 2026. No affordability basket, price index or income-share figure is published against any of it.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Central African Republic	Satellite service costs about 136% of monthly income per head, at FCFA 33,000 a month plus tax with a kit at FCFA 240,000, against a 2% international threshold. 2026-03-16 — commercial service opened at FCFA 33,000 a month plus tax with a standard kit at FCFA 240,000, a monthly price of about 136% of monthly income per head against an international affordability threshold of 2%. The object advanced and affordability did not, and the state's response was to suspend non-homologated kits rather than to address price. That is the only published price of any kind on this ledger. No mobile tariff, data basket, handset price or regulator price schedule appears for the country at any date, so a service costing more than a month's income per head is the country's one affordability datapoint.	NO CHANGE
Chad	A 30 per cent tariff cut was ordered in December 2021 and never audited; the minister accepted high costs in 2025. The head of state instructed a 30 per cent cut across all internet offers on 29 December 2021, reported as reaching 60 to 78 per cent on some segments, against a target of moving the cost for a minimum-wage earner from 17.8 per cent of salary in 2020 into a band of 8 to 2 per cent (instruction). The ombudsman reported on 29 October 2025 that electronic communications should be treated as a social right, and the minister of state accepted high costs, insufficient service quality and weak market regulation (report). In June 2026 the telecommunications minister argued publicly for the restoration of unlimited satellite internet offers (position). No published tariff schedule or price basket for Chad is held.	NO CHANGE
Comoros	The entry fibre offer moved to KMF 30,000 a month at 850 GB, from KMF 32,500 at 800 GB. The basic fibre offer stood at KMF 32,500 a month for 800 GB, and is now KMF 30,000 a month at 850 GB with unlimited fixed-line calls, plus embedded subscriber-identity migration at KMF 5,000 and a new one at KMF 10,000. It is operator-announced, the source's own dateline is internally inconsistent and the date precision is flagged uncertain. No mobile tariff, basket or affordability measure exists anywhere on this ledger, so one incumbent's fixed offer is the whole of the price evidence for the country.	MOVEMENT
Congo	Backhaul spectrum fees run at about 5% of operators' total revenue against a sub-Saharan median of 0.5%. An industry country report puts mobile backhaul spectrum fees at about 5% of operators' total revenue against a sub-Saharan median of 0.5%, alongside delayed spectrum assignments, cross-border interference and technology-neutrality restrictions. Backhaul is the default rural link where fibre does not reach, so the premium falls hardest where coverage is weakest, and no regulatory response is on file. The only retail price the base holds is a weighted FCFA 0.70 a megabyte in 2024, with nothing later to compare it against.	NO CHANGE a first published price position with nothing earlier behind it
Cote d'Ivoire	Observed mean prices fell 39.9% for voice, 28.9% for SMS and 58.8% for mobile internet between 2020 and early 2025. The official series distinguishes wholesale interconnection caps, displayed retail tariffs and prices drawn from actual consumption including bonuses and promotions. On that last basis it runs from FCFA 10.06 a voice minute, 1.32 an SMS and 0.80 a megabyte in 2020 to FCFA 6.04, 0.94 and 0.33 by the first quarter of 2025 - falls of 39.9%, 28.9% and 58.8% - with wholesale interconnection rates down 77% for voice and 87% for SMS over the same period. The same page gives 2024 mobile penetration as 172.2% on 53,601,479 active SIM cards and mobile internet penetration as 93.7%. What is missing is the denominator affordability turns on: no basket cost as a share of income, and no distributional figure, appears anywhere on this ledger.	MOVEMENT
Djibouti	No national price figure is held; the first authorisation to a competing operator was granted in March 2026. This is a searched absence. The telecommunications union's annual reference publication introduces a data-only mobile broadband basket and reports a global median of 1.4% of income per head, with 130 of 205 economies inside the 2% benchmark; the country's own basket figure sits in the union's price database rather than in the report, and is not held here. What did move is the market. 2026-03-22 - the regulator authorised a new entrant to build and operate a national wired electronic-communications network, market internet access and data transmission, and access the incumbent's landing stations, the first such authorisation against a statutory monopoly. No tariff effect is on record.	MOVEMENT on market opening rather than on any published price

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
DR Congo	Bundle validity was cut without notice: 1GB at 1,500 francs fell from 48 hours to 24, and the 2GB bundle was replaced. Subscribers in Bukavu and the eastern provinces report that a 1GB bundle at 1,500 Congolese francs, formerly valid 48 hours, is now valid 24 hours, and a 2GB bundle at 2,000 francs valid 48 hours has been replaced by 1GB valid 72 hours at the same price. Both ends are subscribers' and resellers' accounts; no operator or regulator statement is on record and the changes are reported as unannounced. It is the only affordability evidence on this ledger, and it comes from the same eastern provinces where service has been cut outright for months at a time.	REGRESSED
Egypt	A new mobile package at EGP 5 replaces one at about EGP 13 while other packages rise 9 to 15%. 2026-05-06 - a new mobile package at EGP 5 replaces a lowest package of about EGP 13, and a fixed package at EGP 150 replaces one at EGP 210, while other packages rise 9 to 15 per cent including taxes. The cheapest entry point falls and the rest of the ladder goes up, which is a distributional change rather than a price cut, and the regulator frames it as digital inclusion. No data-basket price, no price index and no affordability measure against income appears anywhere on this ledger, so what the adjustment means for a typical subscriber cannot be stated. The regulator's consultation framework is the process behind decisions of this kind.	MIXED the cheapest entry package fell while the rest of the ladder rose
Equatorial Guinea	The state operator raised prepaid data volumes 50 per cent at held prices in August 2026, its top tier reaching 24GB for 15,000 CFA. Price last moved by agreement rather than regulation: the government and operators halved internet tariffs from 1 September 2022. In the window the movement was volume: a summer promotion raising data 50 per cent across all prepaid packages at held prices, the top tier at 24GB for 15,000 CFA. Upstream, the regulator updated the primary and secondary broadband capacity market regime by ministerial order in February 2026. No affordability ratio against income is published.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	An entry-level mobile broadband basket costs 85% of monthly income per head, against a 2% affordability benchmark (country tables). Country-table data on 2022 pricing records Eritrea's entry-level mobile broadband basket at 85% of monthly gross national income per head, against the international affordability benchmark of 2% (country tables). That is more than forty times the benchmark, and no later Eritrea-specific figure was located at the probe date, so the base cannot say whether it has moved since 2022. The level is stated and the direction is withheld, because there is nothing to compare it against. The operator's own published terms are the only prices the base holds directly: a fixed telephone line costs a one-time payment of 882 nakfa on top of a written request, an application form and a copy of the identity card, and prepaid mobile recharge is sold in denominations of 110 and 330 nakfa, recharged by a dialled code. No tariff per minute or per gigabyte is published.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it
Eswatini	The cost of data as a share of income per head sits above the international affordability threshold. The finding is stated in an August 2025 account and nothing has moved it since (affordability). It is the constraint under the usage gap recorded separately — mobile coverage substantially exceeds mobile-internet use — and no tariff instrument, subsidy or device-financing scheme appears anywhere in this ledger to address it.	NO CHANGE
Ethiopia	The second operator raised data prices by 20 to 82 percent from December 2025 (report) while a US$40 smartphone pilot named Ethiopia (pilot). Safaricom Ethiopia revised its data packages from 23 December 2025, raising prices by between 20 and 82 percent across most plans while cutting data volumes on several: the weekly 10GB bundle at 250 birr was reduced to 5.5GB, and the 100 birr weekly package to 2GB from 3GB (report). The operator cited operational and investment costs, the birr devaluation and prior below-cost pricing. Ethiopia was named one of six African countries for a 2026 pilot of entry-level 4G smartphones in the US$30-40 range by the handset affordability coalition (pilot). The most recent market assessment is from July 2025 (assessment); its affordability figures are not in the captured text, so the base holds no price-to-income measure against which to size the increase.	MIXED service prices rose sharply at the second operator while a device-affordability pilot was extended to Ethiopia

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gabon	Affordability is set through the annual finance law rather than by the regulator: the 2026 law carries the digital payment and communications measures, and the regulator approved infrastructure sharing to lower deployment costs. The finance law is the operative instrument reaching the retail cost of digital services: it requires transactions at or above FCFA 500,000 to be settled by bank transfer or electronic wallet, and taxpayers of the large and medium enterprise directorates to pay exclusively by electronic means, with penalties attached. Compulsion is not the same as affordability, and the law is annual. 2026-06-11 - the regulator approved a five-year passive infrastructure-sharing contract between the two mobile operators, its stated purpose mutualisation to avoid redundant deployment, lower deployment costs and extend coverage. No tariff basket, price index or income-share measure is published at any date, so neither the level nor the direction of retail prices can be stated. What is published is volume: 3.27m cellular connections against 1.87m internet users at the end of 2025.	MOVEMENT
Gambia	D75 per gigabyte from 1 January 2026, the regulated floor price ended and data rollover introduced. The final tariff order sets mobile data at D75 per gigabyte with effect from 1 January 2026, ends the price floor and introduces rollover of unused data. The ministerial directive to lift the floor was issued on 16 October 2025 with a cost-of-service study still pending, so the price was set before the cost basis for it was established. Roaming costs move separately: caps between The Gambia and Senegal with thirty days of free incoming calls start on 1 March 2026.	MOVEMENT
Ghana	An independent index puts the market among the ten cheapest in Africa for a one-gigabyte basket, and the regulator has opened a consultation on roaming wholesale rates. 2026-02-28 - an independent index for the fourth quarter of 2025 places the country among the ten cheapest African markets for a one-gigabyte monthly mobile data basket, attributing it to state-supported infrastructure rollout, infrastructure sharing and stronger competition, while cautioning that the results are converted to dollars and sensitive to exchange-rate movement. 2026-03-11 - the regulator opened a four-week consultation proposing a regulator-led wholesale-rate framework for national roaming to replace bilateral operator arrangements, following its significant-market-power declaration. The regulator's own quarterly bulletin is the primary domestic series, but the held capture stops before its average-tariff section, so no national tariff figure is on this ledger and the affordability position rests on the independent index.	MOVEMENT
Guinea	Mobile internet cost was reported down 25 per cent over 2025 in the ministry's sector review, with no baseline price published. The reduction is ministry-reported and carries no starting price, tariff basket or basis of comparison (sector review). No regulator tariff series, affordability index or income-share measure exists against which to read it, so the direction is stated and the level is not.	MOVEMENT on the ministry's own figure
Guinea-Bissau	No tariff or affordability figure is published; the universal access fund plan is the instrument aimed at the gap. The base holds no Guinean retail tariff, price basket or affordability ratio. The instrument that would address affordability is the universal access fund, which a legal review recommended restructuring in October 2025 and for which a 2026-2031 strategic and financing plan was delivered in May 2026. Neither publishes a price target.	NO CHANGE
Kenya	A bill proposing consumption-based internet billing drew warnings from two providers that per-megabyte metering would force deep packet inspection into their networks. They told Parliament it would hand subscriber-level usage to the regulator, raise consumer prices, break fixed-speed broadband pricing and conflict with data minimisation, and a jurists' commission warned the central store could be used to monitor activists, journalists and political opponents; the reporting establishes no precedent for the regime in any national market (submissions, assessment, warning). The Bill's own gazetted text runs to four clauses, of which one brings internet service providers inside the definition of telecommunication operator and another preserves existing licences until expiry; the only verification duty in it is the user's verification of an invoice, and the subscriber-verification duty reported from the commentaries is not in the text (the Bill).	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Lesotho	The regulator found against an operator over unnotified airtime restrictions and ordered them reversed; no price series is published. 2020-02 — a World Bank diagnostic is the base's fullest account of digital infrastructure and affordability. 2025-10-01 — an operator published promotional bundle terms. 2025-12-05 — the regulator found against an operator over airtime restrictions applied without notice and ordered them reversed. No basket price, income share or affordability index for Lesotho is held, which is what this indicator turns on.	MOVEMENT on enforcement rather than price
Liberia	The regulator's own series puts a 5GB basket at 12.1 per cent of monthly income in 2025, down from 13.6 per cent in 2023. The sector series holds the 5GB monthly basket flat at US$8 across 2023, 2024 and 2025 while average monthly income rose from US$59 to US$63 to US$66, giving affordability ratios of 13.6, 12.7 and 12.1 per cent against a 2 per cent benchmark. The whole of the improvement is income, not price. Tax works the other way: the April 2026 revenue notice raises the general services rate to 13 per cent from 1 May 2026 while holding telecommunications at 15 per cent. Roaming charges among Liberia, Ghana and Sierra Leone were removed in February 2026, with full implementation still to follow.	MOVEMENT on income growth alone
Libya	Operator tariffs run from 0.5 LYD for 50MB to 80 LYD for 80GB; no regulated price basket is published. The base holds no regulated tariff order and no affordability basket for Libya. What it holds is the retail cards: an operator's live tariffs from 0.5 LYD for 50MB over a day to 80 LYD for 80GB over thirty days. A competing unlimited daily plan caps heavy use at 10 dinars through the operator's app. Neither is set against income, and no regulator series measures the basket as a share of earnings.	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	Operators and the state agreed in December 2025 to cut mobile internet prices gradually, with excise relief conditioned on reinvestment in quality. The agreement ended a standoff between the state and the operators (agreement). No price schedule, reduction figure or implementation date was published with it, and no tariff basket or affordability measure for the country is held, so the base records that prices were agreed to fall and cannot say from what or to what.	MOVEMENT
Malawi	The minister called for scrapping the 10 per cent internet surtax and reviewing the 17.5 per cent smartphone value-added tax, targeting 30 per cent mobile internet usage by 2030. The call was made at a Lilongwe summit in August 2026, setting a target of raising mobile internet usage from 12.5 per cent to at least 30 per cent by 2030 (call). No budget measure, bill or instrument is on record: the treasury has published nothing and no timetable is given. It is a ministerial statement at a summit, and it is the only affordability position the base holds for the country.	MOVEMENT
Mali	About 1.5GB of mobile data in Bamako costs what buys 25GB in Dakar, and the market has one surviving independent provider. The comparison, published in August 2026, puts the ratio at roughly twenty-five to one and attributes it to weak market oversight, the duopoly of the two incumbent operators and the years since a new operator licence was issued (comparison). It is a press comparison rather than a tariff series, and neither the basket nor the date of the prices compared is stated. One independent internet service provider is reported surviving, buying wholesale transit at near-retail prices, which is the wholesale structure behind the retail figure (provider).	NO CHANGE a first published comparison with no earlier price series behind it
Mauritania	No price series is published. The regulator's market observatory is where one would appear; the statistics agency publishes a communication price index. No tariff basket, income-share measure or affordability index for Mauritania is held on this base. The two places a figure would come from are published and do not carry one: the regulator's market observatory and annual report, and the statistics agency's monthly bulletin, which carries a communication price index rather than a retail tariff. What the window did add is a cost imposed rather than a price charged: the 2026 finance law introduced a tax on electronic transactions. Affordability of connectivity and affordability of using it are moving in different directions, and only one of them is measured.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritius	A free monthly mobile data package for young people was added in June 2026 to the regulator's promotional tariff framework. The regulator issued a promotional tariff framework in August 2025 (directive). A free monthly mobile data package for young people is administered through the revenue authority (package). Usage and penetration are reported annually (statistics). Both instruments are interventions rather than measures: no price index, basket cost or affordability figure is held, so whether tariffs have moved cannot be read from the base.	MOVEMENT
Morocco	Mobile interconnection tariffs entered a transitional reduction in July 2026 and reach full symmetry in February 2027. The transitional phase runs from 1 July 2026 to 31 January 2027, with full symmetry from 1 February 2027 (phase). The record of it is the operator's own half-year filing; the regulator's decision text is not held, and no retail price, basket or affordability measure for the country is held at all.	MOVEMENT
Mozambique	A standard data package fell from 9.4 per cent of monthly income per head in 2022 to 2.67 per cent in March 2026, on the funder's own figures. The figures were released with the national coverage map and are the World Bank project's own; the basket behind the standard package is not defined in the record held (figures). A fall of that size in four years is the largest single improvement recorded for the country in this base, and it is the one measure here that a household would feel directly.	MOVEMENT
Namibia	The regulator's chief executive proposed tax relief on fourth-generation devices, against operator-reported tower utilisation close to half in one region. The proposal was made at a tower launch in Kunene; no fiscal instrument, budget line or ministerial response has been published, and the operator reported utilisation close to 50 per cent across about 74 enabled towers in the region (proposal). Device cost, not coverage, is what the proposal treats as the constraint, and the incumbent made the same argument a year later in asking for smartphone subsidies before the 2G and 3G switch-off.	NO CHANGE a regulator proposal with no fiscal instrument or ministerial response behind it
Niger	Operator promotions cut the effective price toward 143 FCFA a gigabyte, against a 2023 basket at 7.2% of income per person. An operator announced a night bundle of 3.5GB for 500 FCFA on 1 September 2026, usable between 23:00 and 06:00 and working out at about 143 FCFA a gigabyte, following its 200% data bonus on bundles activated from 1,000 FCFA in December 2025. Both are promotional and time-limited rather than regulated tariff changes, and cover one operator. The last measured position is older and far from the target: a 2GB data-only basket at 7.2% of gross national income per person a month in 2023, against the 2% affordability benchmark. No later basket measurement, and no regulated retail price, is on file.	MOVEMENT on operator promotional tariffs with no updated basket measurement behind them
Nigeria	Sub-US$100 smartphone shipments fell 34 per cent in a quarter with the African average price up US$41, and consumer cloud storage rose more than 50 per cent on some plans. A global memory-chip shortage turns device cost into a digital-divide variable in a market that imports almost every computer it sells: sub-US$100 shipments fell 34 per cent year on year in the second quarter of 2026, the continental average selling price rose US$41 to US$202, and the Nigerian market fell 11 per cent in the quarter as buyers delayed purchases (devices); the analyst's stated cause is artificial-intelligence data-centre demand for memory making US$75 devices unprofitable to build (devices, laptops). A single provider raised consumer cloud storage prices by more than 50 per cent on some plans, with Nigerian users facing increases of up to 52 per cent (storage); it is the only dated consumer cloud price the base holds (storage).	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rwanda	An infrastructure-sharing regulation was made in January 2026, while excise on mobile services stepped from 12 to 14 per cent in June. The regulation made on 27 January 2026 requires cost-based, non-discriminatory infrastructure sharing — a structural route to lower retail prices through less duplicated network investment (regulation). Against that, excise duty on mobile services stepped from 12 per cent in June 2025 to 14 per cent in June 2026, within an effective average tax rate on sector pre-tax profits put at 74 to 83 per cent (study) — an operators' trade association's own commissioned analysis. The regulator's published tariffs stand at RWF 40 a minute and RWF 10 or 5 per megabyte (report).	MIXED sharing mandated while excise rose
Sao Tome and Principe	The incumbent's published mobile tariffs run from 10 dobras for 24 hours to 330 dobras for 30 days, the largest bundle carrying 4,000 MB. The schedule lists four bundle families at 24-hour, 7-day and 30-day durations, the entry tier carrying no data allowance and the top tier 4,000 MB for 330 dobras (tariffs). No earlier schedule is held, so no direction can be stated. Nothing on file gives a price basket, an income comparison or a second operator's tariffs, so affordability in the sense the indicator asks about cannot be computed from what the base holds - only the prices themselves. The page is undated and the year is inferred from the capture.	NO CHANGE a first schedule with no earlier tariff held
Senegal	The mobile services price index fell 15.6% year on year while a seventeen-year handset import-tax exemption was reversed. The regulator's index was flat quarter on quarter in the second quarter of 2026 across all four operators and all nine consumption profiles, after successive falls of 5.3% and 10.2%, and down 15.6% year on year, driven principally by one operator at minus 24.5%. The fall is concentrated in the heavy-data profiles; two voice-heavy profiles recorded increases. It is an index, not a basket price, so it yields no franc amount and no share of income. The entry cost moved the other way: loi 2025-18 reverses the seventeen-year suspension of customs duties and taxes on imported fixed and mobile handsets, making them liable to import duties, taxes and value added tax, under a domestic resource mobilisation plan and to align with the regional common external tariff. One acts on the tariff, the other on the handset, and no affordability threshold or income comparison is stated for either.	MIXED the service price index fell 15.6% over the year while a handset tax exemption of seventeen years was reversed
Seychelles	The World Bank finds internet cost a barrier to inclusion; Cabinet reformed prepaid and e-SIM rules in March 2026. The lender's country partnership framework states that despite high mobile coverage and broadband subscription rates, the cost of internet remains a barrier to greater digital inclusivity (framework). In March 2026 Cabinet approved amendments to the prepaid mobile regulations allowing e-SIM sales through digital platforms, requiring annual operator audits and capping tourist and non-resident SIMs at 21 days (Cabinet); the changes modernise compliance rather than tariffs. Operators have competed on volume instead: entry-level unlimited fibre plans rose to a minimum 60 Mbps at no extra cost in April 2026 (upgrade). No tariff basket or price-per-gigabyte series for Seychelles is held.	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	Sierra Leone entered the regional free roaming agreement in February 2026, removing charges with Liberia and Ghana. The agreement entered in February 2026 removes roaming charges among Sierra Leone, Liberia and Ghana, with the regulator stressing that full implementation still had to follow. It is a cross-border price, not a domestic one: nothing in the base publishes a Sierra Leonean retail tariff or an affordability ratio against income.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	Average mobile data cost fell from USD 5.75 to USD 5.10 between 2023 and 2024, and an operator launched cheaper tiered bundles in April 2026. The regulator's price basket, built on the international methodology, records average mobile data cost falling 11.3 per cent from USD 5.75 in 2023 to USD 5.10 in 2024, with one gigabyte of residential mobile broadband around USD 5.65 at purchasing-power parity (report). An operator expanded tiered low-cost bundles — internet-only, calls-only and combined — reachable by short code in April 2026 (launch). Affordability has two halves and the handset is the other: a financing scheme launched in May 2026 to put devices in hands without a bank account or credit record (programme).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	Unused bundles must roll over from January 2027, while wired internet rose 3.5% and wireless 4.1% in the first half of 2026, both ahead of inflation. 2026-01-23 — amendment regulations were gazetted requiring unused data bundles to roll over automatically and free of charge at least once, excluding bundles of seven days or less and uncapped, free and promotional bundles, with depletion alerts at 50%, 80% and 100%. They come into force on 23 January 2027. Two operators have filed for review, and the filing date and case number are unestablished. On devices the two forces run opposite ways. The minister credits the April 2025 excise removal with 1.1m additional entry-level units; against that, African sub-$100 smartphone shipments fell 34% year on year in the second quarter of 2026 and the continental average selling price rose $41 to $202, attributed to memory and semiconductor demand. A tax cut and a component-cost rise are working on the same price, and the base holds no South-Africa-specific unit or price series to net them against. 2026-09-07 - wired internet rose 3.5% and wireless 4.1% over the first half of 2026, against cumulative headline inflation of 3.8%, reversing six years in which both ran well below it - 18.6% and 6.4% against 36% since January 2020.	MIXED a data-rollover regulation gazetted and under legal challenge while internet prices moved above inflation for the first time in six years
South Sudan	Three tariff adjustments on exchange-rate grounds brought Parliament to summon the information minister, after an operator cut tariffs 25 per cent in December 2025. The adjustments ran through 2026 in three phases and no regulator determination, tariff schedule or operator justification is published; Parliament moved to summon the minister on 21 August 2026 (summons, phase three, phase two, second, operator, first). An operator cut tariffs by 25 per cent in December 2025 with the ministry pressing for more (cut), and the revised rates after the adjustments are unpublished (price, editorial). So the direction is a cut followed by three rises, none of which can be quantified from anything published.	REGRESSED
Sudan	One operator raised bundle and call prices in September 2025 and the other reset its schedule in January 2026; prices have moved again since. The first increase took effect on 6 September 2025, covering daily, weekly and monthly internet bundles and local call minutes, on grounds of higher operating costs (announcement). The second operator's schedule as at 8 January 2026 ran from SDG 1,100 for 100MB a day to SDG 110,000 for 500GB a month (schedule). Its own current price list differs again, so the schedule moved after that report (price list). No affordability measure against income is held, so the direction is clear and the burden is not.	REGRESSED
Tanzania	Bundle data fell 2 per cent while voice rose up to 14 per cent, on 42.5 per cent mobile broadband penetration. In the quarter to September 2025 industry-average bundle data tariffs fell 2.0 per cent from 2.12 to 2.08 shillings a megabyte while bundle voice tariffs rose, on-net by 14.2 per cent and off-net by 4.7 per cent. The regulator's report for the quarter to March 2026 puts basic voice at 29 shillings a minute and bundle data at 9.35 shillings a megabyte, with mobile broadband penetration at 42.5 per cent and smartphone penetration at 32.83 per cent. An operator and vendor device-financing offer put a 5G router at 80,000 shillings upfront and 80,000 a month for twelve months with unlimited internet up to 10 Mbps. The two tariff series are quoted on different bases and the regulator publishes no reconciliation between them.	MIXED data tariffs fell while voice tariffs rose
Togo	A regulator's decision of 19 February 2026 made the byte the sole billing unit and carried over unused bundle volumes. The decision fixes principles of transparency, non-discrimination and fairness for permanent and promotional mobile offers and takes effect on signature. Its announced content carries over unused voice and data volumes for 10 or 30 days by validity, mandates the byte as the sole billing unit so billed volume matches consumed volume, and extends inactivity before deactivation from three months to six. The decision is issued unilaterally by the regulator's director-general; the announcement's framing of it as jointly agreed with operators and consumer associations is the announcement's, not the instrument's. Prices themselves have no later published comparison than April 2023, when entry-level bundles still cost more than six times the top-range rate a gigabyte, the widest such gap in the monetary union.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tunisia	The regulator published an affordability report on international data in July 2026, cited as a reference measurement rather than absorbed. It is cited as a reference measurement, not absorbed as country state (report). A regulator publishing an affordability comparison is the kind of measurement most units in this frame lack entirely, and this base holds the fact of it rather than its figures.	MOVEMENT
Uganda	A device-tax paper was stated ready for cabinet, and average monthly consumer data spend rose on volumes that moved the implied per-gigabyte cost the other way. The regulator proposed major telecom tax cuts and a device-tax paper was stated ready for cabinet in August 2026; the study itself is not held (paper, cuts). The two ends of the spend series are on different consumption volumes, so the implied per-gigabyte cost moved the other way; the reporting outlet's own per-gigabyte derivation is not the regulator's figure (spend). A regional dataset states a mobile data price printed in dollars with no exchange-rate or conversion basis (price), and buy-now-pay-later device financing is reported by a trade analysis with no default, repossession or total-cost-of-credit figure published (financing).	MOVEMENT
Zambia	The regulator's 2025 sector report carries its own subscription and affordability figures, and the mobile money levy schedule was revised. An external country diagnostic published Zambia-specific prepaid one-gigabyte and voice basket prices — the base's earlier affordability position, from a foreign tool rather than a domestic series. 2026-03 — the regulator's 2025 ICT and postal sector market performance report gave its own current mobile subscription and affordability figures, which is the more durable source. 2025-12-30 — an Act revised the person-to-person mobile money transfer levy schedule, effective 1 January 2026. A transfer levy is an affordability question for the poorest users of the payment system, and no assessment of its incidence accompanies it.	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	An uncapped 500 Mbps fibre package at US$99 came out of a price war, while satellite subscriptions grew against a rural population 76 per cent of whom live below the poverty line. The package prices are the operators' own, quoted in United States dollars (package, wireless). Satellite subscriptions grew in scale only; affordability is unchanged against a rural population three-quarters of whom live below the poverty line (affordability, silence). A media institute's review of internet affordability against income was published in August 2026 on regulator data; it is a review rather than a household survey, and the penetration figure it uses counts active subscriptions (review).	MOVEMENT

National fibre backbone

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	3.4m of over 7m fixed-internet subscribers are on fibre, with copper replacement targeted for end-2026 or early 2027. The copper phase-out was announced in May 2025 on a 2027 target. By May 2026 there were over 7m fixed-internet subscribers of which over 3.4m on fibre, and over 51m mobile subscribers, with copper replacement targeted for end-2026 or early 2027, after 3m fibre-to-the-home households in February and a claim of continental leadership on that measure. The 400G optical backbone was commissioned in February 2025 and no capacity update has followed, and an Italy-Algeria submarine cable is at memorandum stage only, with no build contract, route or landing date.	MOVEMENT
Angola	Five official statements of fibre length run non-monotonic between 20,000 km and 30,000 km, and the base asserts no current national figure. The measurement is the finding. Official statements put the terrestrial network at 22,000 km in 2023, 20,000 in October 2025, 30,000 in November 2025, 22,000 in April 2026 and 28,000 in June 2026. The series is not monotonic and no definition accompanies any of the figures, so the base asserts no current national length. The regulator's annual statistical report that would settle it was dropped as unobtainable. The build behind the figures is equally opaque. The national broadband network was financed by a specific loan agreement of about US$249m signed in October 2023 and remains active with no delivery milestone published at either end. A domestic submarine cable to interlink the coastal cities and connect a transport corridor to an international system was stated as in preparation in March 2026, with no route, cost, financier or date.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Benin	More than 3,000 km of fibre underpins the service estate, cited as a foundation of the 2031 strategy and unchanged in the window. More than 3,000 km of fibre is cited as underpinning the service estate and as a foundation of the 2031 strategy. The figure is a strategy citation rather than an operator or regulator return, and the same figure stood at the start of the window. No route map, capacity, utilisation or extension programme is published, and no second measurement exists to read it against. The regional financing reported under development-partner project financing carries a broadband pillar, and nothing yet states what of it lands on this backbone.	NO CHANGE
Botswana	About 16,000 km of fibre is stated laid, linking four neighbours, and a P43m local-access project connected three villages and 191 customers. 2026-03-09 — the minister put the network at about 16,000 km of fibre laid, linking South Africa, Namibia, Zimbabwe and Zambia, a statement with no published register behind it. 2026-08-16 — a P43m local-access programme completed, extending fibre to three villages and connecting 191 customers with 210 construction jobs created, by an operator reporting P376m revenue and 99.7% availability across the backbone, confirmed in a third account. Against those figures, a Village Connectivity Project is stated as running with no site count, target, budget or completion date published: the state names the programme and publishes no figure against it, while the wholesale operator publishes down to the customer.	MOVEMENT
Burkina Faso	More than 11,292 km is reported deployed with 270 km more programmed, and the wholesale price of a 10 Gb service fell from about 90m to about 35m FCFA a month. 2025-12-30 — more than 11,292 km is reported deployed with 270 km more programmed for 2026. No earlier cumulative figure is on file, so the increment is not derivable, and the figure does not reconcile with the other lengths the base carries. 2026-08-18 — the operating company's director general puts the wholesale price of a 10 Gb service at about 35 million FCFA a month against about 90 million in 2023, on three years running the state-built backbone. The figures are his own in an interview, no published tariff schedule is held, and the 3,000 km he describes does not reconcile with the 307 km first phase in service at 1,600 Gbit/s, itself the first stage of a stated EUR 175m and 5,740 km programme with no phase-two status on file. The other completed build is dual-purpose: 650 km of backbone plus 150 km of city links, 900 surveillance cameras and 300 video-surveillance sites on a Chinese concessional loan of RMB 560m, reported complete in August 2025 on two records that disagree about completion.	MOVEMENT
Burundi	1,750 km on the national backbone covers all provinces, with the regulator stating the national territory is now covered by fibre. Regulator statistics as at 31 December 2024 give fibre deployment by infrastructure operator: 1,750 km on the national backbone covering all provinces, 350 km of metropolitan network in the capital and 3,400 km on a third operator's network, and state that the national territory is now covered by fibre optic. 2026-04 — a presidential decree appointed a new director general of the mixed-economy company holding the backbone concession, and a second decree four days later named the administrators representing the state on its board. Governance moved; no traffic, utilisation or wholesale-price figure for the backbone is published, so what the fibre carries cannot be read from the base.	MOVEMENT
Cameroon	The backbone is reported at over 15,000 km, and a fourth phase of about FCFA 108.4bn was authorised by decree. The base held about 12,000 km terrestrial plus about 812 km overhead on 2024 reference-year figures, and the backbone is now reported at over 15,000 km. The two figures are not reconciled to a single primary and may rest on different measurement bases. 2026-03-06 - a decree authorised signature of CNY 1,350,963,161, about FCFA 108.4bn, for a further 4,000 km, a national data centre and regional links to Chad, the Central African Republic and Nigeria. The loan is not confirmed signed and the executing contractor is not confirmed.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cape Verde	The inter-island backbone sits under a concession requiring an autonomous wholesale division to manage it, and the State guaranteed a EUR 37 million loan to renew the inter-island cable in April 2026. The concession contract held by the incumbent operator requires an autonomous wholesale division to manage the inter-island fibre-optic backbone network and the international hub, with provision for later separation into wholesale and retail companies, the regulator and the operator both heard before adoption. No later instrument effecting that separation is held. 2026-04-20 - the State guaranteed up to EUR 37 million of an investment-bank loan to the operator in which it holds 82 per cent, to underwrite modernisation of critical telecommunications infrastructure, stating the purpose as renewal of the inter-island submarine cable and reinforcement of international connectivity, and that the guarantee is not direct public financing and carries no charge on the budget. No length, route or capacity figure for the backbone is published at any date, so the network being renewed cannot be sized.	MOVEMENT
Central African Republic	The backbone holds 935 km in service and gained nothing through the window, against a 12,000 km commitment stated by the minister. 935 km of terrestrial and sub-fluvial fibre is in service on the Bangui-Douala corridor with spurs to Cameroon and Congo, and no new kilometrage, commissioning or route was added through the window. The minister's claim of about 1,200 km in July 2025 is unverified and the development bank is the announcer of record for the 935 km. The 2026 estimates appropriate FCFA 2,000,000 to connect prefecture capitals to Bangui over it. 2026-02-02 — against that, the minister stated a 12,000 km fibre commitment at the ministry's orientations ceremony, with no contract, financing, route, phasing or timetable held and no progress in the six months since. The figure is roughly ten times the backbone built to date and reaches this base through a speech. A two-million-franc line to connect the prefectures and a twelve-thousand-kilometre announcement are the two ends of the same year's policy.	NO CHANGE
Chad	A seven-day ultimatum to the two mobile operators to connect to the national backbone was not complied with and no sanction was applied, and the trans-Saharan section is 60 per cent complete. The ultimatum followed a ministerial meeting; the state cited 1,275 km of fibre deployed, a figure no source reconciles with the project's own 1,200 km target, and no sanction was ever recorded as applied (ultimatum, order, link). The state connectivity programme's first phase was inaugurated at Sarh in January 2026; its 2020 specification of 2,000 km of fibre and 200 masts across twelve regions has never been restated and no delivery is reported against any figure (programme, phase). The trans-Saharan section was reported 60 per cent complete on EUR 29m of European financing, with no completion date, operator or route detail on file (section, delays). A twenty-year border-to-border concession has made no progress (concession).	STALLED
Comoros	A connectivity project reached readiness-stage funding talks in August 2026; the 2018 supplier loan has no delivered site count. 2026-08-10 - two lenders told the finance ministry they are ready to fund feasibility studies as a grant for a project carried by the digital agency covering data-centre studies and inter-island connectivity. No commitment amount, study contract or timetable is stated, so it is readiness-stage discussion. The standing position is a CNY 567,000,000 concessional loan signed in December 2018 at thirty-year maturity funding a US$81m supplier contract for fibre extension to fifty-seven sites, with no site count delivered, no completion status and no repayment position held at either end. It is still the largest tracked deal in the base for this country.	NO CHANGE
Congo	The backbone's first three phases were contributed in kind to the state operator at FCFA 143,878,429,945, staged to prepare a listing. Earlier phases were held by the operator as usufruct with no formal contribution and no capital entry. A council of ministers decree contributed assets valued at FCFA 143,878,429,945 in kind against a capital increase, raising share capital to FCFA 157,297,453,418 and absorbing accumulated losses of just over FCFA 20bn, staged explicitly to prepare a listing, recorded in the council of 6 May 2026. The backbone whose outages the regulator's own enforcement file blames for northern coverage failures is the asset being readied for market. A co-regulation accord on shared fibre and pylon infrastructure, announced as imminent in March 2025, has no signature, text or implementation sixteen months on.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cote d'Ivoire	Deployed fibre is put at about 38,000 km, of which over 6,600 km is state backbone, against 30,303 km earlier in the window. The base held 30,303 km deployed nationally at the window's opening. 2026-07-13 - the ministry put deployment at about 38,000 km with connectivity reaching nearly one million homes, and the state broadband backbone at over 6,600 km. A third figure of over 33,000 km for 2024 is in tension with the 2025 count, and all of them are the ministry's or the agency's own. 2025-12-17 - the first national assises on protecting network infrastructure convened operators, infrastructure managers and the regulator after 665 acts of theft and vandalism nationally between January and October 2025; no protection instrument has been published since. 2026-08-13 - an operator and its vendor completed a proof of concept in Abidjan detecting vibrations around fibre ducts and classifying them to flag third-party excavation before a cut happens, on a vendor-issued account with no commercial deployment stated.	MOVEMENT
Djibouti	A binding agreement for a 2,800 km terrestrial corridor to Addis Ababa and Port Sudan was signed on 4 February 2026, from a memorandum only. The corridor stood at a memorandum of understanding in December 2024. 2026-02-04 - a binding agreement was signed in Djibouti covering about 2,800 km, 144 fibre pairs and about 14 ms latency, reported across the trade press. No service date is published, and the route and latency figures are the three operators' own. Domestically, the fibre programme moved from the Ali-Sabieh regional hospital connected and over 200 km deployed in June 2025 to a school, sub-prefecture and clinic at Damerjog connected in October 2025, with a stakeholder and grievance workshop covering the capital, Balbala and the five interior regions.	MOVEMENT
DR Congo	7,000 km of backbone is deployed against a target of more than 18,500 km, leaving 11,500 km outstanding to 2030. 2026-08-03 - the 95th ordinary Council meeting was told 7,000 km had been deployed against a target of more than 18,500 km, leaving 11,500 km outstanding, tied to connecting 145 territories by 2030. The minister cites budget constraints and a low disbursement rate on external financing, and the remaining distance over the 2030 horizon implies about 2,900 km a year against about 7,000 km delivered in the programme's first year. 2026-07 - a memorandum was signed with a Chinese supplier for about 2,100 km along and beside the Congo River at a stated US$1.5bn, more than US$400m of it required for the first phase, with no financing close, contract or works. Both figures are company-reported.	MOVEMENT
Egypt	The incumbent launched in-home fibre-to-the-room commercially with a vendor, stated as a first for the country. The service did not exist at the window's opening. 2026-05-24 - the incumbent's consumer brand launched in-home fibre-to-the-room commercially with a vendor, presented as a first for the country. No coverage, subscriber, tariff or contract-value figure is stated. It is the only fixed-network product launch on this ledger, against a rural fibre programme that has reached about five million lines and a fixed base of about 12.6 million subscriptions - so what share of the network it touches is not established.	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	The four-ring backbone may be joined by the electricity utility's 2,000km grid fibre network. The minister's own account puts the backbone at four rings and an international gateway with over US$30m invested. A second national network exists and is unused for telecommunications: the electricity utility is studying whether to lease its 2,000km grid fibre network to operators, on a vendor study. International capacity may also grow — a study backs a Medusa cable landfall at Bome near Bata at EUR 20-60m, with service targeted for 2029-2030.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	The ministry reports about 73km of new cable laid and landline plant renovated in six towns; no independent measure of the backbone exists. 2026-05-19 — the minister responsible for communications reported 184 towers installed, about 73km of new cable laid, and landline plant renovated in six named towns and at the Naval Force Base, against a claimed cumulative investment above 35 billion Nakfa. The figures are the ministry's own, carried by state media, and nothing on the ledger tests them: no operator disclosure, no regulator return and no third-party measurement of the network appears for Eritrea in the window. EriTel remains the sole operator.	MOVEMENT on the ministry's own figures

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eswatini	International capacity rose from 47 to 72 Gbps, above target, and 1,031 public institutions are targeted for connection under the digital project. The capacity increase was reported in February 2026 as above target (capacity, rollout). The institution target was stated at the project's change-management workshop (institutions). A landlocked country raising international capacity by half in a reporting period is a real gain; it is also why the satellite gateway recorded separately is framed as reducing dependence on cross-border fibre.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	The second operator began building fibre from Afdera to Mekelle in August 2025, the only backbone construction the base holds. Construction on that route started in August 2025 and is the only record of national fibre being built by anyone other than the incumbent (fibre deployment). No route length, capacity, cost or completion date is published, and the base holds no figure at all for the national backbone's route kilometres, its utilisation or its redundancy.	MOVEMENT
Gabon	2,000 km of backbone is deployed, with 88 per cent forest cover cited as the physical limit on extending it further. The figure is ministry-stated at a satellite seminar in July 2026 rather than a regulator or operator return, and extension works are said to be under way (backbone). On access, the incumbent announced nine new fibre-to-the-home localities for 2025 on top of eight opened in 2024, and the base holds a plan and never a completion (access programme). The first technology-neutral fixed authorisation was signed with the regulator in January 2025 carrying no build obligation or coverage target, and nothing is on record of what has been built under it since (fixed authorisation).	NO CHANGE
Gambia	A US$50m partnership signed in January 2026 would take the backbone from 40 Gbps to 800 Gbps, on a network still carrying a 2017 concessional loan. No completion date or milestone schedule is published for the upgrade (partnership). The existing network was built under a US$25.9m concessional loan repayable by the state operator, with a servicing history of arrears cleared in June 2020 and the loan collateralised against a minimum escrow balance accessible to the lender (loan); no statement of network condition, utilisation or debt position has followed since (loan).	MOVEMENT
Ghana	Fibre cuts are projected at 8,578 nationwide in 2026, 4,289 of them already in the first half, at roughly US$2,045 a repair. The 2022 peak was 10,034 cuts costing US$17.4m (repairs, backbone under strain). One operator recorded sabotage affecting 157 sites (sabotage). A dig-once policy drafted with the roads ministry is claimed to cut fibre rollout cost by up to 60 per cent (dig once). 2026-09-07 - the minister's own account puts 8,578 cuts projected nationwide for 2026, 4,289 already recorded in the first half, at roughly US$2,045 per repair and more than US$20m spent on repairs in 2025, with major corridors averaging 72 cuts a month and uncoordinated excavation under the government's own road programme accounting for about half of road-related cuts. The 2026 number is a projection, not an outturn. The dig-once answer to it has slipped: a joint Cabinet memorandum with the roads ministry now awaits Cabinet, the third-quarter 2026 implementation target having passed with no instrument or commencement on record. A US agency funded a feasibility study on 9 September 2026 for open-access fibre along northern electricity lines spanning over 60 per cent of the country (study); no grant value is stated.	REGRESSED
Guinea	The backbone's first loop went from 200 to 400 Gb/s on 20 May 2026, with 600 Gb/s targeted by year end. SOGEB announced on 20 May 2026 that the first loop of the national fibre backbone had been raised from 200 Gb/s to 400 Gb/s with Huawei's technical support, the second upgrade in eighteen months after December 2024's step from 50 Gb/s to 200 Gb/s — a cumulative 700% increase — with both partners targeting 600 Gb/s across the whole infrastructure by the end of the year. The same account carries the regulator's traffic series, mobile internet traffic rising from 23.98 million GB in the second quarter of 2021 to 118.86 million GB in the second quarter of 2025. No utilisation figure against the upgraded capacity is held.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Guinea-Bissau	The WARDIP-GB backbone reached its environmental and social safeguards study in May 2026, on a 2,877 km, 56-node design not yet built. The country has no national fibre backbone. The design for one specifies 2,877 km over 56 nodes in four phases, targeting coverage of more than 99% of the population and operation by a private wholesale operator under exclusive licence; that specification is itself undated and carried at year precision. 2026-05-21 — the environmental and social impact study was published, which is the movement in the window: the project passes from design toward implementation procurement. The starting position was thinner. In August 2025 the country was seeking deployment experience from Chad with no fixed design published, after the programme's launch in April 2025. No construction contract, no selected wholesale operator and no built phase appears on the ledger.	MOVEMENT
Kenya	A cross-border terrestrial link with Tanzania was launched in July 2026, and two coastal and regional routes were announced in September 2026. It was delivered by the information technology authority with the Tanzanian state operator at two border points; no capacity, cost or route length is stated (link). A 2,000-kilometre Paratus terrestrial route from Goma to Mombasa via Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi was announced live and carrying traffic on 9 September 2026, giving eastern DRC access to subsea capacity at the Kenyan coast (route). A 500km LuLu Coastal Cable System linking five landing points from Mombasa to Lamu was presented on 9 September 2026, pairing a seabed cable with a parallel protected terrestrial route and targeting ready-for-service in the second quarter of 2028 subject to contract execution (cable); no project value, financing structure or regulatory approval is stated. It is the only completed backbone build in the base with a date on it, against a national target of 100,000km measured at about 2,193km delivered.	MOVEMENT
Lesotho	A metropolitan fibre network has a completed feasibility study and no construction reported; a 96km Roma to Thaba-Tseka stretch was under way in 2025. The budget speech of February 2025 recorded the feasibility study for the Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network as completed, laying groundwork for high-speed broadband across the major towns, with construction not reported (feasibility). The same speech recorded a 96km fibre stretch from Roma to Thaba-Tseka under way and 17 base tower stations operational (budget speech). Eighteen months on, no completion, route map or capacity figure has been published for either.	MOVEMENT
Liberia	The domestic backbone is reported extending south-east from one coastal city toward five counties, with no route map or kilometre figure. The line is reported reaching a border town from the capital, with private firms extending it (extension, earlier account). No completion date is published, and the base holds no national kilometre figure for the backbone at any date.	MOVEMENT
Libya	A flood severed the Ghat to Tahala fibre link on 27 May 2026; 11 of 12 sites were back within days, most on VSAT backup. The link was cut by flooding on 27 May 2026 and restored to 11 of the 12 sites it serves, 91.7 per cent, with most running on VSAT backup rather than on fibre (restoration). The base holds no route map, no capacity figure and no statement of when full fibre service returned, so the condition of the backbone after the cut cannot be established beyond the count of sites.	REGRESSED restored to eleven of twelve sites after a flood cut, most of them on satellite backup
Madagascar	A 558 km Antananarivo to Mahajanga backbone entered service in December 2025, built in eight months by the country's third fibre operator. The link was inaugurated in December 2025 after eight months' construction (backbone). It is the base's only national fibre construction record. No route map, capacity figure, wholesale price or measure of the pre-existing backbone is held, so the addition can be recorded and the total cannot.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Malawi	Two concessional loans financed the fibre backbone with no route length or operating status published, and procurement for more than 90 towers is advancing against a requirement above 1,000. Phase one was financed by a concessional loan of CNY 155,432,330 committed in 2016 (phase one) and phase two by CNY 693,000,000 at 1 per cent over twenty years, on-lent to the electricity utility with CNY 299,286,770 drawn as at June 2023 (phase two). The base holds the two loan records and no statement of route kilometres, completion, operator or current operating status. Tower procurement for more than 90 towers is being advanced against a project commitment of around 100, while a study cited at the same meeting puts the requirement for nationwide coverage above 1,000 towers (towers, project). A separate commercial loan covering 136 tower installations and last-mile fibre has no progress report, disbursement figure or completion statement on file (loan).	MOVEMENT
Mali	Retail fibre speeds doubled to 100 Mbps across six cities, ADSL is to be retired by end-2026, and a single national transport operator was recommended. An operator doubled fibre speeds at no extra cost in June 2026, reaching up to 100 Mbps across six cities (speeds). Retirement of copper and migration to fibre to the home was announced for the end of 2026, with no subscriber or coverage figure published (migration). The national digital week recommended making the state transport-infrastructure company the sole national operator of transport infrastructure, as a law; nothing has been tabled (recommendation). No route map or backbone length for the country is held.	MOVEMENT
Mauritania	The national infrastructure company operates more than 1,760 km of fibre on three axes, and a regional programme's backbone loan closed in 2022. The kilometre figure is the company's own, given at the inauguration of its headquarters in December 2025, with no route map, capacity, utilisation or wholesale tariff beside it (network). The regional communications infrastructure programme's second loan closed with an implementation completion report covering the national backbone it financed (completion). The relationship between the two - what the programme built and what the company now runs - is not established by anything on file.	MOVEMENT
Mauritius	The backbone is in service under the 2030 strategic plan's connectivity pillar; no route length or capacity figure is held. The 2030 strategic plan is the instrument the backbone sits under (plan). The incumbent used its December 2025 summit to position the island as the natural connector between Africa and Asia (summit). What the base does not hold on this indicator is any physical figure — kilometres laid, lit capacity, or the number of exchanges reached. The connector claim rests on landings and geography rather than on a published domestic network.	NO CHANGE
Morocco	Fibre to the home reached 1.5m lines, about half of wireline internet, with passive sharing opening commercially and joint ventures holding shared assets. The regulator's first-quarter 2026 observatory gives fixed lines at 3.262m, up 5.05 per cent, and fibre to the home at 1.5m, about 52 per cent of wireline internet (observatory). Technical prerequisites for passive infrastructure sharing were completed in April 2026 with commercial opening scheduled for 27 April over a 40,000-line lot (sharing); the date is the operator's own filing and no source confirms the opening happened (sharing). Two operators formed joint ventures on shared fibre and mobile-site assets in April 2025, with no further reporting on file; the regulator flagged uneven low-density coverage as a risk of the shared model (joint ventures).	MOVEMENT
Mozambique	The incumbent's modernisation facility covers 7,600 km of fibre and capacity from 10 to 400 Gbit/s, last reported 57 per cent complete in 2023. The scope is 1,350 antennas, 7,600 km of fibre and capacity raised from 10 to 400 Gbit/s, at 57 per cent complete in September 2023 with completion expected in May 2024 (facility). No completion or delivery report has entered the base since. It is the only national backbone build on record, and its last measured position is three years old.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Namibia	The backbone runs to 18,719.5 km, and the state operator is laying redundant long-distance routes after network failures. The ministry's budget motivation gives the network length as 18,719.5 km, longest in //Karas at 3,340.48 km, Otjozondjupa at 2,624.34 km and Erongo at 2,547.72 km (motivation). The state fixed operator said in May 2026 that it is laying new long-distance routes and creating redundant paths between key cities and regions, acknowledging network problems customers had experienced (modernisation), and signed a second open-access fibre partnership in June 2026, live in five named localities (partnership). That modernisation is financed by a seven-year N$405 million social loan from a commercial bank (loan). No later backbone length is published, so the redundancy work cannot be read as added kilometres.	MOVEMENT
Niger	1,031 km on five cross-border axes were provisionally accepted in November 2025, above a 2,275 km domestic backbone completed in 2017. The trans-Sahara acceptance covers five axes to Algeria, Chad, Nigeria, Benin and Burkina Faso plus an 88 km loop to the national data centre, under a project launched in 2017 with works from 2021 and financed at about EUR 43m through a concessional window and national counterpart funds (acceptance, reception, financing). The domestic backbone runs 2,275 km across three sections, built under a concessional loan of RMB 623.7m signed in January 2014 and completed in the first quarter of 2017, aimed at raising national broadband coverage from 54 to 72 per cent (loan, backbone). Repayment responsibility was assigned to the incumbent, whose legal relationship to the loan is unresolved in the source.	MOVEMENT
Nigeria	Project BRIDGE has a US$1.6bn appraised envelope and an October 2026 start, against about 101,000 km already built that bypasses some 130m Nigerians. The programme's special purpose vehicle is incorporated with private investors at 51 to 75 per cent and the state at 25 to 49 (execution); the minister stated in August 2026 that the 90,000 km rollout begins in October and that funding is raised, against the 2027 start for physical deployment the project documents carry (execution, rollout, envelope). The financier's own two figures are five weeks apart and on different bases: an appraisal counting 30,000 km of terrestrial fibre deployed against the 120,000 km the national blueprint requires and stating flatly that there is no national backbone network, and a board statement framing the programme as extending the backbone from 35,000 km to 125,000 (appraisal, approval). About 101,000 km of fibre has been built and the finding is that it bypasses some 130m Nigerians, a utilisation and last-mile problem rather than a backbone one (utilisation); an operator lit a 400G and 800G optical backbone in October 2025 (optical).	MIXED a 90,000 km open-access programme moving into execution while the fibre already built bypasses 130m people
Rwanda	A government network carrying US$33.5m is named as a project subcomponent and has not moved in the base in twelve months. It is named as a subcomponent of the acceleration project with a stated allocation and nothing else: no route, capacity, coverage or completion figure (network). A named national system carrying that much money and generating no reporting for a year is the clearest instance in this unit of the reporting problem the acceleration project has generally.	NO CHANGE
Senegal	The state operator records 4,500 km of fibre and more than 400 administrative buildings connected; the regulator is consulting on how fibre is shared. The operator's own account gives 4,500 km of optical fibre across the territory and 720 km of submarine cable between Praia and Dakar, presence in 14 regions and 42 departments, more than 400 administrative buildings connected by fibre, 174 point-to-point on a closed secure network, 252 on mobile broadband and 148 structures on the intranet. The commercial access network is separate: the incumbent operator inaugurated its thousandth fibre plaque and reports FCFA 288.6 billion of investment in 2025, 15% of turnover, with catalogue speeds improved without a tariff increase; it gives no route-kilometre, homes-passed or coverage figure. The regulatory question is open: the regulator published in August 2026 a synthesis of 21 contributions to its consultation on deploying and sharing fibre to the end subscriber, setting no rule, obligation or timetable.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Seychelles	The incumbent upgraded its national fibre network to 50G-PON in April 2026, raising entry-level unlimited plans to 60 Mbps at no extra cost. The upgrade raised entry-level unlimited plans to a minimum of 60 Mbps and capped plans to a minimum 30 GB automatically, on newly deployed 50G-PON technology across the fibre network (upgrade). The competing operator had launched unlimited home broadband from R999 for 10 Mbps in September 2025, with a R200 booster to 200 Mbps (package). Both announcements are the operators' own. Neither publishes homes passed, subscriber numbers or coverage by district, and the regulator's quarterly statistics carry no fibre series.	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	The national fibre backbone reaches 14 of 16 districts, a marginal advance with the last two districts unstated as to timing. Backbone coverage was reported at 14 of 16 districts in May 2026 (backbone, centre, ambition). No date, cost or route is stated for the remaining two, and no utilisation or last-mile figure accompanies the coverage count. The evidence recorded separately is that the gap in this country is usage rather than reach.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	The regulator convened the first submarine cable technical working group in June 2026; the terrestrial backbone is still being designed under a feasibility consultancy. The working group brought cable operators, internet service providers and technical experts together on outage management, competition, infrastructure development and implementation of the submarine cable regulatory framework (workshop). The consultancy launched in October 2025 is mapping existing broadband infrastructure and designing backbone and cross-border routes (launch), funded by the regional project's grant agreement (agreement). No route kilometre figure for a national terrestrial backbone appears anywhere in the base.	MOVEMENT
South Africa	The flagship broadband programme was declared ended and the state network merger pushed to FY2028/29, while an amendment Bill on rapid deployment was tabled and a private wholesale 5G network opened. 2026-04-28 — the state network merger went backwards: the plan tabled in March 2026 starts again with a preliminary report and implementation in FY2028/29, where the year's deliverable was a finalised road map. 2026-04-20 — an Electronic Communications Amendment Bill was tabled that would make not-for-profit network services licence-exempt and require a uniform wayleave process, with submissions extended to 21 September 2026. 2026-08 — a privately financed wholesale 5G home-broadband network opened wholesale sales, its chief executive accepting that this is the open-access network the state spent a decade trying to licence. No coverage footprint, site count or wholesale price is published, so what entered service cannot be sized. 2026-09-07 - a third long-haul route from Cape Town to Pretoria via Springbok and Mahikeng was completed, inside a wholesale network of about 180,000km, so a major break no longer isolates the country. The operator association applied for a five-year Competition Act exemption letting its six members share limited infrastructure planning information through an independent third party, to find connectivity gaps and cut duplicated build. The Commission's timetable is not held.	MIXED a programme closed and a merger deferred while a rapid-deployment Bill and a wholesale network moved
South Sudan	A commercial fibre project moved to execution in early 2026, and the state backbone programme states fibre tendering starting in the second half of 2026. The commercial project holds a fifteen-year licence and moved to execution with a local partner in early 2026 (execution, licence). The state programme runs about 2,400 km through a neighbour (tendering); the design budget and route length are the government's own figures, and the lender's implementation report puts tendering in the second half of 2026 (tendering, network, design, route). Neither has laid cable on any record held.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sudan	The incumbent added 1,586 km of backbone and 94 sites in 2025, taking group-wide terrestrial fibre past 25,000 km. The operator's own results announcement for the year to 31 December 2025 reports over 25,000 km of terrestrial fibre group-wide, 1,586 km of new backbone added and 94 new sites built, alongside stakes in three submarine systems (results). These are group figures across the operator's footprint, not a Sudan-only count, and they are the company's own. The audited statements for the same year carry a qualified opinion, because war-related restrictions on access to Khartoum, Darfur and Kordofan sites prevented verification of property, plant and equipment (statements).	MOVEMENT
Tanzania	The prime minister committed to further national backbone investment and higher rural fund allocations (statement). The prime minister committed to continued investment in the communications sector, including strengthening the national backbone and raising funding for the rural communications fund (statement). No amount or route length is stated. A contradiction between three figures is resolved: 16,280 km is the planned total, 13,820 km the length laid at April 2025, and 15,167 km the length at December 2025 (backbone); the "over 15,000 km" quoted at an international summit in July 2026 is that December figure, correctly stated (backbone, budget, zanzibar, sector). It is built as a state network: the regional manager states phase one connected government offices and public institutions, with individual citizens only next. A backbone user figure for one region was given to the minister and no national connected-user total is held (users). A cross-border terrestrial link was launched in July 2026 with no capacity, cost or financing stated, and its relation to a 2025 connection is unreconciled (link). The state operator agreed with the Burundian backbone operator to raise cross-border capacity from 4Gbps to 10Gbps, reported 9 September 2026 (capacity).	MOVEMENT
Togo	The backbone is documented for the first time — about 1,500 and 800 route kilometres — and a seven-year core rebuild was signed. Government ICT specification pages describe the incumbent's backbone at about 1,500 km north-south at 24 fibres a link, doubled at Lome and on two northern axes; the second operator's at about 800 km at 96 fibres; and the government network at about 300 km linking over 600 public buildings, its core rebuilt and lifted from 10 to 100 Gbit/s. The page carries no editorial date, so its February 2023 price validity is a floor. In December 2025 the incumbent signed a seven-year agreement worth close to 60 billion FCFA to rebuild its fixed and mobile core, transmission and architecture and add more than 500 radio sites. A development policy operation approved on 15 December 2025 carries a cap on wholesale broadband prices among its prior actions.	MOVEMENT
Tunisia	More than 50,000 km of fibre is claimed by the incumbent, and the Medusa cable entered commercial service in June 2026. The incumbent operator stated on winning the 5G licence in November 2024 that it had deployed more than 50,000 km of fibre, the backbone under its fibre-backed rollout. The Medusa submarine cable reached Bizerte on 1 November 2025, the system's first African arrival, with a 1,040 km Tunisian segment giving the second operator up to 24 Tbps and that operator owning and running the landing station, and entered commercial service on 24 June 2026 with four fibre pairs at 24 Tbps each. The 50,000 km is the operator's own figure, given as it took the 5G licence, and nothing independent holds it. No national backbone map, route inventory or coverage statement is published.	MOVEMENT
Uganda	Parliament approved an RMB 1.05bn loan for backbone phase five in December 2023, with no newer figure, and service-centre throughput was made contingent on it. The loan approval is the last figure on file for the backbone programme (loan). Making the service centres' throughput contingent on a backbone phase whose latest reported position is a 2023 loan approval is the dependency worth stating. A 260 km commercial route carrying over 1 Tbit/s was lit before the window opened (route), and a gigabit fixed broadband product launched in May 2026 with no subscriber, price or footprint figure published (product).	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zambia	The backbone extension financing stood at 0 per cent disbursement as of July 2022 — the largest single undrawn digital-infrastructure commitment the base holds — and the two national fibre-length figures are irreconcilable. Corruption allegations from a former utility board chairman are on the record against the undrawn commitment (extension). Neither fibre-length figure states whether it counts backbone only or backbone plus metropolitan and access network, which is why they cannot be reconciled (length, appraisal). A second communication towers programme reached 87.8 per cent disbursement on ministry reporting through a third-party database (towers). One programme nearly drawn and one not drawn at all, both Chinese-financed, is the backbone record.	MIXED a backbone extension financed and 0 per cent drawn while the two national fibre-length figures cannot be reconciled
Zimbabwe	Two ministerial fibre-length figures four months apart reconcile neither with each other nor with the regulator's series, and a cross-border corridor carries traffic on phase one. Two ministerial figures four months apart and a regulator series that matches neither is the measurement position (length, report). The corridor's first phase runs on an indefeasible right-of-use model with the state operator retaining operational control (corridor, switch-on). Government arrears owed to the state fixed operator doubled on the chief executive's statement at an annual general meeting; the two currency figures are the company's own (arrears) — the state is the largest debtor of the operator carrying its backbone.	MIXED a cross-border corridor switched on while ministerial fibre-length figures do not reconcile with each other or the regulator

International internet bandwidth

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	Equipped international capacity exceeds 10.2 terabits per second, up from 1.5 in early 2020. 2026-01-15 - the minister told parliament that equipped international bandwidth capacity now exceeds 10.2 terabits per second, against 1.5 terabits in early 2020 - close to a sevenfold rise over six years, on the minister's own figures. 2025-10-23 - the minister gave the go-ahead for a submarine fibre-optic cable project departing from the capital's port, intended to expand the routes available. What is not published is utilisation: no figure for how much of the equipped capacity carries traffic, and no wholesale price, appears on this ledger.	MOVEMENT
Angola	A new cable branch entered service with 23.6 Tbps allocated to Angola, and 1.0 Tbps was contracted through a neighbouring landing. 2025-12-13 — the 2Africa branch and its landing station were inaugurated and switched on, built by the incumbent for US$43m, with 23.6 Tbps of the cable's capacity allocated to Angola, replacing an end-of-life system and one already at capacity. The incumbent is the only Angolan member of the consortium. 2026-06-15 — the state operator signed a master service agreement for an initial 1.0 Tbps of dedicated capacity through a Namibian landing of the Equiano cable, with an option to assume ownership; design, testing, commissioning and handover are still to run, and the country reaches that cable only indirectly. Further submarine expansion is stated as ministry policy. No price, utilisation or wholesale capacity figure is published for any of it, so the base can state what has been added and not what it costs or carries.	MOVEMENT
Benin	The earlier regional connectivity project closed and a second was approved in March 2026 at US$137m across three countries. No bandwidth figure for Benin is published. The first regional connectivity project reached its implementation completion report in January 2018. 2026-03-10 — a second operation under the same regional programme was approved, at US$137m across Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone. What neither record carries is a capacity figure: no international bandwidth in gigabits per second, and no price per megabit, appears anywhere on this ledger.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Botswana	A first direct cross-border fibre link with Namibia was completed and interconnected, while the only national traffic figure held remains just over 100Gbps from February 2025. 2026-08-10 — the Namibian operator completed the Gobabis-Buitepos link, now interconnecting at Charles Hill, which the two sides describe as the first direct cross-border fibre link between them, against a memorandum only in February 2026. No capacity, commissioning date or traffic figure is published for the link and the corridor beyond it is not reported delivered. 2026-07-06 — a second corridor's first phase is live at 800Gbps on equipment rated over 10Tbps, with phase two due September 2026; it is described as a three-country corridor and the live section is inside a neighbour, with no Botswana segment dated. Measurement has not moved with the build. International traffic was just over 100Gbps in February 2025, up from under 8Gbps in 2015, after a P100m gateway upgrade, and no later figure has been published — the only national capacity figure the base holds, eighteen months old at the window's close.	MOVEMENT
Burkina Faso	Nigeria proposed connecting its planned 90,000 km fibre network to Burkina Faso's borders. At a bilateral meeting of the two digital-transformation ministers on 12 August 2026, Nigeria proposed connecting its planned 90,000 km open-access national fibre network to Burkina Faso's borders to improve internet resilience, quality and affordability, alongside cooperation on artificial intelligence, digital public infrastructure and talent. It is a proposed corridor and not a live link: no agreement, route, capacity or date is held, and the Nigerian network it would connect to is itself planned rather than built.	MOVEMENT
Burundi	International capacity runs through neighbouring countries' submarine landings; no capacity figure is published. The regulator's indicators report records submarine cable access to EASSy, SEACOM and TEAMS through neighbouring countries, cross-border fibre interconnection points with Rwanda, the Democratic Republic of the Congo and Tanzania, and regional roaming. For a landlocked country the international bandwidth position is its neighbours' landings and the transit bought over them. What the base does not hold is any capacity figure in Gbps, any wholesale transit price, or any statement of redundancy — which is the part that matters, since a single cross-border route is a single point of failure for the whole country's international traffic. Capacity on the Tanzanian route was agreed to rise from 4Gbps to 10Gbps, reported 9 September 2026 (capacity).	NO CHANGE
Cameroon	A memorandum to join the Medusa Africa submarine cable was finalised in December 2025. Cameroon finalised a memorandum of understanding to join the Medusa Africa submarine cable project, stated to be operational by 2028 and to improve connectivity with Europe, Africa and Asia. It is a memorandum and not a landing: no landing station, capacity, cost or in-service date for Cameroon is held.	MOVEMENT
Cape Verde	EllaLink came ashore at Praia on 18 February 2021 with a stated 30 TB capacity. The EllaLink submarine cable came ashore at Portinho beach, Achada Grande Tras, in Praia on 18 February 2021; the Secretary of State for Innovation called it a historic moment for the country's telecommunications, and the government's record gives the low-latency fibre system a capacity of 30 TB, more than all existing cables combined. A second ECOWAS regional submarine cable reached feasibility-study validation at a Monrovia workshop in October 2025. No inventory naming every system serving Cabo Verde, its landing station and its in-service date is held, and no lit or used capacity figure is on file for any of them.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Central African Republic	A published assessment set out the options for reaching submarine cable capacity other than through Cameroon (assessment). A published assessment set out the options for reaching submarine cable capacity other than through Cameroon (assessment). It is an analysis, not a route secured.	MOVEMENT
Chad	The fibre corridor memorandum to a neighbour was suspended pending revision, and that route is the country's only entry point for international submarine-cable capacity. The ministry ordered the two operators to correct the clauses and sign; the date of the suspension is not established in any source held (corridor, analysis, sites). For a landlocked country this route is the only entry point for international submarine-cable capacity on the record. Suspending the instrument that would build it is the single most consequential regression in this unit.	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Comoros	The regulator approved the state cable company's 2025-2026 access catalogue, setting wholesale international connectivity prices. 2025-07-17 - a regulator decision approved the access catalogue, setting the wholesale prices at which a state-owned company sells the country's international connectivity. The tariff schedule itself is a separate document and is not held, the regulator publishes no decision series so no prior catalogue exists in the base, and the held decision is an excerpt of a two-page scan. What the country pays for international capacity, and whether the approved prices moved, cannot be stated from anything on file.	MOVEMENT
Congo	A switch to an alternative submarine cable was stated to be three weeks away in July 2026; no source confirms any new cable carrying traffic. The country has relied on one cable since 2012, and after weeks of outages sought a new subsea connection in January 2026. 2026-07-14 - the regulator stated a connection to another cable could be operational within three weeks, with one alternative cable delayed. No source since confirms any new cable carrying traffic. Single-cable dependence is the structural fact under every connectivity row here, and no capacity figure, landing station or redundancy arrangement is published for the cable actually in service.	STALLED
Cote d'Ivoire	A consortium memorandum was signed for an Atlantic cable with an Ivorian landing, and an existing branch was repaired. 2026-05-15 - a Europe-to-South Africa Atlantic system with an Ivorian landing had its consortium memorandum signed, its route survey funded and supplier selection being prepared. No landing date, capacity or cost is stated, and the held Ivorian account is a reprint of the consortium release. 2026-08-02 - the 2Africa Ivory Coast branch was restored to service after an outage, with WACS repairs expected the following week. The outage's start date, cause and duration are not stated, and no capacity figure for any landing is on file.	MOVEMENT
Djibouti	Twelve submarine systems land in the country, carrying about 18% of international submarine cable data, and a southern extension is under build. Twelve operational systems were reached by the two carrier-neutral facilities in June 2025, and twelve now land, six of them connected to Italy, carrying about 18% of international submarine cable data. Both counts are the reporting parties' own; no landing register is held. 2025-09 - a southern extension of the regional cable was announced at 36 Tbit/s over about 3,200 to 3,500 km, ready for service in 2028, reported across three outlets. 2026-08-03 - an Italian cable inspection and protection project at the landing station was reported during a ministerial mission, under a memorandum with the finance ministry and with no amount, term or delivery date.	MOVEMENT
DR Congo	International bandwidth stood at 6 kbit/s per internet user in 2020; one operator activated an initial 200 Gbps of submarine capacity on 18 December 2025. No later per-user figure is published. The reference statistical profile is the only per-user measurement the base holds: international bandwidth 6 kbit/s per internet user in 2020, mobile network coverage 75 per cent in 2022 and 27 per cent of individuals using the internet in the same year. 2025-12-18 - one operator became the first in the country to bring the first phase of a submarine cable into service, activating an initial 200 Gbps of international capacity. 2026-09-09 - the eastern half of the country was tied into a terrestrial corridor to the Indian Ocean: a 2,000 km route is live and carrying traffic. Two new routes and no updated per-user figure: the improvement is real and cannot be sized against the 2020 baseline.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Egypt	About fifteen active international submarine systems land in the country, the largest concentration in Africa, and a 200 km, 5 Pbps link to Taba is under agreement. The base held thirteen systems landing on the eastern coast with a stated plan to expand to eighteen, and now about fifteen active systems, the largest concentration in Africa. Both figures are operator or ministry-reported and no independent register is held. The largest system carries Mediterranean capacity in service since January 2025 on the Port Said to Genoa and Marseille route, with the country a transit hub rather than a terminal landing, the whole stated at about 45,000 km across thirty-three or more countries and designed for up to 180 Tbps on main routes. No later source updates the vendor partnership behind that activation. An agreement was signed on 3 September 2026 to construct a multiple-petabit Sharm El Sheikh to Taba subsea cable, framed by the incumbent as extending the country's eastern digital corridor. It is a domestic route rather than an international landing, and no cost or in-service date is held. The Sharm El Sheikh to Taba link has a contractor: Power Sub Link, building the 200 km cable extending the Red Sea festoon into a continuous Suez-to-Taba path at about 5 petabits per second (contractor).	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	The country lands three submarine systems, has two more under study or agreement, and since November 2025 exchanges traffic overland with Gabon. One regional system was inaugurated in 2018 on a 400 km route between the two main cities and a neighbour, alongside an earlier landing; no later capacity or utilisation figure is held (regional cables). The state infrastructure operator is landing party for the continental system and hosted its maintenance committee in May 2026, with capacity unchanged on the record (landing party). A Mediterranean-anchored system is under study at a landing in one of two towns, put at EUR 20-60m and 2029 to 2030 with an alternative route also named, the existing cable reported to degrade quality which is the stated reason for diversifying (study, routes). A subsea fibre agreement with Nigeria was signed in February 2026 bundling a data centre, with no route, capacity or delivery date published (agreement, signature). 2025-11-10 - the two countries' national backbones were interconnected and inaugurated at Ebibeyin, exchanging traffic on the Bitam-Ebibeyin and Libreville-Bata routes, the first terrestrial international route on this ledger; no traffic or capacity figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	Bandwidth is reported at about 1,536 Mbps after a decade of growth, and it is carried by satellite: no submarine cable lands in Eritrea. 2026-05-19 — the ministry put international bandwidth at about 1,536 Mbps, risen over the past decade. 2026-04-16 — the industry position is unchanged: Eritrea is still the only one of Africa's coastal states with no cable landing, and cable firms describe a country that does not answer landing requests. An earlier account of the same position dates it to June 2024. EriTel's international transit therefore runs on geostationary satellite, which is what a bandwidth figure of this size describes. The growth is real and the ceiling is the technology carrying it.	MOVEMENT on a ministry figure, with no cable landing behind it
Eswatini	International capacity on the national backbone stands at 72 Gbps, and a June 2026 ruling forced the backbone open after a provider built its own cross-border link. The national fibre backbone carries 72 Gbps of international capacity with rollout continuing (backbone). The national operator complained that a private provider had built its own cross-border fibre link from a border post, bypassing the backbone. The regulator fined the provider E150,000 and directed the operator to give reliable, non-discriminatory and transparent backbone access and to share its existing connections and fibre topology with internet service providers, effective 1 July 2026 (ruling). The alternative route out of the country runs to Maputo over powerline fibre and onward to undersea cable at Cape Town (programme). No per-operator bandwidth table, utilisation figure or price is published, so the 72 Gbps cannot be read against demand.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ethiopia	A multi-terabit corridor to Jeddah through Djibouti and Sudan entered deployment, the first new international route the base holds. The corridor is described as multi-terabit and now runs to Saudi Arabia, which would give a landlocked country a second path to international capacity alongside its existing transit (corridor deployment). No capacity figure, in-service date or price is published, and the base holds no measurement of international bandwidth in use, per person or in total, against which to read it. The incumbent's Year II business plan targets international gateway capacity rising from 4.3 Tbps to 5.2 Tbps in 2026/27 (plan); it is a target, not an outturn.	MOVEMENT
Gabon	Bandwidth stood at 35,321 bits per second per internet user in 2020 against 4,620 in 2010; a terrestrial route to a neighbour opened in November 2025 and a cable incident degraded service nationally in May 2026. The completion report ties the series to the infrastructure carrying it: 35,321 bits per second per internet user in 2020 against 4,620 in 2010, the submarine connection and the earlier role of a second cable system, a 1,760 km national backbone linking 26 towns and three borders, and a public-private operating arrangement with the first phase in commercial operation from February 2019. 2025-11-10 - a terrestrial route was added: the physical and logical interconnection between the national backbone and a neighbour's was inaugurated, exchanging traffic on two routes. 2026-05-27 - the dependence showed. An incident on the terrestrial section of the submarine system degraded internet service nationally overnight, with traffic progressively restored and full return to normal at 10h15 on 4 June, in under a week against a typical three, resilience mechanisms under the service delegation maintaining continuity. No per-user bandwidth figure later than 2020 is published.	MOVEMENT
Gambia	15 Gbps through the state incumbent, with a partnership to lift the backbone from 40 to 800 Gbps. The state incumbent's own profile puts its international capacity on the ACE cable at 15 Gbps and its share of the country's cable segment at 49 per cent. The US$50m partnership signed in December 2025 is to take the national backbone from 40 to 800 Gbps. A second submarine cable is further off: five states evaluated bids in Abuja between 29 June and 10 July 2026, and the programme coordinator flagged the deal as still unsigned later that month.	MOVEMENT
Ghana	The regulator names five submarine cable providers on an undated page, against an analyst count of six cables and about 2.5 Tbps in use. The landing licence rests on section 3(8) of the 2008 Act and the regulator's list carries no date, so it predates later landings; the six-cable count and the capacity estimate are an analyst's, not the regulator's (landing page, market brief). A separate five-year renewable authorisation lets consortium members sell capacity directly to users, charging 1 per cent of revenue annually, lapsing if not operated within two years and requiring three years' notice of non-renewal (carrier authorisation); the document held is the template with the grantee left blank (carrier authorisation). The 2008 Act is the statute under which both landings and 5G licences are granted, and it sources the universal-access fund from contributions stipulated in each licence rather than from any rate set in the Act (the Act).	NO CHANGE
Guinea	The single 2012 landing is saturated, and agreements are now signed or agreed for a second and a third cable. The cable has been the country's only landing for about thirteen to fifteen years and is named saturated (sole landing). A construction and maintenance agreement was signed in August 2026 to land a Mediterranean-anchored system at Conakry, with the state-majority landing party alongside a mobile operator; no timeline is given for the 8,700km, 19-landing-site system (second landing, agreement). Co-investment in a third system was agreed in Paris in June 2026 with no landing date published (third landing). No capacity figure, price or utilisation is published for the existing link or the two planned, so saturation is asserted and not measured.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Guinea-Bissau	The ACE submarine cable remains the country's only international fibre link, with a second, ECOWAS-led cable approved at feasibility stage in October 2025. International capacity rests on a single submarine cable. The ACE landing is the country's first and only international fibre-optic connection, live since March 2023, and it is held only as background in a secondary record: no primary on the landing itself is on the base. 2025-10-22 - member-state experts with their technical and financial partners reviewed and approved the feasibility study for a second submarine cable serving Cabo Verde, Liberia, Sierra Leone and Guinea-Bissau, at a workshop the ECOWAS Project Preparation and Development Unit convened in Monrovia. That cable is at feasibility and nothing further: no route, cost, landing site or construction date is published. Nor does any capacity, price or utilisation figure for the existing link appear on the ledger, so the base can state what carries the traffic and not how much it carries. The national backbone that would distribute that capacity inland is still in design.	NO CHANGE a second cable approved at feasibility but not built
Kenya	Two new submarine systems are expected, taking the country from seven landings to nine. A 10,000km France to Middle East system routed through Africa is expected by a research firm to land in 2027, which is a forecast rather than an operator or landing-party statement (forecast). A 4,108km system with 24 fibre pairs from Salalah to Mombasa at US$23m was ready for service in 2026 on its announcement, with the incumbent named landing and operating partner (cable); nothing held records landing, testing or service readiness (cable).	MOVEMENT
Lesotho	A managed satellite enterprise service launched in August 2026, the first international path not transiting a neighbour. 2018-02-13 — the regulator’s sector review describes the international gateways and bandwidth pricing structure. 2026-07-01 — the regulator’s strategic plan makes universal and meaningful connectivity its top theme. 2026-08-26 — the incumbent operator launched managed satellite enterprise connectivity. Lesotho is landlocked and every terrestrial route crosses South Africa. No capacity figure in gigabits, and no wholesale price, is published.	MOVEMENT
Liberia	Two routes to a second landing are open: one at Buchanan sought with partial funding, and an ECOWAS four-country cable approved at feasibility. 2025-10-22 - member-state experts with their technical and financial partners reviewed and approved the feasibility study for an ECOWAS second submarine cable serving Cabo Verde, Liberia, Sierra Leone and Guinea-Bissau at a workshop the ECOWAS Project Preparation and Development Unit convened in Monrovia; no route, cost, landing site or construction date is published. 2026-07-23 - the minister announced a second submarine landing at Buchanan, with partial funding stated as sourced and investors still being sought at a technology summit; no landing partner, cost or date is published. Neither record says whether the two are the same project. The country has run on one landing in the capital, which is why the agreement to commercialise spare fibre on the regional power grid matters as much as the cable does: both would end sole reliance on a single route.	MOVEMENT
Libya	The Medusa cable has been live at Misrata since May 2025 and no capacity or bandwidth figure has been published for it since. The cable was inaugurated at Misrata in May 2025 (inauguration). No capacity figure, utilisation share or price effect has been published in the fifteen months since, and the base holds no measure of international bandwidth per user for the country at all.	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	A subsea cable extension to Mahajanga and Toliara was announced in September 2025, with work from 2026 and service from 2028. The extension runs on a leg of 3,200 to 3,500 km via Tanzania and Mozambique and is ready for service in 2028 (extension, route). No capacity, landing-station or price figure is published, and the base holds no measure of the country's existing international bandwidth against which to set the addition.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Malawi	Wholesale bandwidth fell from about US$460 per Mbit/s a month in 2017 to below US$10 at 2024, and no price for 2025 or 2026 is held. The fall was reported at the close of the foundations project, on the lender's own figures (close, account). No wholesale price for 2025 or 2026 is held, so whether the gain has held is not established, and a 2024 appraisal instead gives about US$35 per Mbit/s (appraisal), which the base does not reconcile.	NO CHANGE
Mali	An independent subsea route with automated rerouting was added behind the inland backbone in July 2026, easing a landlocked country's exposure to three landing points. The inland backbone integrated capacity on a west-coast subsea system in July 2026, giving an independent route with automated rerouting behind it (integration). The country's inland routes had been exposed to the concentration of landings at Abidjan, Accra and Lagos. The account is the vendor's, and no capacity, price or utilisation figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Mauritania	The one international cable since 2011 is to be joined by a second commissioning in early 2027, with a third financed and unlanded. A single submarine cable has been the country's only international connection since 2011 (cable, baseline). The second cable was launched at Nouadhibou in July 2025 at 669 km and 200 Gb/s rising to 12 Tbit/s, European-financed; phase-one coastal landing is complete, offshore laying was scheduled for August 2026 and commissioning is expected in the first quarter of 2027 (landing, launch). A third system's sub-Saharan component is financed with no landing, route or commissioning date on record (financing). A country dependent on one cable for fifteen years is the position the other two are meant to end.	MOVEMENT
Mauritius	Two ageing cables carry most international traffic; a new cable participation rests on a non-disclosure agreement, and two further landings are named in an operator strategy. Landings exist on four systems, two of which carry most international traffic, and the stated driver for new capacity is infrastructure ageing, with one cable due to retire around 2027 (cables, estate). The prime-ministerial commitment to join a new transoceanic cable sits behind a signed non-disclosure agreement and unfinished technical, legal and financial negotiation; no consortium confirmation, landing point, capacity, cost or service date is published, and the operator's own chief executive stayed non-specific on subsea at the same event (commitment, summit, report). Two further landings are named as planned in the operator's strategy, one of them to replace the retiring cable, with no contract, cost or date published (landings).	MOVEMENT
Morocco	The Medusa subsea cable selected its optical supplier in July 2025 and no Moroccan landing date has been published. The supplier was selected in July 2025 and nothing further is on file; the system was announced in 2022 and landing agreements are held with licensed local operators (supplier). No capacity, price or utilisation figure for international bandwidth is held for the country, so the base records one cable in progress and no measure of what the country already has.	NO CHANGE
Mozambique	A subsea cable southern extension announced in 2025 plans a Mozambican landing, with work from 2026 and service from 2028. The extension plans landings in Tanzania, Mozambique, Madagascar and South Africa, interconnecting at Mombasa, with the Mombasa to Durban route estimated at 3,200 to 3,500 km (extension); no construction start was confirmed by August 2026 (extension). No capacity, price or utilisation figure for the country's existing international bandwidth is held, so the addition is on record and the base it adds to is not.	MOVEMENT
Namibia	A subsea cable station at Swakopmund carries a 100G link to Johannesburg, and a 2026 agreement commits an initial 1.0 Tbps on a regional system. The state fixed operator inaugurated its cable station and activated a 100G link between Swakopmund and Johannesburg in July 2024 (station). In June 2026 it signed a master service agreement with two Angolan counterparts for a regional submarine system integrating the existing cable, committing an initial dedicated 1.0 Tbps (agreement); the Namibian operator is the landing party hosting Angolan equipment. A low earth orbit satellite broadband service launched commercially in June 2026 through a licensed local partner, a second international route (satellite). No lit capacity, utilisation or wholesale price figure is published, so the 1.0 Tbps cannot be read against what is actually carried.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Niger	The minister put backbone modernisation at 100 to 800 Gbit/s and a second trans-Saharan phase of 3,500 to 4,000 km in June 2026. No capacity figure for international bandwidth is published for Niger, but the route it would travel is now described. The communications minister's account of 17 June 2026 sets out modernisation of the national backbone targeting 100 to 800 Gbit/s, a national data centre described as near complete, and continuing discussion of a second phase of the trans-Saharan link adding 3,500 to 4,000 km of fibre, presented as the route to becoming a regional telecommunications hub. The first phase is built rather than promised: sections of the trans-Saharan backbone were provisionally received in November 2025, about 1,031 km, over the domestic backbone financed from 2014. Niger is landlocked, so all of it is transit through neighbours.	MOVEMENT
Nigeria	A second international breakout via the 2Africa cable was announced, and ring-protected transit was activated across four cable systems. An operator announced on 7 February 2026 a second international breakout landing at Kwa Ibo in Akwa Ibom, reducing dependence on Lagos as the sole breakout — the first structural change to the country's landing geography the base records. A wholesale carrier reports activating ring-protected transit across four cable systems, giving carriers serving Nigeria east-to-east and west-to-west redundancy against a single-cable failure; it is the carrier's own account on its corporate channel. Neither carries a capacity figure. The last official one remains the 2020 broadband plan: six submarine cables at Lagos, over 40 Tbps available and under 10 per cent used, now six years old.	MOVEMENT
Rwanda	A new subsea cable system was announced in July 2026 with no timeline, and for a landlocked country the exposure is the terrestrial leg rather than the cable. The system was announced in early July 2026 and no timeline was given (cable). A landlocked country's exposure is backhaul, so this row moves only when the terrestrial leg is contracted. The cross-border terrestrial route recorded elsewhere in this report is the relevant instrument, and its live status rests on a vendor announcement.	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	The cable to the second island cut its project rating to moderately satisfactory in October 2025 on procurement difficulties, against installed international capacity of 35,840 Gb in 2023. The lender's status report records that progress towards the development objective declined from satisfactory to moderately satisfactory owing to ongoing challenges with procurement of the cable, while most other project activities progressed and the telecom legal and regulatory framework advanced considerably (status report). The regulator reports installed international broadband capacity of 35,840 Gb in 2023 against 6,122 Gb used (statistics), so the constraint is not headline capacity on the main island. Connecting the smaller island remains the single most consequential connectivity item for this country, and a year on the base can say only that its procurement is what slipped.	STALLED
Senegal	A subsea cable landing station was commissioned in December 2025, and a second cable landing was announced in May 2026 with no landing-site, financing or contract detail. The landing station was commissioned in December 2025; the base holds a month-precision event date and no day (station). The second cable was announced at a continental summit in May 2026 and no landing-site, financing or contract detail is held for the country's leg (cable). An internet exchange point reactivation was announced in a state and operator partnership in March 2025 and is the only source in the base naming the exchange (exchange).	MOVEMENT
Seychelles	International bandwidth stood at 308,074 Mbps at 31 March 2026, unchanged on the quarter, against 17,870 Mbps in March 2020. The regulator's first-quarter 2026 statistics give national international internet bandwidth of 308,074 Mbps, 154,023 uplink and 154,051 downlink, unchanged from the fourth quarter of 2025, against 17,870 Mbps at the start of the published series in March 2020 (statistics). The capacity behind it is two submarine cables: the SEAS link, and the PEACE cable in service since 16 November 2022 (cables). No utilisation figure against the lit capacity is published.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sierra Leone	A wholesale operator added new subsea capacity to its West Africa network in July 2026, and an ECOWAS four-country cable cleared feasibility in October 2025. The added capacity serves a wholesale route across several West African states and is not a national asset (capacity). 2025-07-11 - a ministry delegation assessed feasibility and public-private models for a second landing routed via Guinea, and nothing further on that route is held. 2025-10-22 - separately, ECOWAS member-state experts with their technical and financial partners reviewed and approved the feasibility study for a second submarine cable serving Cabo Verde, Liberia, Sierra Leone and Guinea-Bissau at a Monrovia workshop; no route, cost, landing site or construction date is published, and neither record says whether the two are the same project. A single landing station is the most concentrated infrastructure risk in this ledger, and until one of these is built it stays that way.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	A first submarine cable landing technical working group was opened with an international financier in June 2026. The working group was opened in June 2026 to develop the landing and its regulatory framework (group). That the regulatory framework is being developed alongside the first landing rather than after it is the point worth recording: the country is setting the rules for cable landings while it still has the option to.	MOVEMENT
South Africa	A new subsea route opened for business in December 2025 with two South African landings. 2025-12-04 — the 2Africa West route opened for business with landings at Yzerfontein and Duynefontein, an in-window addition to international capacity where none had been recorded. No capacity, price or utilisation figure is published for either landing, so the base can state that capacity was added and nothing about how much, at what cost, or to whom it is sold. That is the standing weakness of this indicator for the country: cable landings are announced and the wholesale market they feed is not measured anywhere on this ledger. A second route was launched in September 2026: a €93.1 million cable from Saint-Paul on Réunion to Durban, 16 fibre pairs at 20 Tbps each, to be built within three years and framed as route diversity ahead of an older cable's retirement from 2027 (launch). It is French-side led and about 79 per cent publicly funded, so the South African end is a landing rather than an investment. A second operator joined the EUR93 million consortium for a 16-fibre-pair cable to La Reunion on 9 September 2026, planned for service in 2028 as successor to a route in service since 2002 (consortium).	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	The international gateway is operated by a Swiss company which also holds the national data centre, under an oversight committee constituted with it. One privately held foreign company holds both the country's international gateway and its national data centre (gateway). No concession terms, duration, revenue share or performance condition is published for either. That concentration — international transit and national hosting in the same private hands — is stated in the record and nowhere explained.	NO CHANGE
Sudan	A tripartite binding agreement was signed in February 2026 converting a 2024 memorandum into a three-country fibre corridor, and no source states a build or completion date. The agreement was signed in Djibouti between the three states' operators, converting the December 2024 memorandum into a binding instrument (agreement, deal, corridor). No physical build or completion date is stated in any source held (review, operators). For a country whose international capacity runs through neighbours, the corridor is the single most consequential infrastructure commitment in this ledger, and it is dated only by its signature.	MOVEMENT
Tanzania	A submarine cable was announced in November 2025 with no construction start, contractor or cost confirmed since, and cables and landing stations are counted on two unreconciled bases. The cable announcement has produced nothing further in the base (cable). Cables and landing stations are not the same unit and nothing in the base reconciles the two counts, one from the regulator to December 2025 and one from a ministerial statement at an international summit (cables, summit).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Togo	Capacity on a second submarine system was added for route diversity, on a pan-regional account with no country-specific figure. The country is one of eleven places tagged in the account, and no national capacity, price or route figure is published (capacity, fibre pair, ownership). Route diversity on the subsea leg is real and unquantified here. It is the only international-capacity item in the ledger.	MOVEMENT
Tunisia	A submarine cable landing became ready for service in June 2026, with the state operator holding a dedicated fibre pair on it. The landing was ready for service on 3 June 2026. Both national operators' publicity claimed the landing; it is settled against the cable operator's own newsroom, which makes one the owner and the other a capacity customer (operational, live, landing, hosting). The state operator's dedicated pair entered service with the cable; the cable operator's record gives it as 20 Tbps and trade press and a national re-report give 22 (pair, joining). Access to the older landing station has been regulated since 2013, when the regulator required cost-oriented third-party access after terms proved prohibitive enough that an alternative cable was built to bypass it; nothing states whether that decision reaches the new cable.	MOVEMENT
Uganda	A 2,000 km protected route to the coast was switched on in February 2026, and a second route to the same coast launched with 1 Tbps activated. The first route was switched on in February 2026 (route, highway). The second launched in June 2026 with 1 Tbps activated, and is absent from the compiled intersection page (second). Two protected routes to the coast inside five months is the most substantive infrastructure gain in this unit, and both are commercial builds with no state instrument attached. A second international route is being procured under a presidential directive rather than by tender. The state transmission company cancelled open bidding for a commercialisation partner for its fibre network and moved to prepare a proposal for a single named company for a Uganda-Tanzania connection; the parliamentary committee on state enterprises questioned why firms that had expressed interest were dropped (committee). A State House letter of 27 August 2025 had told the ICT and energy ministers that a Tanzanian route could be cheaper than the existing route through Kenya. No contract, value or timetable is held.	MOVEMENT
Zambia	A cross-border fibre interconnector was commissioned in February 2026 with no capacity, cost or funder stated, and a terrestrial cable segment is stated ready for service in 2027. The interconnector was commissioned in February 2026 (interconnector, appraisal). The cable segment's 2027 date was first stated inside the window; the position itself did not move (segment, investment). For a landlocked country these two routes are the whole of the international capacity record, and neither carries a capacity figure.	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	Equipped international bandwidth rose on the regulator's fourth-quarter 2025 report, and the apparent collapse in headline used bandwidth is a reclassification rather than a fall in traffic. The measure excludes the satellite operator from the second quarter of 2025 (bandwidth). The satellite operator was excluded and the baseline restated from that quarter, so the apparent collapse in headline used bandwidth is a reclassification and not a fall in traffic (framework, report). Naming a measurement change as a measurement change is what stops a series break being read as a collapse. A terrestrial segment of a trans-continental cable, built by a domestically owned group, is stated ready for service in 2027 (segment).	MOVEMENT

Internet Exchange Points

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	An independent measurement puts local content at 13% of national traffic, most of it served from European servers. The position is unchanged at both ends: an independent measurement puts local content at 13% of national traffic in June 2026, most of it served from European servers, with no national exchange point or local-hosting policy held. It is the only traffic-localisation measure on this ledger and it is a third party's. A country with mandatory in-country data localisation, a new national data centre and a sovereign cloud has no published exchange point, and most of what its users reach is served from another continent.	NO CHANGE
Angola	Two active exchange points with 29 members between them, present in one of the fourteen population centres above 300,000. The tracker's position is that Angola has two active internet exchange points with 29 members between them, present in one of the country's fourteen population centres above 300,000 people. Domestic peering therefore exists but is concentrated in a single city, and traffic between networks elsewhere in the country still travels to reach it. Nothing in the window records a third exchange, a new member or a peering policy. The infrastructure that would feed one continued to grow — the national broadband programme and submarine fibre expansion — without a stated intention to distribute exchange capacity beyond the capital.	NO CHANGE
Benin	Benin IX is operating and tracked in the Internet Society's register. Benin IX appears in the Internet Society's IXP tracker. The society's Benin chapter published a study in June 2023 on what its redynamisation, modernisation and long-term viability would require, which is the only assessment of the exchange on the record. No peering-member count, traffic figure or local-traffic share is held.	NO CHANGE
Botswana	Digital Delta IX is registered and operating in Gaborone with one peer and 10G of capacity, while the 2005 association exchange is recorded defunct. 2026-04-21 — the exchange's registry entry records one peer, one connection and 10G of total capacity, the only public description of its size. 2025-11-25 — the Tier III data centre behind the exchange was launched. 2026-02-18 — Namibia's MTC and BoFiNet agreed cross-border interconnection, IP transit and wholesale capacity exchange through the Buitepos-Ngoma corridor. No traffic figure for the exchange is published. The first exchange is gone. The association-run exchange established in Gaborone in October 2005 is recorded as defunct in the international directory, with no subnets, facilities, contacts or switches listed and only a comment that work is happening and formalities remain to be sorted out. Nothing in the base records when it stopped operating or why, so a country that has had an exchange point for twenty years is starting again with one peer.	MIXED a new exchange with one peer while the country's first is recorded defunct
Burkina Faso	The exchange point runs at a 6 Gbit/s peak with local latency of 15 to 20 milliseconds against over 300 before peering. The exchange has operated since June 2015 at a 6 Gbit/s peak, keeping local traffic flowing through subsea cable cuts, and 2026-05-25 — local latency is reported at 15 to 20 milliseconds against over 300 before peering. The capacity figure has not moved and no update has been published since May 2026. For a landlocked country whose international transit runs through neighbours' coastlines, keeping domestic traffic domestic is the cheapest resilience available, and 6 Gbit/s is a small ceiling against the service estate this report describes. No address-protocol migration plan exists to sit beside it: operators and the regulator again called for a roadmap with a timetable in July 2026, with individual operators migrating on their own schedules.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burundi	The exchange created by decree in 2014 carries nine members and 26 Gbps of cumulative capacity, unchanged over the last twelve months. The instrument is old: a national internet exchange point was created by decree in May 2014, its first objective keeping local traffic off international links. 2026-08 - what it amounts to twelve years on is now on the record: nine member networks and 26 Gbps of cumulative port capacity, with no network joining and none leaving in the last twelve months. Five members are registered in Burundi, three in the United States and one in the Netherlands - two content networks, two research networks, one service provider, one backbone operator at 10 Gbps, a route server and two unclassified. The security and measurement markers are absent: four of the nine peer at the route server, five hold valid routing-origin authorisations, the exchange is in no routing-security programme and hosts no measurement anchor. No traffic figure is published at any date, so how much local traffic actually stays local is not something this base can state.	NO CHANGE twelve months with no member joining or leaving
Cameroon	CAMIX opened a third point of presence at the ST Digital data centre in April 2026. CAMIX opened a third point of presence at the ST Digital data centre in April 2026. Its Douala presence is tracked in the Internet Society's register, and the exchange's own site dates its current form to March 2026. No peering-member count, traffic figure or local-traffic share is held.	MOVEMENT
Cape Verde	One exchange exists, registered in Praia since 29 November 2022, and the government states it is operational and reduces cost and latency. The international exchange directory's registry entry records the exchange in Praia, organisation type association, status active, media type Ethernet, established 29 November 2022, with IPv4 and IPv6 subnets assigned; its switch, facility and participant tables are empty. The government's own status booklet states twice that the exchange is introduced and operational and that it reduces cost and latency, without a date beyond the booklet's own. No traffic, member or peering figure is published on either side, so what the base holds is that the exchange exists and not that it carries anything.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Central African Republic	A national internet exchange point was created in January 2026, known to the base only through a foreign operator's investor filing. 2026-01 — an internet exchange point was created, described as reinforcing digital sovereignty, where none existed. The date carries month precision and the sole source is an operator's half-year investor filing: no government instrument, membership list, peering agreement or traffic figure is held. That an exchange point's creation reaches this base through a foreign shareholder's financial report rather than through the regulator is the sharpest illustration of the measurement problem in this country. The regulator publishes nothing, reported under quality standards, and its own quality-of-service site is financed and not live.	MOVEMENT
Chad	The national internet exchange point held its first-year general assembly and adopted statutes and internal rules. The assembly was held in May 2026, institutionalising the exchange (exchange). Its stated purpose is to stop traffic leaving the country and returning, and the cost and latency benefit is asserted and never quantified. No member count, traffic volume or peering figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Comoros	An exchange point is installed at Moroni, letting the two operators exchange local traffic; the earlier programme-funded attempt failed. The regional communications programme that built the cable landings tried and failed to establish an exchange point, for want of telecom-operator commitment, and its completion report of March 2023 records that as an unmet outcome. The state cable company's own site now states that an exchange point has been installed at Moroni, enabling local traffic exchange between Comores Telecom and Yas Comores, alongside IP transit at Moroni and the 2Africa cable in service. That page is undated and is the only record of it; no traffic figure, membership list, operating date or independent confirmation exists on file. What changed between 2023 and now, and who paid, is not stated anywhere.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Congo	CGIX has served as the African Union's Central Africa sub-regional hub since August 2017. The Congo Internet eXchange Point was initiated by the regulator and launched in May 2013 with seven connected operators, and was selected by the African Union in August 2017 to serve as the Central Africa sub-regional hub; its own portal states 4 connected members, 1 point of presence and 70 Mb/s of traffic an hour. The counters are the exchange's own and carry no date on the page, and the fall from seven operators at launch to four members is not explained anywhere in the base.	NO CHANGE
Cote d'Ivoire	The national exchange point is operating with content-network peering at a 36 Gbps daily average, over a decade in service. The exchange has been operating for over a decade and was reported peering with content networks alongside operators and internet service providers at an average daily 36 Gbps. A memorandum was signed in June 2025 to colocate a third point of presence at a Grand-Bassam facility, and nothing on file confirms it was commissioned. No traffic series, member count or peering policy is published, so the single throughput figure is the whole of the evidence.	NO CHANGE
Djibouti	Two exchange points operate, a national one and an international operator's, both unchanged in the window. The two exchanges are in operation, a national point and one run by an international exchange operator alongside it, the second launched with a carrier-neutral facility expansion. Nothing moved in the window. No traffic figure, member count or peering policy is published for either, so what they carry is unknown - which is the same gap that sits under the country's whole transit position, where the landing count is published and the capacity is not.	NO CHANGE
DR Congo	One exchange became distributed across two carrier-neutral facilities and another moved into a Tier III facility. 2026-05 - an exchange established in 2023 and operating from a single presence added a second presence at a Kinshasa carrier-neutral facility, making it the country's first distributed exchange, open to licensed operators, service providers, mobile networks, cloud and content providers. 2026-08-20 - a second exchange relocated its infrastructure into a carrier-neutral Tier III data centre, the operators stating it connects more than 20 networks with over 1 Tbps of available capacity and expecting more than 2 Tbps after the move, as one of three points under a national exchange project managed by the internet service providers association. Capacity and network counts are the operators' own and no traffic measurement is held for either.	MOVEMENT
Egypt	15% of popular web content is served from inside the country, the majority from European servers. A byte-weighted measurement puts 15% of popular web content served locally, the majority from European servers, against 13% for Algeria, 66% for South Africa and 83% for the United States. No prior reading is held. The finding sits against the cable-hub and data-centre framing: the country carries other people's transit and hosts little of its own users' content. The one edge presence on file is a content-delivery edge location in Cairo in operation since May 2024, with a vendor-stated latency reduction of up to about 30%, and no capacity expansion or additional presence recorded - an edge cache, not a cloud region.	NO CHANGE
Equatorial Guinea	The exchange point reached construction stage in 2017 and no launch has been recorded since. The continental infrastructure registry's entry is the only record the base holds: construction stage in 2017, no launch, no operator, no traffic figure. Nine years on nothing records it operating, so domestic traffic between Equatoguinean networks has no published local exchange path.	NO CHANGE
Eritrea	None. The exchange tracker records no active exchange point and no listing in the peering database, so domestic traffic leaves the country and returns. The tracker states it directly: there are no active internet exchange points in the country and none listed in the peering database. Every exchange of traffic between two domestic networks therefore travels out over international transit and back. The transit it travels on is satellite, which makes the cost of that detour unusually high in both money and delay. An exchange at the capital appears in a diaspora policy proposal alongside a cable landing and domestic data-centre capacity, and in no government document. Nothing records a peering arrangement being negotiated or an exchange being constituted.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eswatini	A national internet exchange point was launched in April 2014 under the African Union's exchange-point project; nothing later is held. The African Union Commission launched the exchange point with the ICT ministry and the Internet Society on 10 April 2014, to keep intra-country traffic inside the country rather than routing it abroad (launch). Twelve years on the base holds no peering-member count, no traffic figure, and no statement that it is operating. The one adjacent fact the base does hold points the other way: the regulator had to order the national operator in June 2026 to share its backbone and fibre topology with internet service providers, which is the interconnection problem an exchange point exists to solve at the traffic layer.	NO CHANGE launched in 2014 with nothing published since
Ethiopia	The country's only internet exchange carries three members and 21 Gbps of cumulative port capacity (tracker). Measurement from self-reported peering data, last updated in January 2026, records the Addis Ababa Internet Exchange with three members, 21 Gbps of cumulative port speeds, all three members peering at the route server and two of the three using route origin validation (tracker). The exchange, the country's first, had by September 2025 been operating for over a year at a Tier III data centre in the technology park (update). The base holds no earlier capacity or membership figure, so the level is stated and the direction is not. It holds no second exchange and none outside the capital.	NO CHANGE a first measurement of the sole exchange with no earlier figure behind it
Gabon	The exchange point passed 250 Mbps of local traffic after the two mobile operators reconnected, from about 80 Mbps and two members. The two operators reconnected on 13 May 2026 and local traffic passed 250 Mbps, against about 80 Mbps unchanged since 2019 on two members (relaunch). A national reboot workshop ran from 3 to 8 August 2026 with an international internet body and the regional registry, closing with certificates after six days of peering, security and sovereignty training (reboot workshop, workshop programme). The registry called for a network of trained ambassadors to carry the skills into firms and administrations, and operator representatives named broader institutional buy-in as the remaining task; the post-relaunch member count has not been published.	MOVEMENT
Gambia	The Serekunda exchange, founded in 2013 by fourteen members, publishes no current traffic figures. The exchange's own page records its founding on 25 July 2013 by fourteen members and shows no current traffic or membership data. It is the country's only exchange point, and nothing in the base since 2013 states how much traffic it keeps local or which providers peer there.	NO CHANGE
Ghana	The Accra exchange is past 200 Gbps, but only 4 of 39 connected networks peer at all three exchanges, so most local traffic still transits abroad. The fragmentation is the finding rather than the traffic figure: an exchange's value is the traffic it keeps local, and three partly-overlapping exchanges keep less of it than one would (exchange traffic). No membership list, peering policy or retained-traffic percentage is published for any of the three, so the base can see the overlap and not what it costs.	MIXED the main exchange grew while three exchanges keep splitting the traffic between them
Guinea	The exchange point's executive secretary represented the country at the fifteenth continental peering forum, and the base holds no traffic or member figure for the exchange itself. The national internet exchange point was represented at the fifteenth African peering and interconnection forum in Kigali from 17 to 20 August 2026, supported by the communications, digital economy and innovation ministry through a regional digital integration programme, with the stated aim of strengthening its place in the continental interconnection network (forum). Attendance is what is recorded. No peering agreement, member count, traffic figure or local-traffic share is published for the exchange point, so whether domestic traffic stays in the country is not established.	MOVEMENT
Guinea-Bissau	No exchange point is recorded; the national fibre backbone it would sit on is still at tender. Nothing in the base records an internet exchange point in Guinea-Bissau, operating or planned. The domestic network that would justify one is not built: the national fibre backbone tender was relaunched in March 2026 after two prior rounds were cancelled, and the procurement plan records that history.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Kenya	A foreign-operated exchange runs in Nairobi alongside the association-run exchange active there since February 2001. Connected networks include a major video platform and a satellite operator (exchange). The baseline is inferred from the stated twentyfold growth rather than separately published, so the direction is firmer than the level. The country's own exchange, managed by the technology service providers' association, has been active in Nairobi since February 2001 on Ethernet with two subnets. The third-party registry record carries no participant count, traffic figure or facility list, so its size is not established and the base cannot compare the two exchanges.	MOVEMENT
Lesotho	The exchange was relaunched after a revamp in February 2026, with a refreshed registry record in May. 2011 — the regulator’s annual report covers the exchange’s founding period and the regional cable completion. 2026-02-02 — the Internet Society chapter relaunched the revamped exchange. 2026-05-13 — a refreshed registry record gives a later externally visible snapshot. No peer count, traffic figure or capacity for the exchange is published.	MOVEMENT
Liberia	The exchange launched in 2015 is functional but still under-peered as at December 2025. The Liberia Internet Exchange Point was launched in Monrovia on 6 August 2015 by the African Union Commission with the ministry under the African Internet Exchange System project, which supplied equipment, technical support and capacity building. No separate licence or establishing regulation was located. At the national peering forum in December 2025 the regulator's commissioner said the exchange remains functional but suffers governance problems and limited provider participation, with many providers still not peering, against upgraded equipment and a newly elected association leadership.	NO CHANGE
Libya	Libya's only registered exchange point shows zero peers connected. The registry record for the Tripoli exchange lists no connected peers, so nothing measurable is exchanged there and domestic traffic between Libyan networks has no published local path. Nothing in the base since records a peering agreement, a member count or a traffic figure for it.	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	The country's one exchange point is restarting after a 2019 suspension, on a small operating footprint. A funder announcement of January 2025 named the national research network as a peering infrastructure grantee to restart the exchange after its suspension in 2019 (grant). A tracker page updated in February 2026 shows one active exchange with four members and under 1 per cent of domestic networks reachable through it (tracker). The restart is real and the footprint is small: the figures evidence an exchange in operation rather than one most domestic networks reach.	MOVEMENT
Malawi	The Lilongwe exchange took a peering infrastructure grant in February 2026 after standing up a new switching fabric. The older exchange has run since December 2008, operated by the internet service providers' association, and migrated its peering to the national data centre as of 14 November 2024. No traffic figure, member count or port speed is published for it, at any point in eighteen years. 2025-12 - the Lilongwe exchange stood up the first phase of a new leaf-spine switching fabric with a content delivery network installed at its facility. 2026-02 - it was awarded a sustainable peering infrastructure grant to raise port speeds and take additional members. Two exchanges and no published measure of what either carries.	MOVEMENT
Mali	A steering committee for an exchange point was created by decree in 2017 and nothing since says whether it reported or an exchange point exists. Decree n. 2017-0872/P-RM created the committee with its organisation and working arrangements (decree). Nine years on the record is silent: no committee report, no exchange point, no operator listing. A published peering record would settle it, and the row is carried as a dated absence rather than a finding either way.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritania	The base holds a 2014 feasibility study for a national exchange point and nothing since saying whether one was established. The final study was completed under the regional connectivity project in June 2014, setting out the state of the internet sector and its market data (study). Twelve years on, nothing on the record says whether an exchange point exists. A published operator listing or peering record would settle it, and the row is carried as a dated absence rather than as a finding either way.	NO CHANGE
Mauritius	The exchange launched in 2015 runs public route servers on both address families; its size is known only from a third-party tracker. It was launched in August 2015 with African Union support, to keep intra-country traffic in country (launch). Its route servers and looking glass are publicly reachable on both address families (looking glass). The only account of its size is an external tracker's snapshot (tracker). The exchange publishes its infrastructure and not its traffic: no peer count, throughput figure or domestic-traffic share comes from the exchange itself.	NO CHANGE
Morocco	The two exchanges carry 210 Gbps and 30 Gbps across three members each, with net contraction over twelve months. A turnkey contract to build a national internet exchange point was documented by the regulator in December 2023. What the trackers show is small and shrinking: the larger exchange at 210 Gbps across three members and the Casablanca exchange at 30 Gbps across three, with net contraction over the trailing twelve months. Three members is not a peering fabric for a market this size.	REGRESSED
Mozambique	The national internet exchange carries 143 Gbps of cumulative member port capacity across eighteen peers, and opened a second point of presence in a carrier-neutral Maputo facility in May 2025. The exchange is operated by the national university's computer centre in Maputo, founded in May 2002, with eighteen peers on its own site and 143 Gbps of cumulative member port capacity (exchange). A second point of presence opened at a carrier-neutral Maputo data centre hosting more than fifteen network operators in May 2025, when the exchange reported peak traffic above 150 Gbps across nineteen peering members and about 35 per cent of the country's internet traffic routed through domestic exchanges (point of presence). Member port capacity is an upper bound on what could be exchanged at one time and not measured traffic; no autonomous systems joined or left over the tracked period and the exchange's own peering database record has been stale since 2016 (tracker). The peer count falls between the 2025 and 2026 accounts and neither explains it.	MOVEMENT
Niger	A Niamey internet exchange point was inaugurated in August 2025, letting domestic networks exchange traffic locally. The exchange entered service on 19 August 2025 (exchange). No peer count, port capacity or traffic figure is published, so the base records that domestic interconnection now exists and not how much passes through it. It sits beside a national data centre accepted three months later, which is the other half of keeping traffic and data in the country.	MOVEMENT
Nigeria	The national internet exchange passed 1 Tbps of traffic in April 2025, and close to twelve licence-exempt optical links now carry urban transport across Lagos. The exchange passed a 1 Tbps traffic milestone in April 2025 (exchange). Two companies say they deployed close to twelve wireless optical links across Lagos over two years, distributing bandwidth from points of presence to banks, internet providers, hotels and a utility, rated at up to 20 Gbps over up to 20 km, with three further cities named next; the links need no trenching, civil works or spectrum licence, so a high-capacity urban transport layer sits outside the spectrum instruments the regulator uses to shape the market (links, deployment).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rwanda	The exchange took a new cloud member in June 2026, and Rwanda was selected to host the continental peering forum in August 2026. The exchange operates under terms tying its management to a 2014 memorandum between the regulator and the country-code registry (terms). Rwanda was selected to host the continent's principal peering and interconnection forum in August 2026, putting the exchange and Kigali at the centre of continental interconnection discussion (announcement). A cloud infrastructure operator announced its own connection in June 2026 (announcement). No member count, traffic figure or peering ratio is published.	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	There is no active internet exchange point and none listed in the peering directory, with an internet resilience score of 30 out of 100. The tracker states that no exchange points are active in the country and none are listed in the peering database, and gives a resilience score of 30 out of 100 with 50 per cent of the 1,000 most-visited sites reachable from an in-country server or cache (tracker). For a two-island state whose only international capacity arrives on one submarine cable (cable), the absence of an exchange means domestic traffic between the two networks leaves the country and comes back. The page is a live tracker with no publication date and the year is inferred from the read.	NO CHANGE
Senegal	The exchange at Dakar records 260 Gbps of member capacity and six members, all six having joined within the preceding twelve months. The tracker records the exchange with 260 Gbps of cumulative member port capacity and six member networks at September 2026, six having joined over the last twelve months and none having left — so the entire recorded membership is new within the window. The figures are registry self-declarations rather than measured traffic, and no traffic volume is published. The older association-run exchange is constituted but unevidenced as operating: its statutes establish an association of indeterminate duration with its registered office at the telecommunications ministry, its object the direct exchange of local internet traffic to favour local services and optimise bandwidth cost, and name no members, traffic figure or operating site. Both took part in a state-co-organised national peering forum on 30 June 2026 with the regulator present, whose listed outcomes are given as expected results on a provisional programme.	MOVEMENT
Seychelles	An internet exchange point was launched in February 2015 under the African Union's AXIS project; nothing since records its operating state. The African Union's own launch statement records the exchange point established with the Department of ICT to keep intra-country internet traffic inside the country (launch). Eleven years on, no peering count, traffic figure, member list or operating statement is held, and nothing more current than the launch announcement was found. What the base establishes is that an exchange point was created, not that one runs.	NO CHANGE
Sierra Leone	One exchange is on the global register: Michcom-IX in Freetown, carrier-neutral, with five peers and 60G of capacity and no IPv6. The exchange is run as a non-profit initiative by Michcom Limited and is open-access and carrier-neutral, taking internet service providers, mobile operators, content delivery networks, cloud providers and academic and government networks; its record shows five peers, six connections, 60G of total capacity and no IPv6 (record). Five peers is the whole of the domestic peering fabric the base can see. No traffic volume, no national exchange run by the regulator, and no policy requiring local peering appears anywhere in the record.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	The country's only registered exchange point records zero peers and zero connections, on an entry last updated in September 2019. The registry entry lists the exchange in Mogadishu under the communications regulator, with IPv4 and IPv6 address blocks allocated, and states zero peers, zero connections, zero open peers and no IPv6 participation (record). The record's own last-updated stamp is September 2019, which is both the most current evidence available and a fact about how little has been reported since. Regional exchange-point support is inside the scope of the digital integration project's grant agreement (agreement); nothing reports it reaching this exchange.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	The Cape Town exchange went live at two further data-centre sites in August 2026, reaching six locations while one facility still holds most of its peering. 2026-08-03 — the Cape Town internet exchange went live at two further data-centre sites, taking it to six locations. More sites is the movement; concentration is what the same record shows underneath it. One facility holds 87 of the exchange's 122 networks and nearly every 100 Gbps port, against 208 networks and 10,132 Gbps on the more distributed Johannesburg exchange. Distribution across sites is not the same thing as resilience while a single building carries most of the peering, and the base holds no traffic, outage or failover figure for either exchange to test it against.	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	*Not held*, searched 2026-09-06 - exchange point coverage and peering efficiency both score zero, and the first exchange is being built. The internet resilience index scores exchange point coverage at zero out of a hundred and peering efficiency at zero out of a hundred as at July 2025, on registry and peering-database sources; a registered South Sudan exchange number sits with the communications authority with no members, prefixes or traffic (index). A peering roadshow ran in June 2025, the local internet society chapter now leads implementation of the country's first exchange, and external technical assistance was planned for the last quarter of 2025 (update). Zero peering means every domestic exchange of traffic leaves the country and comes back.	MOVEMENT
Sudan	The single listed exchange point has not been updated since January 2020; cooperation on exchange points was discussed in July 2026 without a commitment. The registry entry for Sudan's sole listed exchange point, operated by the National Information Center, records four peers and a 4G aggregate capacity, last updated on 22 January 2020 (entry). It is self-reported and shows no membership change since. At the WSIS Forum in July 2026 the minister discussed strengthening exchange points, IPv6 expansion and internet-resource development with the regional registry and the Internet Society (meeting). That is the only movement found, and it is a conversation rather than a peering.	NO CHANGE
Tanzania	Six exchanges operate on the association's own account, with a new operator joining the peering community. The service providers' association operates six exchanges — the Dar es Salaam exchange plus nodes at Arusha, Dodoma, Mbeya, Mwanza and Zanzibar. A carrier-neutral data-centre operator joined the association and the peering community with effect from 19 September 2025, opening peering, cross-connect activation and capacity roadmaps to others. A second developer passed 380 million dollars of committed capital in July 2026 with a Tanzanian carrier-neutral facility in its pipeline, exchange and peering connectivity among its intended services. No member count, traffic figure or share of traffic exchanged locally is published for any of the six.	MOVEMENT
Togo	Togo's single exchange point carries nine member networks and 18 Gbps of port capacity as at July 2026. The tracker records seven of the nine members peering at the route server and five of the nine validating route origins, with no participation in the mutually agreed routing norms and no measurement anchor at the exchange. The full member list carries autonomous system numbers, port speeds and countries of registration. The underlying data are self-reported by members to the peering database, so the figures are the members' own. The national data centre separately claims direct access to four submarine cables and a local exchange point. The base holds no traffic volume, no peering ratio and no second exchange.	NO CHANGE
Tunisia	The internet agency operates the national exchange point alongside the domain registry and address allocation; nothing else is held. The Tunisian internet agency's own institutional page states that it operates and manages the national internet exchange point, together with message gateways for service providers, the country-code domain registry in Latin and Arabic script, and national address allocation, and that it has run internet infrastructure since 1996. No founding instrument for the exchange was located, and the page carries no date of its own. No member list, peering count, traffic figure or statement of whether international traffic is exchanged locally is held — which is the measure this indicator would otherwise turn on.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Uganda	The established exchange began and ended 2024 at 32 networks and about 40 Gbps, and the state launched a national peering exchange in April 2026. 2025-01 - the established exchange reported it began and ended 2024 with 32 connected networks and about 40 Gbps of peak traffic, with a mid-year depression after a content provider withdrew remote peering worldwide and a recovery when a cache was restored. It also launched an endowment covering 25 per cent of annual non-salary operating expenses, and names high taxes and a continuing social-media restriction as suppressing growth. 2025-10 - the IT authority established a National IP Peering Exchange with a national peering policy. 2026-04 - that exchange was launched at a workshop in Kampala, on the stated grounds that domestic traffic was being routed internationally and back. Its own launch describes it as the country's first neutral and open exchange point, which the established exchange's report contradicts, and nothing on file reconciles the two. No connected-network or traffic figure has been published for it.	MIXED a second exchange launched while the first did not grow
Zambia	The Lusaka exchange carries 12 peers on 76G, and a regional DNS deployment went live on it. The exchange's peering record lists 12 peers over 12 connections, 10 of them open, on 76G of total capacity with full support for the newer addressing protocol. 2025-12 — a regional internet registry's DNS deployment went live at the exchange, its own account putting the reduction in query latency at roughly 93 per cent. Local DNS resolution is the least visible and most consequential thing an exchange does: it keeps lookups from crossing an ocean before a page begins to load, and the figure is the deploying body's own rather than an independent measurement. Traffic statistics for the exchange itself remain linked rather than published.	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	A national internet exchange point was reported to an international development forum in October 2020, and no traffic, peering or membership figure later than that is held. The report was made in October 2020 (exchange). Six years without a traffic, peering or membership figure is the record. It matters against the international-bandwidth series, because domestic peering is what would keep local traffic off that link.	NO CHANGE

Satellite broadband licensing and availability

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	The regulator opened a tender for two satellite-internet licences in April 2026; no award is held. There was no licensing route for non-geostationary satellite service at the window's opening. 2026-04-09 - the regulator opened a tender for two licences, reported as opening the satellite communications market. No award is held as at 2026-08-03, four months on. Nothing on file states the licence terms, the spectrum on offer, the coverage obligation or the closing date, so what the two licences would oblige a winner to do is unknown.	MOVEMENT
Angola	A low-orbit licence reached a multi-year capacity agreement and a first reseller was licensed on the national satellite, while one application is unresolved. 2026-06-12 — the country's first and only licensed low-orbit operator, granted a 15-year licence in June 2025 with a Luanda ground station, moved from licence to commercial deployment through a multi-year capacity agreement with a local provider. 2026-07-02 — on the national satellite, a commercial access hub opened in December 2025 with 37 firms in the integration process by April 2026, and a first startup was licensed to resell access. Bandwidth, pricing and operator access terms remain undisclosed. 2026-08-03 — the largest low-orbit operator is still unlicensed, with a secretary of state saying only that the process is under way and the regulator still working out how to fit low-orbit operators into a regime written for terrestrial networks. Sixteen months of identical status is the finding, the position being unchanged since the ministry said negotiations were continuing in April 2025.	MOVEMENT one operator now commercially deployed while another application stands unresolved

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Benin	ARCEP Decision 2024-108 sets the conditions for non-terrestrial network service providers. The regulator's Decision 2024-108 of 11 April 2024, made under the Code du numerique, fixes the conditions under which providers of non-terrestrial network services may operate — the licensing regime the satellite operators in the market run under. No licence award, applicant list or authorisation register under the decision is held.	MOVEMENT
Botswana	The incumbent connected 61 rural villages by satellite with 105 areas in progress, and no update has been published since November 2025. 2025-11-28 — the incumbent operator reported 61 rural villages connected by satellite — schools, clinics and community centres — with 105 further areas in process, announced with half-year results. No baseline preceded it and no update has followed in nine months. That is the whole of the satellite record for the country: no licensing decision, no low-earth-orbit operator, no tariff and no subscriber figure appears. The one place a satellite operator does appear is in a risk register — the state wholesale operator escalated low-earth-orbit competition to its board as a structural disruption, reported under national production capacity.	MOVEMENT on one programme with nothing reported since
Burkina Faso	The satellite operator is still unlicensed with a ministerial decision pending, after the regulator declared terminal sales irregular. The regulator declared terminal sales irregular under the 2008 telecommunications law, and 2026-07-26 — the operator remains unlicensed, with ministry negotiations reported advancing and the minister saying she hopes to rule soon. The position is unchanged across the window. The operator's own continental map still listed the country as available from 2026 without a licence, so an unlicensed service is being marketed into a market whose regulator has said the terminals are illegal. No second satellite operator, no capacity purchase and no institutional use of satellite backhaul appears on this ledger, which matters for the white-zone programme reported under digital divides: the localities it targets are the ones terrestrial backhaul reaches last.	NO CHANGE
Burundi	Satellite broadband is licensed but effectively unavailable on cost, the kit alone at roughly US$500, unchanged through the window. The service is licensed and effectively unavailable on price, with the terminal alone at roughly US$500. That was the position at the start of the window and nothing has moved it since: no tariff change, no subscriber figure, no second satellite operator and no regulatory statement appears. It is the only alternative to a mobile network that the regulator describes as failing mainly on electricity, and it is priced beyond the population it would serve. No universal-service subsidy, terminal financing or institutional purchase of satellite capacity is on the ledger.	NO CHANGE
Cameroon	A draft concession convention was finalised in December 2025, with the file at the ministry undecided for more than two years. The licence was refused in March 2025. 2025-12-12 - the regulator finalised a draft concession convention and specification, and as at July 2026 the file at the ministry had been undecided for more than two years, with the objections on record being lawful interception, armed-group use and the incumbent's commercial position. The 2024 customs circular remains the operative instrument, with kits entering through indirect registration abroad and ten modems seized at one post on 12 December 2025. No other satellite broadband offer is on file, so the country's whole position on the technology is one undecided file and a seizure regime.	MOVEMENT a draft concession convention was finalised while the file stayed undecided and the seizure circular stayed operative
Cape Verde	The satellite entrant reached 0.2% of internet subscriptions by June 2025, and the regulator opened a consultation on satellite rules. The entrant began activity in January 2025 under a general authorisation granted in 2024 and holds 0.2% of internet subscriptions at 30 June 2025, up 0.12 percentage points on the quarter in a market of 484,929 subscriptions; the Prime Minister had reported entry as an accomplished fact in November 2024 while the regulator dates commercial start to January 2025. No market-share figure later than that quarter is held. 2026-08-05 - the regulator opened a public consultation on licensing, radio-spectrum use, frequency coordination, user protection, network security and emergency communications for satellite operators, submissions to 31 August 2026, a direct response to the December 2024 launch; no draft text or adoption date is published.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Central African Republic	Satellite broadband went commercially live in March 2026 with 450 government kits, and the regulator began a field sweep against unregistered access points in August. 2026-03-16 — the service went commercially live as the operator's 27th African market, with 450 government kits, on a convention signed in December 2025 with United States embassy involvement. No licence and no service existed before. Enforcement followed at once. Roaming was deactivated on kits acquired abroad that had not met homologation conditions, on traceability and national-security grounds, six weeks after commercial launch. 2026-08-12 — the regulator began a control operation across named capital neighbourhoods identifying unregistered internet-access points, with the ministry estimating about 3,000 users in the country against 200 registered, and the operation to extend progressively to provincial cities. The ratio is the ministry's own estimate, no register total is published, and two of the operators visited said they had not been told registration was required. What limits the service is its price rather than its reach, and that is reported below.	MOVEMENT
Chad	A satellite operating licence was granted and commercial launch announced, under an order on conditions of use that mandates identification and retention ahead of any data-protection law. The licence was granted in March 2025 and commercial launch was announced by the minister in June 2026; no subscriber count is held at any date, and the government complained to the operator in Washington in May 2026 about service quality and tariffs it judged less competitive than in other African markets (licence, launch, service, complaint). The order on conditions of use was signed in August 2025. Its own number and text are not held, and identification and retention are mandated ahead of any data-protection law (order). Requiring subscriber identification and data retention in a country with no protection statute and no supervisory authority is the pattern this unit repeats.	MOVEMENT
Comoros	A ministerial circular of 9 June 2025 prohibits installation, testing, deployment and use of satellite internet, pending a licence. The circular was signed on 9 June 2025 and announced by the regulator on 12 June, with installation, testing, deployment and use all prohibited and no licence issued. It is still in force on the record: no licence, no lifting and no enforcement outcome is held. The circular's own text is not held, a field inspection to identify and notify users was announced with no outcome on file, and whether the operator has since been authorised is expressly not established - which for an archipelago whose inter-island connectivity is itself at feasibility-study stage is the material gap.	NO CHANGE
Congo	The regulator completed low-orbit specialist training and met a satellite operator; no licence or service authorisation is on file. 2025-10 - the regulator's network-services directorate completed three days of specialist training in France on constellations, transmission security, spectrum management and regulatory adaptability, and held a strategic meeting on low-orbit and high-altitude platform regulation. Regulatory capacity was built and nothing has been licensed. No licence, service launch or authorisation is on file at 2026-08-06, experimental satellite terminals require express regulator authorisation, and the satellite thread runs to European operators rather than to the American one that has been licensed in most neighbouring markets.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	Starlink began selling nationally in July 2026 on a twelve-month provisional licence, alongside two operator satellite offers. The position at the window's opening was that the entrant was not authorised to sell, the regulator having threatened sanctions in 2024 for supplying internet without authorisation, with frequencies since assigned. 2026-07-17 - it went live nationally on a twelve-month provisional licence reviewable on service quality, hardware XOF 148,148 to 247,466 and service from XOF 28,746 a month. The definitive individual licence under the 2024 electronic communications law is not yet issued. Both operators sell into rural white areas, one on leased geostationary capacity from January 2026 and one on hybrid geostationary and low-orbit capacity from April 2026, neither with a subscriber, price or coverage figure on file.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Djibouti	The incumbent's chief executive states there is no clear regulatory framework for new entrants; no licensing decision is on file. The position is unchanged at both ends: the incumbent's chief executive states there is no clear regulatory framework for new entrants, and no licensing decision is on file. It is a cited absence rather than an unexamined one, and it is stated by the party the absence protects. No application, refusal, consultation or draft framework for satellite market entry appears anywhere on this ledger, in a country whose interior regions the domestic fibre programme is still reaching one facility at a time.	NO CHANGE
DR Congo	A satellite direct-to-cell service launched commercially on 14 August 2026, while the sovereign satellite programme is unchanged. The satellite provider has been licensed since May 2025, reversing a March 2024 prohibition, a decision civil society welcomed as a corrective to incumbent monopoly abuse; the licence conditions and any enforcement outcome are not established. 2026-08-14 - a satellite-to-mobile service launched commercially, the first African operator to take such a partnership out of testing: a compatible handset with a clear view of the sky reaches messaging and voice where there is no terrestrial coverage, with no dish or router, on a phased rollout the regulator has confirmed. A free 30-day trial is the only access term published. The sovereign satellite programme has no contract, operator selection, build or launch date twelve months on.	MIXED a satellite-to-mobile service launched commercially while the sovereign satellite programme did not move in twelve months
Egypt	Satellite talks moved to a licensed local operator with no licence, entity or service date, a possible 2025 launch having passed. Advanced ministry negotiations were reported in June 2025 with a possible launch during that year. That expectation passed without delivery. Talks moved to a licensed local operator, with no licence, no local entity, no service date, and the operator's own map listing the country as service date unknown in May 2026; nothing is held on a June 2026 meeting or after. The standing instrument is a framework in force since 9 July 2024 for any foreign satellite operator serving earth-station terminals in the country, granting categorical licences to operators supplying space capacity to licensed providers, adopted in October 2023 with a grace period. No foreign low-earth-orbit operator has been licensed under it, and the telecommunications law criminalises unlicensed wireless equipment with a minimum of one year's imprisonment.	STALLED
Equatorial Guinea	The satellite service is now available in the country, after a July 2026 authorisation that covered only foreign companies' offshore operations. The July authorisation covered North American companies' offshore operations inside jurisdictional waters and was signed at the presidential palace on 28 July 2026, with extension to individual subscribers deferred on stated security grounds (authorisation). On 29 August 2026 the operator confirmed the service is available in the country, following the government's opening of negotiations on national digital transformation in March 2026 (availability). The confirmation is the operator's own, made on its and its owner's social-media accounts. Type-approval and competences were unresolved with the regulator a month earlier (implementation), against an entry signalled in February 2025 that was not then authorised (entry). So a service that was lawful for foreign companies at sea and unlawful for citizens on land is now stated to be generally available, and the licence, tariff and subscriber figures that would show on what terms are not held.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	Starlink lists Eritrea with no planned launch date, one of seven African states without a timetable; the base holds no licence application or refusal. 2026-07-17 — Starlink's own availability map still lists Eritrea as having no planned launch date, leaving it one of seven African states with no announced timetable, all of them in North Africa and the Horn. The position is the one the base carried at the start of the window. What is not on the ledger is any Eritrean decision: no application, no refusal and no regulatory statement about satellite broadband appears, so the absence is recorded from the operator's side only.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eswatini	A government satellite gateway was commissioned to reach mountainous and remote areas and reduce dependence on cross-border fibre, and a business reseller channel launched as a joint venture. The gateway was commissioned in April 2026, its stated purpose reaching mountainous and remote areas and reducing dependence on cross-border fibre (gateway). A joint venture launched as an authorised business reseller in July 2025 (reseller). A government-commissioned gateway is an unusual arrangement — most units in this frame record licensing and resale rather than state operation — and no capacity, coverage or cost figure is published for it.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	Satellite services are licensable as a class landing-right authorisation, and no low-earth-orbit operator is authorised on the record. The licensing directive of July 2021 carries a class authorisation for satellite voice, internet and data services provided without infrastructure or a network facility in the country, one of thirteen class licences alongside internet service provider, data centre, hosting and terminal authorisations (licensing directive). There is no orbit-specific determination and no authorised operator on record, and the regulator denied in July 2025 that any discussions with a low-earth-orbit operator had taken place (the same record).	NO CHANGE
Gabon	The regulator prohibited the sale, installation and use of one satellite service in May 2026 on penalty of fines, imprisonment and equipment seizure. The prohibition follows a warning against illegal commercialisation issued in November 2025 (regulator warning), and was announced with nationwide enforcement controls. At the same date the operator's own map still listed the country as available from 2026, with no licence granted (prohibition). No enforcement outcome is on file: no seizure, fine or prosecution has been reported, and no authorised satellite broadband provider exists on the record.	REGRESSED
Gambia	A satellite licence remains withheld after more than a year, the minister stating the applicant needs a general satellite licence rather than the permit sought. He stated on 24 May 2026 that he had refused to approve the permit and that the applicant lacks the competencies and equipment for the terminal permit (refusal). A fee was paid and the licence left unissued for over a year, the government citing due diligence in the face of United States pressure (due diligence), and the delay has been argued in public as a transparency and trust question (public argument). The base carries a fee paid in December 2024 and a permit payment in February 2026, and whether these are the same payment is not established.	NO CHANGE
Ghana	29 satellite licences have been issued, eleven of them last-mile, and subscriptions reached 15,384 by mid-2025 from 2,666 before licensing. The framework has operated since the end of August 2024 and nothing has been published on it since (framework). Subscriptions ran at 11,982 in the first quarter of 2025 and 15,384 in the second, from 2,666 before satellite licensing, on a regulator presentation to the international union (subscriptions). No figure has been published for any quarter after mid-2025, so a fast-moving series stops eighteen months before this report.	MOVEMENT
Guinea	One satellite provider is stated not to be recognised in the country, and no licensing decision is on file. The operators' union made the statement in May 2026 in the course of its dispute over access licensing (union statement). No authorisation, refusal, framework or enforcement action on satellite broadband is held at any date, so the position is a third party's characterisation rather than a regulatory decision.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Guinea-Bissau	Starlink has been commercially live since June 2025 under a provisional authorisation from the regulator, and nothing moved in the window. 2025-06-19 — Starlink entered service, Guinea-Bissau's seventh West African and twentieth continental market, following a provisional authorisation from ARN-TIC in April 2025. Both events fall before the twelve-month window. Nothing since records a definitive licence, a second satellite operator, a subscriber figure or a tariff, so what the base holds is the fact of availability and nothing about its reach. An initial provisional licence referred to in the launch record is not itself held. Satellite is the only service reaching what the absent national backbone does not, which is what makes the missing uptake figure matter.	NO CHANGE
Kenya	Satellite broadband reached 24,999 subscribers and 0.9 per cent of fixed share, with new orders in seven counties diverted to a waitlist. It stood at 17,425 subscribers and 0.8 per cent share in the quarter to June 2025 on 359 net adds (earlier quarter); by March 2026 it was a top-ten fixed provider with median speed of 34.55 Mbps, down 26 per cent year on year, and sign-ups in seven counties were suspended to a deposit-backed waitlist (cap). A direct-to-handset pilot with the second mobile operator was declared complete and awaits regulator approval; it would be the country's first such service on compatible handsets with no extra module or charge (pilot). A spectrum-interference audit opened in March 2026 with its conclusion put at mid-year had produced no finding, clearance or refusal as at August (audit). Separately a hyperscaler's constellation has applied for a fifteen-year international gateway licence covering an earth station and network control centre, the wholesale route into the market rather than the household one; neither the regulator's decision nor a determination date is held (gateway application).	MIXED subscribers grew while new sign-ups were capped in seven counties and two approvals stalled
Lesotho	A ten-year satellite licence was granted in April 2025 over local-shareholding objections, and the service is live through a sole reseller. The communications authority granted a ten-year licence on 14 April 2025, contested over full foreign ownership: the incumbent appealed for local shareholding and a rights group objected (licence, objection). Nothing later on record resolves the objection. The service launched through T-Connect as exclusive reseller on 30 June 2025 (launch, account), and by January 2026 was reported also carried over the incumbent's low-earth-orbit backhaul (backhaul).	MOVEMENT
Liberia	Satellite communications guidelines were issued in August 2026 setting licensing, tax and service rules, with no licence yet issued under them. The regulator frames the rules around national security and commercial transparency as space-based solutions become the route to territories terrestrial networks have not reached (market rules, guidelines). It frames them as opening licensed satellite broadband to the named constellations (framework), and no licence has yet been issued on the record.	MOVEMENT
Libya	The state operator signed a capacity partnership with Arabsat in August 2026 for the 30.5 degrees east position; no commercial terms are stated. LTT and Arabsat announced a partnership on 7 August 2026 for capacity on Arabsat-6A at 30.5 degrees east (partnership). No value, duration, service date or retail offer is published, and the base holds nothing on licensing terms for any other satellite provider, including the low-orbit operators active elsewhere in the region.	MOVEMENT
Madagascar	A direct-to-cell satellite trial ran in July 2026 on operator spectrum, a low-earth-orbit rural partnership deepened, and ten enclaved zones remain unconnected. The first direct-to-cell trial ran at Sadabe on 11 July 2026 on an operator's spectrum, the third African country to do so, with commercial launch pending the regulator (trial, authorisation). A separate low-earth-orbit rural broadband partnership was deepened in June 2026, with no rural site count or subscriber figure published (partnership). An arrangement to connect ten enclaved zones under the connectivity project was discussed in March 2025 and nothing has been connected, with no site or date published (zones).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Malawi	Thirty rural schools were connected by satellite, and an operator signalled interest in satellite backhaul at its annual meeting. Thirty rural schools were reported connected, serving 100,000 students and 1,500 teachers on a company announcement (schools); responsibility for the recurring subscription cost is not stated, and the student figure averages over 3,000 per school without reconciliation (schools, preparation). An operator signalled interest in satellite connectivity to complement terrestrial networks in hard-to-reach areas and improve resilience, with no partner, licence, capital allocation or timetable stated (interest). The base holds no satellite licence date, licence terms or subscriber figure for the country.	MOVEMENT
Mali	An operator's satellite 3G and 4G service reaches about 360,000 remote residents, while the regulator is seizing unauthorised terminals nationwide. The satellite-backhauled service is in service reaching about 360,000 remote residents, with no later coverage figure published (service, loan). A six-month lifting of the import ban on low-orbit kits was reported in October 2024 (lifting), the prohibition on unauthorised equipment was restated in March 2026 with a warning of sanctions (prohibition), and control, seizure and dismantling operations were announced in June 2026 against unauthorised kits, shared Wi-Fi zones and walkie-talkies, with operators ordered to cease immediately (enforcement). Imports and use remain banned pending authorisation.	MIXED a licensed operator's satellite service reaching remote residents while unauthorised terminals are seized
Mauritania	Three firms were provisionally selected for satellite internet licences across two lots in July 2026, with no award or operating framework published. The tender opened in January 2026 and nine bids were received, from which three firms were provisionally retained, two of them required to match the leading offer (selection, tender). Thirteen firms took the dossier, and the leading bid was US$800,000 for the mobile lot and US$3m for capacity against US$50,000 and MRU 6.5m from the other two (bids). The regulator's own communique is not held and the figures reach the base through a trade account of it. No award, launch date or operating framework has been published.	MOVEMENT
Mauritius	The satellite authorisation regime requires a locally licensed provider, a local point of presence and provider-retained terminals, and no service has been authorised under it. Raphael Island in the Saint Brandon archipelago was connected to the internet (report). The regulator's decision of May 2025 permits service only through a locally licensed provider, with a local point of presence carrying Mauritian-geolocated addresses, real-time terminal dashboards and provider-retained terminal ownership (decision). No satellite service has been authorised under it. Domestic experts are divided on its relevance given the country's existing fibre and mobile coverage (debate), which is the argument a small dense island makes against low-orbit service that larger neighbours cannot. The ICT authority awarded a two-year contract on 28 August 2026 to provide satellite-based internet and communications to Raphael Island in the St Brandon archipelago, a first for the archipelago, intended to strengthen maritime monitoring, meteorological capability and safety in a cyclone-prone area (contract). No service date, capacity or contract value is stated.	MOVEMENT
Morocco	Starlink has no licence eighteen months after incorporating a local subsidiary, while a satellite terminal licence was renewed in February 2026 to 2035. The subsidiary was incorporated in November 2024 with capital of MAD 1,000 and still had no authorisation in May 2026, with regulator negotiations reported continuing and the operator's own map listing the service date as unknown (status, subsidiary, observation). A licence requires a competitive call under the telecommunications law and security clearance, which is the procedural reason the base records rather than a refusal. The incumbent's satellite terminal licence was renewed in February 2026 for a further ten years to 2035 (renewal).	MIXED an incumbent terminal licence renewed to 2035 while the low-orbit operator is still unlicensed
Mozambique	Low-orbit service is live with an operator backhaul partnership, donated terminals went to flood centres, and trials of an Angolan satellite began in August 2026. The low-orbit service is live, with an operator backhaul and equipment-resale partnership; no licence date, subscriber count or terminal count is held (service, deployment). Donated terminals were deployed by the regulator with open access at flood accommodation and coordination centres in February 2026, plus four operator connectivity kits at four named locations; the terminal count is not stated (terminals). The state operator began proof-of-concept testing of the Angolan satellite in August 2026 as a step towards a commercial agreement, implementing a bilateral memorandum of June 2026; no commercial terms are published (trials).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Namibia	A satellite licence application was declined and 622 of 624 reconsideration requests failed, under a 51 per cent Namibian ownership requirement the applicant cannot meet. Licence and spectrum were declined in March 2026 on three of six statutory criteria; 622 of 624 reconsideration requests failed the legal threshold, two were refused on merits, and the operator's own request was dismissed as out of time (dismissal, rejection, block). The ownership requirement is in force with no exemption granted; the regulator held that wholly foreign ownership raises questions of jurisdiction, enforceability of compliance obligations and effective oversight, and states the power to waive the rule rests with the minister rather than with it (requirement). The applicant stated its global shareholding rules bar it from accepting local ownership (exemption).	REGRESSED
Niger	Satellite retail service has been available since March 2025 and an operator-integrated version launched in January 2026, while the regulator moved against unauthorised resale. Retail service became commercially available through approved sellers in March 2025 under an agreement signed with the operator in October 2024 (availability, launch, distribution). A telco-integrated service was commercialised in January 2026, with the operator rather than the customer holding the satellite relationship (integration). The regulator served a formal notice against unauthorised resale in September 2025 with a deadline of 3 October, carrying three months to a year and fines to 60m FCFA (notice), invoking a prior-authorisation regime that has been in force and is now enforced (regime).	MOVEMENT
Nigeria	Satellite service became the second-largest provider then paused orders over congestion, a second landing permit was granted with no service, and two national satellites were approved for 2028 and beyond. The incumbent satellite service became the country's second-largest internet provider on late-2024 figures, then paused new orders in parts of two cities over congestion in September 2025, and was brought inside the regulator's biometric subscriber-verification regime with more than 66,000 users required to submit identity numbers and headshots (provider, congestion, verification). A landing permit for a second constellation was granted in January 2026 with no service (permit). Cabinet approved the acquisition of two high-throughput communications satellites in August 2026 on an operator timetable of 2028 and 2029 or 2030, with no contract value published and negotiation still to follow (satellites, approval); a low-earth-orbit partnership announced in January 2025 has no service (partnership) and a direct-to-device memorandum targeted for end-2025 has nothing on file (direct to device).	MIXED the largest satellite provider paused orders over congestion and was brought inside biometric verification while three further satellite programmes remain unbuilt
Rwanda	A satellite reseller authorisation was certified by the space agency in February 2026, on a partnership running since December 2025. The reseller was certified in February 2026 and the partnership dates from December 2025; the held body is partial and flagged for verification (authorisation). No subscriber count, tariff or coverage figure is published, so the authorisation records a licensing step rather than availability.	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	Satellite internet service was activated in December 2025, about ten months after the operator stated an intention to invest. Intention to invest was reported in February 2025 and service began in December (service, intention). No licence terms, subscriber count, tariff or regulatory condition is published. In an island state whose only submarine cable to its second island is still in build, satellite is the redundancy that arrived first.	MOVEMENT
Senegal	A five-year satellite operating authorisation was granted in February 2026, a teleport gateway is in service, and the universal connectivity project slipped through the first half. The authorisation runs five years, with commercial launch about 4 February 2026 and the country the operator's twenty-sixth African market; the regulator separately warned against illegal wireless resale (authorisation, framework, warning). A teleport satellite gateway is in service; the source states no commissioning date so the publication date is used (gateway). The universal connectivity project opened a deployment tour in April 2026; the target was restated between February and April and the first half closed with nothing published (tour, deployment, kits).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Seychelles	Satellite internet soft-launched at a State House briefing in July 2026, after Cabinet approved the licence in February and the operator incorporated locally by May. Cabinet approved the service provider licence on 18 February 2026, the operator incorporated locally and was in final licensing by May, and the soft launch was confirmed at a State House briefing in July (soft launch, clearance, incorporation, live, coverage). Requiring local incorporation before licensing is the design choice worth recording: several units in this frame licensed the same operator on a full foreign-ownership basis, and this one did not. No subscriber count, tariff or coverage figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	Satellite service has been licensed since June 2024 with three local resellers, and twelve universities were connected under the national broadband strategy. The service has been licensed since June 2024 and operates through three local resellers (licence, universities). Twelve universities were connected through a local reseller under the broadband strategy (connection). Licensed satellite service reaching universities and, separately, health facilities makes one foreign operator the connectivity of last resort for two national systems at once.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	Satellite service became available nationwide in August 2025, four months after licensing, on a full foreign-ownership model without major public debate. The service was licensed in April 2025 and available nationwide from August, with a local reseller network following (availability, licence, reseller). Licensing on a full foreign-ownership model without major public debate is the fastest such accommodation on this base's West and East African record. No local-content, data-routing or emergency-access condition is published.	MOVEMENT
South Africa	The ministerial policy direction was rejected by the regulator and the 30% equity requirement stands, while a distributor deal took the route the Act already allows. An instrument was issued and neutralised inside five months. A policy direction gazetted on 12 December 2025 to unblock satellite licensing was rejected in May 2026, and the 30% historically-disadvantaged equity requirement stands. The minister publicly backs entry while conceding licensing is the regulator's alone, and at the spectrum hearings the largest prospective entrant pressed the regulator on how that requirement applies to the new gateway and user-terminal licence categories — which the draft does not say. 2026-07-15 — the market entered anyway by another door: a satellite operator appointed a domestic distributor, the acquisition route the Act already permits, while the other large constellation launched in its 27th African country without entering South Africa. 2026-05/08 — the fee rules moved. Draft amendments to the spectrum and fees regulations were gazetted, with oral hearings on 19 and 20 August 2026 covering satellite registration, blanket licensing for terminal networks and protection of radio astronomy; the prospective entrant's representations ask for flat per-licence fees and a ten-year minimum term.	MIXED the licensing framework went backwards while a distribution route opened and fee rules were consulted
South Sudan	No satellite broadband licence, authorisation or access terms are held; one account names a rural partnership and nothing more. One account names a rural satellite partnership and no licence, authorisation or access terms are held (account). In a country whose fibre backbone is untendered and whose coverage extensions are refused on revenue grounds, the absence of any satellite licensing record is a gap in what can be said rather than evidence that no service exists.	NO CHANGE
Sudan	Satellite service was never officially licensed and has run informally through smuggled terminals, and an armed group ordered services cut at a locality from 26 August 2026. The service has never been officially licensed on any source held, reaching the country through smuggled dishes described as a lifeline (terminals, lifeline). An armed group ordered services cut at a West Kordofan locality from 26 August 2026 (cut), having banned the service at the same place in December 2025 (ban). Connectivity in the conflict areas is therefore governed by whoever holds the ground rather than by the regulator, and the same terminals are described in the record as both a lifeline and a war facilitator (conflict).	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tanzania	Satellite broadband went live in November 2025 through operator partnerships, and no subscriber, licence or pricing figure for the country is held. The service went live at month precision, with the satellite operator moving from rival to partner of two mobile operators (service, partnership). No subscriber, licence or pricing figure is held. Arriving through operator partnerships rather than a direct consumer licence is a different market structure from most units in this frame, and no licensing instrument is on file either way.	MOVEMENT
Togo	A satellite licence has not been granted twelve months after the operator listed the country as available, and spectrum royalties for satellite and machine-to-machine services were amended by decree. The operator lists the country as available from 2026 with no licence granted; twelve months without movement is the finding, and the regulator has issued no statement on any application (licence, regulation, coverage). The royalty amendment was adopted in July 2026 and framed as encouraging innovation and connectivity; the parent decree is held only as an image scan with no text layer, so the baseline rates are unreadable (royalties, adjustment). Adjusting satellite spectrum royalties while granting no satellite licence is the sequence the record shows.	NO CHANGE
Tunisia	A satellite licence is withheld with pre-orders opened in February 2026, the unresolved point being routing through a local ground station and a national interconnection point. Pre-orders opened in February 2026 with no licence issued (status, pre-orders). The unresolved point is routing: the state wants low-earth-orbit traffic through a local ground station and a national interconnection point. That is a substantive sovereignty position rather than an administrative delay, and it is stated more clearly here than in any other unit in this frame that has withheld or granted the same licence.	NO CHANGE
Uganda	Commercial service began on 2 September 2026 under a five-year licence requiring a national gateway, a point of presence and registration of every device activated in the country. The licence text is not held; a January 2026 wholesale-model ruling and a May 2026 direct licence are unreconciled, and no subscriber or tariff figure is published (switch-on, licence, wholesale, blocking, shutdown). Two providers switched the service on in August 2026 and the held accounts differ on which was first, one naming a regional operator alone (reseller) and the other naming it alongside a domestic operator (switch-on). Either way it is a reseller launch rather than a licensing decision, with no subscriber count, price or coverage figure published. Partner states opened a joint funding account for a regional communications satellite study with deposits due 30 September 2026, and neither the study's cost nor each state's share was disclosed (satellite). 2026-09-02 — the operator began commercial service, ending the regulatory process that followed a memorandum and a five-year licence signed with the regulator in May 2026. The licence requires a national gateway and physical point of presence, an operational office and registration of every device activated in the country, conditions the regulator framed as security, revenue assurance, accountability and compliance with Ugandan law (launch, pricing). The January wholesale ruling and the May direct licence remain unreconciled on the record.	MOVEMENT
Zambia	The country is among the top three African satellite markets by June 2026 after entry in October 2023, and no national subscriber count, licence fee, contract term or procurement route is held. Market entry was October 2023 and the country ranks among the top three African markets by June 2026 (market, appraisal, chiefdom, skills). A top-three continental position with no licence fee, contract term or procurement route on record is worth stating as exactly that. Direct-to-cell satellite trials name the country as a trial site on an operator statement, with no licence, spectrum decision or trial result held (trials).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zimbabwe	Satellite service launched in September 2024 after a cut-off order, two licences were issued with no coverage obligation or duration stated, and terminal subscriptions are counted as a category rather than by operator. The service launched in September 2024 after the 2024 cut-off order, and licence terms, fee and duration are not held (service, rural). Two licences were issued in September 2024 and announced four days later; no coverage obligation, duration or universal-service term is stated in the held account (licences, award). The regulator counts satellite terminals as a category and not the operator separately (terminals), and the country's share of the African satellite market is reported off that same series (share); the state fixed operator's own satellite reseller revenue is reported in its 2025 annual report (reseller).	MOVEMENT

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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